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Former Tamil Nadu school education minister, DMK's Anbil Mahesh Poyyamozhi, was arrested by the Crime Branch for an alleged ₹100-cr financial fraud ▶ P 2

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INITIAL PUBLIC OFFER OF EQUITY SHARES ON THE MAIN BOARD OF BSE LIMITED ("BSE") AND NATIONAL STOCK EXCHANGE OF INDIA LIMITED ("NSE", AND TOGETHER WITH BSE, THE "STOCK EXCHANGES") IN COMPLIANCE WITH CHAPTER II OF THE SECURITIES AND EXCHANGE BOARD OF INDIA (ISSUE OF CAPITAL AND DISCLOSURE REQUIREMENTS) REGULATIONS, 2018, AS AMENDED ("SEBI ICDR REGULATIONS").

(Please scan this QR Code to view the RHP, the Abridged Prospectus and the Addendum)

SFC ENVIRONMENTAL TECHNOLOGIES LIMITED
(TO BE LISTED ON THE MAIN BOARD OF BSE AND NSE)

Our Company was originally incorporated as *'SFC Environmental Technologies Private Limited'* at Mumbai, Maharashtra as a private limited company under the Companies Act, 1956, pursuant to a certificate of incorporation dated March 29, 2005, issued by the Registrar of Companies, Maharashtra at Mumbai. Thereafter, our Company was converted from a private limited company to a public limited company, pursuant to a resolution passed in the extraordinary general meeting of our Shareholders held on June 29, 2024 and the name of our Company was changed to *'SFC Environmental Technologies Limited'* and a fresh certificate of incorporation dated August 13, 2024, was issued to our Company by the Registrar of Companies, Central Processing Centre. For further details on the changes in the name and registered office of our Company, see *"History and Certain Corporate Matters"* on page 342 of the red herring prospectus dated October 19, 2026 **("Red Herring Prospectus or RHP")** filed with the Registrar of Companies, Mumbai - II at Navi Mumbai (**"RoC"**) read with the addendum to the RHP and abridged prospectus dated October 23, 2026 (**"Addendum"**).

Registered Office: The Ambience Court, Hi-Tech Business Park, 21st Floor, Sector 19-D, Plot No. 2, Vashi, Navi Mumbai, Thane 400 705, Maharashtra, India. **Corporate Office:** 2201-2202, Rupa Renaissance, D-33, Turbhe MIDC Road, TTC Industrial Area, MIDC Industrial Area, Turbhe, Navi Mumbai 400 705, Maharashtra, India
Contact Person: Shweta Deshpande, Company Secretary and Compliance Officer; **Telephone:** +91 22 4482 2717; **Email:** compliance@sfcenv.com; **Website:** www.sfcenvironment.com; **Corporate Identity Number:** U37003MH2005PLC152235

THE PROMOTERS OF OUR COMPANY ARE SANDEEP SUDHAKAR ASOLKAR, PRIYA SANDEEP ASOLKAR, PRACHITI SANDEEP ASOLKAR AND SAKETCHANDRASINGH PRATAPSINGH DHANDORIYA

INITIAL PUBLIC OFFERING OF UP TO [●] EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹2 EACH ("EQUITY SHARES") OF OUR COMPANY FOR CASH AT A PRICE OF ₹[●] PER EQUITY SHARE (INCLUDING A SHARE PREMIUM OF ₹[●] PER EQUITY SHARE) ("OFFER PRICE") AGGREGATING UP TO ₹[●] MILLION ("OFFER"). THE OFFER COMPRISES A FRESH ISSUE OF UP TO [●] EQUITY SHARES (OF FACE VALUE OF ₹2 EACH) AGGREGATING UP TO ₹1,500.00 MILLION BY OUR COMPANY ("FRESH ISSUE") AND AN OFFER FOR SALE OF UP TO 15,682,750 EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹2 EACH ("OFFERED SHARES") AGGREGATING UP TO ₹[●] MILLION, COMPRISING OF UP TO 934,000 EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹2 EACH AGGREGATING UP TO ₹[●] MILLION BY SANDEEP SUDHAKAR ASOLKAR (HELD JOINTLY WITH PRIYA SANDEEP ASOLKAR), UP TO 3,736,000 EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹2 EACH AGGREGATING UP TO ₹[●] MILLION BY SAKETCHANDRASINGH PRATAPSINGH DHANDORIYA, (THE "PROMOTER SELLING SHAREHOLDERS") UP TO 3,565,000 EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹2 EACH AGGREGATING UP TO ₹[●] MILLION BY SARVESH KUMAR GARG, UP TO 2,136,000 EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹2 EACH AGGREGATING UP TO ₹[●] MILLION BY SANDEEP SAMBHAJI PARAB, UP TO 2,136,000 EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹2 EACH AGGREGATING UP TO ₹[●] MILLION BY RAJESH KESAVAN NAMBISAN, UP TO 2,136,000 EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹2 EACH AGGREGATING UP TO ₹[●] MILLION BY KUMARAGURU MADURAKAVI, UP TO 933,000 EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹2 EACH AGGREGATING UP TO ₹[●] MILLION BY VEERA VENKATA SATYANARAYANA YANNAMANI, UP TO 70,000 EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹2 EACH AGGREGATING UP TO ₹[●] MILLION BY JAYSHREE HARIT SHAH (HELD JOINTLY WITH HARIT PRAGJI SHAH), AND UP TO 36,750 EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹2 EACH AGGREGATING UP TO ₹[●] MILLION BY HARDIK SURESH MATALIA (THE "OTHER SELLING SHAREHOLDERS", AND TOGETHER WITH THE PROMOTER SELLING SHAREHOLDERS, THE "SELLING SHAREHOLDERS" AND SUCH OFFER FOR SALE OF EQUITY SHARES BY THE SELLING SHAREHOLDERS, THE "OFFER FOR SALE"). THE OFFER SHALL CONSTITUTE [●]% OF THE POST-OFFER PAID UP EQUITY SHARE CAPITAL OF OUR COMPANY.

DETAILS OF THE OFFER FOR SALE BY THE SELLING SHAREHOLDERS AND WEIGHTED AVERAGE COST OF ACQUISITION PER EQUITY SHARE

NAME OF THE SELLING SHAREHOLDERS	TYPE	NUMBER OF EQUITY SHARES OFFERED / AMOUNT (IN ₹ MILLION)	WEIGHTED AVERAGE COST OF ACQUISITION PER EQUITY SHARE (IN ₹)*#
Sandeep Sudhakar Asolkar (held jointly with Priya Sandeep Asolkar)	Promoter Selling Shareholders	Up to 934,000 Equity Shares of face value of ₹2 each aggregating up to ₹[●] million	36.72
Saketchandrasingh Pratapsingh Dhandoriya	Promoter Selling Shareholder	Up to 3,736,000 Equity Shares of face value of ₹2 each aggregating up to ₹[●] million	36.72
Sarvesh Kumar Garg	Other Selling Shareholder	Up to 3,565,000 Equity Shares of face value of ₹2 each aggregating up to ₹[●] million	36.72
Sandeep Sambhaji Parab	Other Selling Shareholder	Up to 2,136,000 Equity Shares of face value of ₹2 each aggregating up to ₹[●] million	36.72
Rajesh Kesavan Nambisan	Other Selling Shareholder	Up to 2,136,000 Equity Shares of face value of ₹2 each aggregating up to ₹[●] million	36.72
Kumaraguru Madurakavi	Other Selling Shareholder	Up to 2,136,000 Equity Shares of face value of ₹2 each aggregating up to ₹[●] million	36.72
Veera Venkata Satyanarayana Yannamani	Other Selling Shareholder	Up to 933,000 Equity Shares of face value of ₹2 each aggregating up to ₹[●] million	36.72
Jayshree Harit Shah (held jointly with Harit Pragji Shah)	Other Selling Shareholder	Up to 70,000 Equity Shares of face value of ₹2 each aggregating up to ₹[●] million	42.85
Hardik Suresh Matalia	Other Selling Shareholder	Up to 36,750 Equity Shares of face value of ₹2 each aggregating up to ₹[●] million	36.72

**As certified by M/s H H Dedhia & Associates, Chartered Accountants, pursuant to their certificate dated October 23, 2026.*
#Calculated per Equity Share on a fully diluted basis.

PRICE BAND: ₹313 TO ₹330 PER EQUITY SHARE OF FACE VALUE OF ₹2 EACH.
THE FLOOR PRICE IS 156.50 TIMES THE FACE VALUE OF THE EQUITY SHARES AND THE CAP PRICE IS 165.00 TIMES THE FACE VALUE OF THE EQUITY SHARES.
BIDS CAN BE MADE FOR A MINIMUM OF 45 EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹2 EACH AND IN MULTIPLES OF 45 EQUITY SHARES THEREAFTER.
THE PRICE TO EARNINGS RATIO ("P/E") BASED ON DILUTED EPS FOR FISCAL 2026 AT THE LOWER END OF THE PRICE BAND (I.E. FLOOR PRICE) IS 18.95 TIMES AND AT THE UPPER END OF THE PRICE BAND (I.E. CAP PRICE) IS 19.98 TIMES AS COMPARED TO THE AVERAGE INDUSTRY PEER GROUP P/E RATIO OF 101.38 TIMES FOR FISCAL 2026.
WEIGHTED AVERAGE RETURN ON NET WORTH FOR LAST THREE FISCALS 2026, 2025 AND 2024 IS 23.82% AND FOR THREE MONTHS PERIOD ENDED JUNE 30, 2026 IS 0.19% *(not annualised)*.

The details of the Fresh Issue, Offer for Sale and the post Offer market capitalization of our Company, each at the Floor Price and the Cap Price, are given below:

Particulars	At Floor Price of ₹313 each		At Cap Price of ₹330 each	
	Upto No. of Equity Shares of Face Value ₹2 each	Upto amount (₹ in Million)	Upto No. of Equity Shares of Face Value ₹2 each	Upto amount (₹ in Million)
Fresh Issue	4,792,332	1,500.00	4,545,454	1,500.00
Offer For Sale	15,682,750	4,908.70	15,682,750	5,175.31
Total Offer Size	**20,475,082**	**6,408.70**	**20,228,204**	**6,675.31**
Post Offer Market Capitalisation of our Company	98,203,602	30,737.73	97,956,724	32,325.72

BID / OFFER PERIOD

BID / OFFER OPENS TODAY

BID / OFFER CLOSES ON THURSDAY, OCTOBER 29, 2026#

 # The UPI mandate end time and date shall be at 5:00 p.m. on Bid / Offer Closing Date.

We are an environmental technology company offering efficient technologies and comprehensive engineering solutions in the field of wastewater treatment ("WWT"), wastewater recycling & reuse ("WRR") and solid waste treatment ("SWT").

THE OFFER IS BEING MADE THROUGH THE BOOK BUILDING PROCESS IN ACCORDANCE WITH REGULATION 6(1) OF THE SEBI ICDR REGULATIONS.
THE EQUITY SHARES OF THE COMPANY WILL GET LISTED ON THE MAIN BOARDS OF BSE LIMITED ("BSE") AND NATIONAL STOCK EXCHANGE OF INDIA LIMITED ("NSE"). NSE SHALL BE THE DESIGNATED STOCK EXCHANGE.
• QIB PORTION: NOT MORE THAN 50% OF THE OFFER • NON-INSTITUTIONAL PORTION: NOT LESS THAN 15% OF THE OFFER • RETAIL INDIVIDUAL PORTION: NOT LESS THAN 35% OF THE OFFER

IN MAKING AN INVESTMENT DECISION, POTENTIAL INVESTORS MUST RELY ONLY ON THE INFORMATION INCLUDED IN THE RHP READ WITH THE ADDENDUM AND THE TERMS OF THE OFFER, INCLUDING THE RISKS INVOLVED AND NOT RELY ON ANY OTHER EXTERNAL SOURCES OF INFORMATION ABOUT THE OFFER AVAILABLE IN ANY MANNER. IN RELATION TO PRICE BAND, POTENTIAL INVESTORS SHOULD ONLY REFER TO THE PRE-OFFER AND PRICE BAND ADVERTISEMENT FOR THE OFFER AND SHOULD NOT RELY ON ANY MEDIA ARTICLES/ REPORTS IN RELATION TO THE VALUATION OF THE COMPANY AS THESE ARE NOT ENDORSED, PUBLISHED OR CONFIRMED EITHER BY THE COMPANY OR THE BOOK RUNNING LEAD MANAGERS TO THE OFFER ("BRLMs").

IN ACCORDANCE WITH THE RECOMMENDATION OF THE COMMITTEE OF INDEPENDENT DIRECTORS OF OUR COMPANY, PURSUANT TO THEIR RESOLUTION DATED OCTOBER 19, 2026, THE ABOVE PROVIDED PRICE BAND IS JUSTIFIED BASED ON QUANTITATIVE FACTORS/ KEY PERFORMANCE INDICATORS ("KPIS") DISCLOSED IN THE *"BASIS FOR OFFER PRICE"* SECTION BEGINNING FROM PAGE 183 OF THE RHP VIS-A-VIS THE WEIGHTED AVERAGE COST OF ACQUISITION ("WACA") OF PRIMARY AND SECONDARY TRANSACTION(S), AS APPLICABLE, AS DISCLOSED IN THE *"BASIS FOR OFFER PRICE"* SECTION BEGINNING FROM PAGE 183 OF THE RHP READ WITH THE ADDENDUM AND PROVIDED IN THE PRE-OFFER AND PRICE BAND ADVERTISEMENT.

Risk to Investors

For details, refer to section titled *"Risk Factors"* on page 28 of the Red Herring Prospectus dated October 19, 2026, read with Addendum.

1. **Risk in relation to dependency on technology:** Our revenues and operations are dependent upon technology. Failure of these technologies, failure to upgrade or innovate these technologies or failure to identify and develop new technologies could have an adverse impact on our results of operations. Our products may be displaced by newer technology and any inability or failure to adapt to technological developments, the evolving competitive landscape or industry trends could harm our business and competitiveness and consequently, could have an adverse impact on our results of operations.
2. **Risk of Sector concentration and dependency on Government projects:** We derive a substantial portion of our revenues from the WWT and SWT segments which together accounted for 88.22%, 84.98%, 84.34% and 87.40% of our consolidated revenue from operations in the three months period ended June 30, 2026, Fiscals 2026, 2025 and 2024, respectively. We are significantly dependent on projects, contracts or works awarded or funded by government entities, either directly or through our private customers. Our revenue from operations directly or indirectly attributable to government entities or government tenders represented 91.97%, 92.35%, 92.40% and 95.72% of our consolidated revenue from the WWT segment for the three months period ended June 30, 2026, Fiscals 2026, 2025 and 2024, respectively and 100.00% in the three months period ended June 30, 2026 and 100.00% of our consolidated revenue from SWT segment for each of the Fiscals 2026, 2025 and 2024. Any reduction or termination in such projects or adverse change in government policies could adversely affect our business, results of operations and financial condition.
3. **Customer concentration risk:** We derive a significant part of our revenue from our top 10 customers, and we do not have long term contracts with most of these customers. If one or more of such customers choose not to source their requirements from us or to terminate our long-term contracts, our business, results of operations and financial condition may be adversely affected. The following table sets out our revenue from our top 10 customers for the three months ended June 30, 2026, and for Fiscal 2026, Fiscal 2025 and Fiscal 2024 and percentage of revenue from operations for the respective periods:

Particulars	Three months ended June 30, 2026		Fiscal 2026		Fiscal 2025		Fiscal 2024	
	Revenue (in ₹ millions)	% of revenue from operations	Revenue (in ₹ millions)	% of revenue from operations	Revenue (in ₹ millions)	% of revenue from operations	Revenue (in ₹ millions)	% of revenue from operations
Top 10 customers	1,060.87	79.20%	5,178.44	64.44%	4,282.85	61.37%	3,891.10	59.18%

4. **Risk in relation to trade Sanctions:** We may be subject to trade restrictions, including economic sanctions and export controls, imposed by government(s) around the world or international organisations with jurisdiction over our operations, which prohibit or restrict transactions involving certain designated persons and certain designated countries or territories. Any failure to comply with trade restrictions such as economic sanctions and export controls or with anti-bribery and anti-corruption frameworks instituted by government authorities or international organizations, such as multilateral development banks, may restrict our ability to participate in projects, and could negatively impact our reputation and results of operations.
5. **Negative cash flows from operating activities:** We have experienced negative cash flows from operations in the recent past. Our consolidated cash flows for the three months period ended June 30, 2026 and June 30, 2025 and for the Fiscals 2026, 2025 and 2024 are set forth in the table below:

(in ₹ million)

Particulars	Three months ended		Financial Year		
	June 30, 2026	June 30, 2025	2026	2025	2024
Net cash generated / (used in) from operating activities	(213.42)	320.70	(258.02)	655.09	(116.94)
Net cash generated/ (used in) investing activities	(4.93)	(180.44)	(664.73)	708.27	(771.52)
Net cash generated/ (used in) from financing activities	13.96	(200.48)	924.68	(1,065.25)	721.37
Net increase / (decrease) in cash and cash equivalents	(204.39)	(60.21)	1.93	298.12	(167.08)

6. **Risk in relation to business growth and expansion:** Our business has grown, including our revenue from operations that has grown at a CAGR of 10.56% from ₹6,574.95 million in Fiscal 2024 to ₹8,036.29 million in Fiscal 2026, and we may fail to manage our growth effectively. Failure to effectively manage our expansion may lead to increased costs and reduced profitability and may adversely affect our growth prospects. Our inability to manage our business and implement our growth strategy could have a material adverse effect on our business, financial condition and profitability.
7. **Risk in relation to corporate records and filings:** Certain of our corporate records and filings are not traceable or have certain discrepancies. We cannot assure you that regulatory proceedings or actions will not be initiated against us in the future and we will not be subject to any penalty imposed by the competent regulatory authority in this regard.
8. **Risk in relation to outstanding litigations:** Our Company, Promoters, Directors, Subsidiaries and Key Managerial Personnel are currently involved in certain legal proceedings. These legal proceedings are pending at different levels of adjudication before various courts and tribunals or other governmental authorities. Further, our Subsidiaries, SFC Umwelttechnik GmbH, Hindustan Waste Treatment Private Limited and Vasudha Waste Treatment Private Limited have been, and continue to be, involved in material legal proceedings or have received show cause notices from statutory or regulatory authorities. Any adverse outcome in such proceedings may render us liable to liabilities/ penalties and may adversely affect our business, results of operations, financial condition and cash flows. For further details, please see *"Outstanding Litigation and Other Material Developments"* on page 553 of the RHP.
9. **Risks in relation to recall of unsecured loans:** Our Subsidiaries, Hindustan Waste Treatment Private Limited, Vasudha Waste Treatment Private Limited, Fine Aeration Systems Private Limited, Pentagen Biofuels Private Limited, Sustainyx Smart Solution Private Limited (formerly Navitas Waste Treatment Private Limited) and SFC Umwelttechnik GmbH have availed unsecured loans from our Company, aggregating to ₹1,724.87 million as on June 30, 2026 that are repayable on demand by our Company. Any such unexpected demand for repayment may have a material adverse effect on our business, cash flows and financial condition.
10. **High working capital requirement:** We have high working capital requirements, and may require additional financing to meet those requirements, which could have a material adverse effect on our results of operations, cash flows and financial condition. The working capital as a percentage of total revenue from operations was 561.06%, 65.19%, 63.51% and 39.94% for the three months period ended June 30, 2026 and Fiscals 2026, 2025 and 2024, respectively. Also, we have experienced an increase in our cash conversion cycle and may experience longer cash conversion cycles in the future. The table below provides our working capital details (on standalone basis):

Particulars	As of June 30, 2026#	As of March 31,		
		2026	2025	2024
Inventory (in ₹ million)	949.11	777.98	637.21	568.34
Trade Receivables (in ₹ million)	3,119.43	4,312.34	3,404.60	2,812.78
Trade Payables (in ₹ million)	447.78	1,128.78	660.81	973.39
Inventory days[(1)(4)]	239	106	106	78
Trade receivable days[(2)(4)]*	443	282	262	197
Trade payable days[(3)(4)]	113	153	109	134
Cash conversion cycle (in days)[(4)]	569	235	259	141

(1) Inventory days is calculated as inventory at the period end multiplied by 365 divided by Cost of Goods sold during the period.
(2) Trade receivables days is derived as trade receivables at the period end multiplied by 365 divided by revenue from operations.
(3) Trade payable days is derived as trade payable at the period end multiplied by 365 divided by Cost of Goods sold during the period.
(4) Three months period ended is annualised and calculated as 365/4.
** For trade receivables outstanding for more than six months, the Company undertakes periodic follow-ups, reconciliations, and internal escalations as part of its standard receivables management process.*
 # The higher number of days for the three-month period is primarily attributable to the seasonality and cyclicality of our business and the lower first-quarter revenue base, and may not be indicative of the underlying annual cash conversion cycle.

11. **Industry related risk:** The SWT industry is capital-intensive in nature. Our business model involves undertaking SWT projects which may require significant upfront capital expenditure, and which may lead to us relying on bank financing or project-based lending. Our ability to borrow and the terms of our borrowings will depend on our financial condition, the stability of our cash flows and our capacity to service debt in a rising interest rate environment.
12. **Risk in relation to materialisation of contingent liability:** We have certain contingent liabilities which, if materialized, may adversely affect our financial condition. As of June 30, 2026, our contingent liabilities amounted to ₹0.21 million.
13. **Risks in relation raw materials:** We depend on a few suppliers for the supply of majority of our raw materials and we do not have continuing and exclusive supply agreements with all of them. Any interruptions in the supply of raw materials, fluctuations in raw material prices or any failure by our suppliers to make timely delivery of raw materials could adversely affect our business, results of operations and financial conditions. The table below provides details in relation to our top one, top five and top 10 suppliers:

Supplier Concentration	Three months period ended June 30, 2026		Fiscal 2026		Fiscal 2025		Fiscal 2024	
	Purchase of stock in trade and raw material (in ₹ million)	% of stock in trade and raw material	Purchase of stock in trade and raw material (in ₹ million)	% of stock in trade and raw material	Purchase of stock in trade and raw material (in ₹ million)	% of stock in trade and raw material	Purchase of stock in trade and raw material (in ₹ million)	% of stock in trade and raw material
Top 1	138.58	20.41%	602.49	17.18%	312.81	10.34%	544.30	15.83%
Top 5	271.85	40.04%	1,434.37	40.89%	961.40	31.79%	1,667.77	48.52%
Top 10	369.86	54.48%	1,952.61	55.66%	1,442.76	47.71%	2,189.94	63.71%

14. **Health and Environmental Risk:** The assets we operate, and the handling and treatment of waste expose us to safety, operational and other risks, including the risk of personal injury to our employees or third parties. Failure to limit our exposure to such risks may subject us to significant disruptions in our business, legal and regulatory actions, costs, and liabilities and could have an adverse impact on our results of operations.
15. **Our Company will not receive any proceeds from the Offer for Sale portion of the Offer by our Selling Shareholders:** The Offer comprises of Fresh Issue and Offer for Sale. The Selling Shareholders shall be entitled to proceeds from the Offer for Sale.
16. The Price/ Earnings ratio based on diluted EPS for Fiscal 2026 for our Company at the upper end of the price band is as high as 19.98 as compared to the average industry peer group Price/ Earnings ratio of 101.38.
17. Lowest weighted average cost of acquisition of Equity Shares for the Selling Shareholders in the Offer is ₹36.72 and Offer Price at the upper end of the price band is ₹330.
18. The weighted average Return on Net Worth for our Company on a consolidated basis for Fiscal 2026, 2025 and 2024 is 23.82% and for three months period ended June 30, 2026 is 0.19% (not annualized).
19. The table below provides details of our EPS, NAV, price/ earnings, return on equity, return of capital employed, enterprise value/ operating EBITDA and market capitalization to revenue from operations for the Fiscal 2026 are as hereunder:

Name of Company	EPS (₹)		NAV (₹ per share)	P/E	RoE (%)	RoCE (%)	Enterprise Value/operating EBITDA	Market Capitalization to Revenue from operations
	Basic	Diluted						
SFC Environmental Technologies Limited	16.52	16.52	86.09	19.98x*	21.55	22.21	13.87x*	4.02x*
Listed Peers								
Thermax Limited	63.95	63.94	492.55	52.01x	13.70	15.00	39.75x	3.71x
Praj Industries Limited	1.30	1.30	71.22	220.77x	1.77	5.59	34.75x	1.67x
Ion Exchange (India) Limited	12.03	12.03	91.30	31.34x	11.20	14.30	26.11x	1.90x

** At the upper end of the Price Band*

Notes:
(i) All the financial information for listed industry peers mentioned above is on a consolidated basis (unless otherwise available only on standalone basis) and is sourced from the annual reports as available of the respective company for the relevant year ended March 31, 2026.
(ii) Net asset value per share = Net worth (excluding Non-Controlling Interest) / weighted average number of equity shares outstanding at the end of the year adjusted for the subdivision of the equity shares and issue of bonus shares, if any, in accordance with principles of Ind AS 33.
(iii) P/E Ratio has been computed based on the closing market price of equity shares on BSE on October 16, 2026, divided by the Diluted EPS for the Fiscal 2026.
(iv) ROE is calculated as total profit after tax for the period / year divided by average total equity.
(v) ROCE is calculated as a percentage of earnings before interest and taxes(EBIT) / total equity plus total borrowings plus deferred tax liabilities minus deferred tax assets as per the restated / audited consolidated financial information. EBIT is calculated as profit before tax and share of profit of joint ventures / associate plus finance costs.
(vi) Enterprise Value / Operating EBITDA has been computed as the Enterprise Value divided by the Operating EBITDA for the Fiscal 2026. Enterprise Value has been calculated as the market capitalization, computed based on the closing market price of equity shares on BSE on October 16, 2026, adjusted for net debt as of March 31, 2026.
(vii) Market Capitalization to Revenue from Operations has been computed as the market capitalization, computed based on the closing market price of equity shares on BSE on October 16, 2026, divided by the Revenue from Operations for the Fiscal 2026.

Continued on next page...

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20. The weighted average cost of acquisition ("**WACA**") of all Equity Shares transacted in last one year and three years immediately preceding the date of the Addendum are as hereunder:

Period	WACA per Equity Share (in ₹)^	Cap price (₹330) is 'X' times the WACA	Range of acquisition price per Equity Share: lowest price –highest price (in ₹)^
Last one year preceding the date of the Addendum	308.78	1.07	Nil - 343.00
Last three years preceding the date of the Addendum	37.82#	8.73	Nil# – 555.00#

^ As certified by M/s H H Dedhia & Associates, Chartered Accountants by way of their certificate dated October 23, 2026.

#Pursuant to a resolution of our Board passed in their meeting held on August 14, 2024 and a resolution of our Shareholders passed in their annual general meeting held on September 5, 2024, each fully paid-up equity share of our Company of face value ₹10 was subdivided into 5 Equity Shares of ₹2 each. The impact of the subdivision has been considered in the calculation weighted average cost of acquisition per Equity Share and range of acquisition price.

Note: The above has been computed based on the Equity Shares acquired/allotted/purchased (including acquisition pursuant to transfer and gifts) involving promoters / promoter group / selling shareholders / shareholders with special rights and other public shareholders (to the extent information available to our Company).

21. Weighted average cost of acquisition at which Equity Shares were acquired by our Promoters and the Selling Shareholders as on the date of the Addendum and in the one year preceding the date of the Addendum:

S. No.	Name	Number of Equity Shares held as on the date of the Addendum	WACA per Equity Share (in ₹)	Number of Equity Shares acquired in the last one year preceding the date of the last one year	WACA per Equity Share (in ₹) in the Addendum*
	Promoters				
1.	Sandeep Sudhakar Asolkar	13,500,000	0.44	Nil	Nil
2.	Sandeep Sudhakar Asolkar (held jointly with Priya Sandeep Asolkar)#	17,388,498	36.72	Nil	Nil
3.	Saketchandrasingh Pratapsingh Dhandoriya#	8,434,125	36.72	Nil	Nil
	Selling Shareholders (other than the Promoter Selling Shareholders)				
1.	Sarvesh Kumar Garg	5,527,215	36.72	Nil	Nil
2.	Sandeep Sambhaji Parab	4,592,715	36.72	Nil	Nil
3.	Rajesh Kesavan Nambisan	4,592,715	36.72	Nil	Nil
4.	Kumaraguru Madurakavi	4,592,715	36.72	Nil	Nil
5.	Veera Venkata Satyanarayana Yannamani	2,143,860	36.72	Nil	Nil
6.	Jayshree Harit Shah, jointly with Harit Pragji Shah	468,750	42.85	Nil	Nil
7.	Hardik Suresh Matalia	36,750	36.72	Nil	Nil

**As certified by M/s H H Dedhia & Associates, Chartered Accountants, pursuant to their certificate dated October 23, 2026. | #Also, a Promoter Selling Shareholder.*

Notes: Pursuant to a resolution of our Board passed in their meeting held on August 14, 2024 and a resolution of our Shareholders passed in their annual general meeting held on September 5, 2024, each fully paid - up equity share of our Company of face value ₹10 was subdivided into 5 Equity Shares of ₹2 each. The impact of the subdivision has been considered in the calculation of number of Equity Shares and in the average cost of acquisition / weighted average cost of acquisition price per Equity Share.

22. The three BRLMs associated with the Offer have handled 111 public issues in the past three years, out of which 35 issues closed below the offer price on listing date.

Name of the BRLMs	Total issues	Issues closed below IPO price on listing date
IIFL Capital Services Limited*	32	10
JM Financial Limited*	28	8
Nuvama Wealth Management Limited*	14	6
Common Issues of above BRLMs	37	11
Total	**111**	**35**

** Issues handled where there were no common BRLMs.*

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION FOR INVESTORS:

1. Our Company has not undertaken any pre-IPO placement.
2. Except as disclosed below, our Promoters or members of our Promoter Group have not undertaken any transaction of shares aggregating up to 1% or more of the paid-up equity share capital of the Company from the date of Draft Red Herring Prospectus till date:

S. No.	Nature of Transaction	Name of Transferor	Name of the Transferee	Nature of relationship with Company	Date of transfer	Whether transferee is connected, in any manner, with the Company, the Promoters, members of the Promoter Group, the Directors, the Key Managerial Personnel, the Subsidiaries, and Group Companies and their respective directors and key managerial personnel*	Number of Equity Shares of face value of ₹2 each transferred	Percentage of pre-Offer share capital of the Company (%)	Transfer Price per Sale Share (₹)	Total consideration (in ₹ million)
1.	Secondary transfer	Asolkar Tradecraft Private Limited	Abakkus Flexi Edge Fund - I	Promoter Group	October 22, 2026	No	623,637	0.67%	330.00	205.80
2.	Secondary transfer	Asolkar Tradecraft Private Limited	Abakkus Growth Fund - Open Ended	Promoter Group	October 22, 2026	No	740,000	0.79%	330.00	244.20
3.	Secondary transfer	Asolkar Tradecraft Private Limited	Carnelian Asset Management & Advisors Private Limited	Promoter Group	October 22, 2026	No	696,970	0.75%	330.00	230.00
Sub-total (A)							**2,060,607**	**2.21%**		**680.00**
1.	Secondary transfer	Sandeep Sudhakar Asolkar (held jointly with Priya Sandeep Asolkar)	Neo Prime Fund	Promoter	October 23, 2026	No	303,031	0.32%	330.00	100.00
2.	Secondary transfer	Sandeep Sudhakar Asolkar (held jointly with Priya Sandeep Asolkar)	Nabs Equity	Promoter	October 23, 2026	No	90,910	0.10%	330.00	30.00
3.	Secondary transfer	Sandeep Sudhakar Asolkar (held jointly with Priya Sandeep Asolkar)	IIFL Late-Stage Private Equity Fund	Promoter	October 23, 2026	No	303,031	0.32%	330.00	100.00
Sub-total (B)							**696,972**	**0.75%**		**230.00**
Total (A+B)							**2,757,579**	**2.95%**		**910.00**

** For the purpose of this confirmation, (i)'connected with' is deemed to mean that (a) there are common directorships or common key managerial personnel; and/or (b) there is more than 1% equity investment interest.*

BASIS FOR OFFER PRICE

The *"Basis for Offer Price"* on page 183 of the RHP has been updated as above and for the details of the price band. Please refer to the websites of the BRLMs: www.iiflcapital.com, www.jmfl.com and www.nuvama.com for the *"Basis for Offer Price"* updated with the above price band. You may scan the QR code for accessing the website of IIFL Capital Services Limited *(formerly known as IIFL Securities Limited)*.

AN INDICATIVE TIMETABLE IN RESPECT OF THE OFFER IS SET OUT BELOW:

Submission of Bids (other than Bids from Anchor Investors):

Bid / Offer Period (except the Bid / Offer Closing Date)	
Submission and Revision in Bids	Only between 10.00 a.m. and 5.00 p.m. (Indian Standard Time ("**IST**")
Bid / Offer Closing Date*	
Submission of Electronic Applications (Online ASBA through 3-in-1 accounts) – For Retail Individual Bidders	Only between 10.00 a.m. and up to 5.00 p.m. IST
Submission of Electronic Applications (Bank ASBA through Online channels like Internet Banking, Mobile Banking and Syndicate UPI ASBA applications where Bid Amount is up to ₹0.50 million)	Only between 10.00 a.m. and up to 4.00 p.m. IST
Submission of Electronic Applications (Syndicate Non-Retail, Non-Individual Applications)	Only between 10.00 a.m. and up to 3.00 p.m. IST
Submission of Physical Applications (Bank ASBA)	Only between 10.00 a.m. and up to 1.00 p.m. IST
Submission of Physical Applications (Syndicate Non-Retail, Non-Individual Applications of QIBs and NIIs where Bid Amount is more than ₹0.50 million)	Only between 10.00 a.m. and up to 12.00 p.m. IST
Modification / Revision / cancellation of Bids	
Upward Revision of Bids by QIBs and Non-Institutional Bidders categories#	Only between 10.00 a.m. and up to 4.00 p.m. IST on Bid / Issue Closing Date
Upward or downward Revision of Bids or cancellation of Bids by Retail Individual Bidders	Only between 10.00 a.m. and up to 5.00 p.m. IST

**UPI mandate end time and date shall be at 5.00 pm on Bid / Offer Closing Date.*

 # QIBs and Non-Institutional Bidders can neither revise their Bids downwards nor cancel / withdraw their Bids.

On the Bid / Offer Closing Date, the Bids shall be uploaded until:

(i) 4.00 p.m. IST in case of Bids by QIBs and Non-Institutional Bidders; and

(ii) until 5.00 p.m. IST or such extended time as permitted by the Stock Exchanges, in case of Bids by RIBs.

On Bid / Offer Closing Date, extension of time will be granted by the Stock Exchanges only for uploading Bids received by Retail Individual Bidders, after taking into account the total number of Bids received and as reported by the BRLMs to the Stock Exchanges.

Bid / Offer Programme:

Event	Indicative Date
Anchor Investor Bid / Offer period Opened and Closed on	Monday, October 26, 2026
Bid /Offer Opening Date	Tuesday, October 27, 2026
Bid / Offer Closing Date	Thursday, October 29, 2026
Finalisation of Basis of Allotment with the Designated Stock Exchange	On or about Friday, October 30, 2026
Initiation of refunds (if any, for Anchor Investors) / unblocking of funds from ASBA Account*	On or about Monday, November 2, 2026
Credit of Equity Shares to demat accounts of Allottees	On or about Monday, November 2, 2026
Commencement of trading of the Equity Shares on the Stock Exchanges	On or about Tuesday, November 3, 2026

** In case of (i) any delay in unblocking of amounts in the ASBA Accounts (including amounts blocked through the UPI Mechanism) exceeding two Working Days from the Bid / Offer Closing Date for cancelled / withdrawn / deleted ASBA Forms, the Bidder shall be compensated at a uniform rate of ₹100 per day or 15% per annum of the Bid Amount, whichever is higher from the date on which the request for cancellation / withdrawal / deletion is placed in the Stock Exchanges bidding platform until the date on which the amounts are unblocked (ii) any blocking of multiple amounts for the same ASBA Form (for amounts blocked through the UPI Mechanism), the Bidder shall be compensated at a uniform rate ₹100 per day or 15% per annum of the total cumulative blocked amount except the original application amount, whichever is higher from the date on which such multiple amounts were blocked till the date of actual unblock; (iii) any blocking of amounts more than the Bid Amount, the Bidder shall be compensated at a uniform rate of ₹100 per day or 15% per annum of the difference in amount, whichever is higher from the date on which such excess amounts were blocked till the date of actual unblock; (iv) any delay in unblocking of non-allotted / partially allotted Bids, exceeding two Working Days from the Bid / Offer Closing Date, the Bidder shall be compensated at a uniform rate of ₹100 per day or 15% per annum of the Bid Amount, whichever is higher for the entire duration of delay exceeding two Working Days from the Bid / Offer Closing Date by the SCSB responsible for causing such delay in unblocking. The BRLMs shall, in their sole discretion, identify and fix the liability on such intermediary or entity responsible for such delay in unblocking. The Bidder shall be compensated in the manner specified in the SEBI ICDR Master Circular in relation to the SEBI ICDR Regulations which for the avoidance of doubt, shall be deemed to be incorporated in the agreements entered into between our Company with the relevant intermediaries, to the extent applicable.*

The processing fees for applications made by UPI Bidders using the UPI Mechanism may be released to the remitter banks (SCSBs) only after such banks provide a written confirmation on compliance with the SEBI ICDR Master Circular and SEBI RTA Master Circular, each to the extent applicable and any subsequent circulars or notifications issued by SEBI in this regard.

ASBA* | Simple, Safe, Smart way of Application!!!

*Applications Supported by Blocked Amount ("**ASBA**") is a better way of applying to offers by simply blocking the fund in the bank account. For further details, check section on ASBA.

Mandatory in public issues. No cheque will be accepted.

UPI-Now available in ASBA for Retail Individual Investors and Non Institutional Investor applying in public issues where the application amount is up to ₹ 500,000, applying through Registered Brokers, Syndicate, CDPs & RTAs. Retail Individual Investors and Non-Institutional Investors also have the option to submit the application directly to the ASBA Bank (SCSBs) or to use the facility of linked online trading, demat and bank account. Investors are required to ensure that the bank account used for bidding is linked to their PAN. Bidders must ensure that their PAN is linked with Aadhaar and are in compliance with CBDT notification dated February 13, 2020 and press release dated June 25, 2021 read with press release dated September 17, 2021, CBDT Circular No. 3 of 2023 dated March 28, 2023, and any subsequent press release in this regard.

*ASBA has to be availed by all the investors except Anchor Investors. UPI may be availed by (i) Retail Individual Bidders in the Retail Portion; (ii) Individual investors with an application size of up to ₹ 500,000 in the Non-Institutional Portion. For details on the ASBA and UPI process, please refer to the details given in the Bid Cum Application Form and Abridged Prospectus and also please refer to the section "Offer Procedure" on page 594 of the RHP. The process is also available on the website of Association of Investment Bankers of India ("**AIBI**") and Stock Exchanges and in the General Information Document. The Bid Cum Application Form and the Abridged Prospectus can be downloaded from the websites of the Stock Exchanges and can be obtained from the list of banks that is displayed on the website of SEBI at www.sebi.gov.in/sebiweb/other/OtherAction.do?doRecognisedFpi=yes&intmId=35 and https://www.sebi.gov.in/sebiweb/other/OtherAction.do?doRecognisedFpi=yes &intmId=43, respectively as updated from time to time. For the list of UPI apps and banks live on IPO, please refer to the link: www.sebi.gov.in. UPI Bidders Bidding using the UPI Mechanism may apply through the SCSBs and mobile applications whose names appear on the website of SEBI, as updated from time to time. Axis Bank Limited and ICICI Bank Limited have been appointed as the Sponsor Banks for the Offer, in accordance with the requirements of SEBI circular dated November 1, 2018 as amended. For Offer related queries, please contact the BRLMs on their respective email IDs as mentioned below. For UPI related queries, investors can contact NPCI at the toll free number: 18001201740 and mail Id: ipo.upi@npci.org.in.*

THE EQUITY SHARES OF OUR COMPANY WILL GET LISTED ON THE MAIN BOARD PLATFORMS OF THE STOCK EXCHANGES.

In case of any revision in the Price Band, the Bid / Offer Period will be extended by at least three additional Working Days after such revision in the Price Band, subject to the Bid / Offer Period not exceeding 10 Working Days. In cases of force majeure, banking strike or similar unforeseen circumstances, our Company may, in consultation with the BRLMs, for reasons to be recorded in writing, extend the Bid / Offer Period for a minimum of one Working Day, subject to the Bid / Offer Period not exceeding 10 Working Days. Any revision in the Price Band and the revised Bid / Offer Period, if applicable, shall be widely disseminated by notification to the Stock Exchanges, by issuing a public notice and also by indicating the change on the respective websites of the BRLMs and at the terminals of the Syndicate Members and by intimation to Self-Certified Syndicate Banks ("**SCSBs**"), Designated Intermediaries and the Sponsor Bank(s), as applicable.

This Offer is being made through the Book Building Process, in terms of Rule 19(2)(b) of the SCRR read with Regulation 31 of the SEBI ICDR Regulations and in compliance with Regulation 6(1) of the SEBI ICDR Regulations wherein not more than 50% of the Offer shall be available for allocation on a proportionate basis to Qualified Institutional Buyers ("**QIBs**" and such portion, the "**QIB Portion**"), provided that our Company, in consultation with the BRLMs, may allocate up to 60% of the QIB Portion to Anchor Investors on a discretionary basis in accordance with the SEBI ICDR Regulations ("**Anchor Investor Portion**"). 40% of the Anchor Investor Portion shall be reserved as under: (i) 33.33% for the domestic Mutual Funds; and (ii) 6.67% for Life Insurance Companies and Pension Funds, subject to valid Bids being received from the domestic Mutual Funds, Life Insurance Companies and Pension Funds at or above the price at which allocation will be made to Anchor Investors ("**Anchor Investor Allocation Price**") in accordance with the SEBI ICDR Regulations. In the event of under-subscription or non-allocation in the Anchor Investor Portion, the balance Equity Shares shall be added to the QIB Portion (other than the Anchor Investor Portion) (the "**Net QIB Portion**"). Further, 5% of the Net QIB Portion shall be available for allocation on a proportionate basis to Mutual Funds only and the remainder of the Net QIB Portion shall be available for allocation on a proportionate basis to all QIB Bidders, including Mutual Funds, subject to valid Bids being received at or above the Offer Price. However, if the aggregate demand from the Mutual Funds is less than 5% of the Net QIB Portion, the balance Equity Shares available for allocation will be added to the remaining QIB Portion for proportionate allocation to QIBs. Further, not less than 15% of the Offer shall be available for allocation to Non-Institutional Bidders (out of which one-third of the portion available to Non-Institutional Bidders shall be reserved for Bidders with an application size of more than ₹0.20 million and up to ₹1.00 million, and two-third shall be reserved for Bidders with application size of more than ₹1.00 million, provided that the unsubscribed portion in either of the aforementioned sub-categories may be allocated to Bidders in the other sub-category) and not less than 35% of the Offer shall be available for allocation to Retail Individual Bidders in accordance with the SEBI ICDR Regulations, subject to valid Bids being received from them at or above the Offer Price. All Bidders, other than Anchor Investors, are required to participate in the Offer by mandatorily utilising the Application Supported by Blocked Amount ("**ASBA**") process by providing details of their respective ASBA Account (as defined hereinafter) and UPI ID in case of UPI Bidders (as defined hereinafter), as applicable, pursuant to which their corresponding Bid Amounts will be blocked by the Self Certified Syndicate Banks ("**SCSBs**") or by the Sponsor Bank(s) under the UPI Mechanism, as the case may be, to the extent of respective Bid Amounts. Anchor Investors are not permitted to participate in the Offer through the ASBA process. For further details, see *"Offer Procedure"* on page 594 of the RHP.

Bidders/Applicants should ensure that DP ID, PAN and the Client ID and UPI ID (for UPI Bidders bidding through UPI Mechanism) are correctly filled in the Bid cum Application Form. The DP ID, PAN, UPI ID and Client ID provided in the Bid cum Application Form should match with the DP ID, PAN, Client ID and UPI ID available (for UPI Bidders bidding through the UPI Mechanism) in the Depository database, otherwise, the Bid cum Application Form is liable to be rejected. Bidders/ Applicants should ensure that the beneficiary account provided in the Bid cum Application Form is active. Bidders/Applicants should note that on the basis of the PAN, DP ID, Client ID and UPI ID (for UPI Bidders bidding through the UPI mechanism) as provided in the Bid cum Application Form, the Bidder/Applicant may be deemed to have authorized the Depositories to provide to the Registrar to the Offer, any requested Demographic Details of the Bidder/Applicant as available on the records of the depositories. These Demographic Details may be used, among other things, for giving Allotment Advice or unblocking of ASBA Account or for other correspondence(s) related to the Offer. Bidders/Applicants are advised to update any changes to their Demographic Details as available in the records of the Depository Participant to ensure accuracy of records. Any delay resulting from failure to update the Demographic Details would be at the Bidders/Applicants' sole risk.

Investors must ensure that their PAN is linked with Aadhaar and are in compliance with the notification issued by Central Board of Direct Taxes notification dated February 13, 2020 and read with press releases dated June 25, 2021, September 17, 2021 and March 28, 2023 and any subsequent press releases in this regard.

Contents of the Memorandum of Association of our Company as regards its objects: For information on the main objects of our Company, please see "*History and Certain Corporate Matters - Main objects of our Company*" on page 342 of the RHP. The Memorandum of Association of our Company is a material document for inspection in relation to the Offer. For further details, see "*Material Contracts and Documents for Inspection*" on page 637 of the RHP.

Liability of the members of our Company: Limited by shares.

Amount of Share Capital of our Company and Capital Structure: As on the date of the RHP, the authorised share capital of our Company is ₹250,000,000 divided into 125,000,000 Equity Shares of face value of ₹2 each. The issued, subscribed and paid-up Equity share capital of our Company is ₹186,822,540 divided into 93,411,270 Equity Shares of face value of ₹2 each. For details of the capital structure of our Company, see "*Capital Structure*" beginning on page 127 of the RHP.

Names of the Initial Signatories to the Memorandum of Association of our Company and the number of Equity Shares subscribed by them: The initial signatories of the Memorandum of Association of the Company are as follows: Enviropro Water Tech Private Limited, Sandeep Sudhakar Asolkar, Aparna Vivek Kapoor, SFC Umwelttechnik GmbH and Gunnar Demoulin who subscribed to 450,000 Equity Shares of face value of ₹10 each. For details of the share capital history of our Company please see "*Capital Structure*" beginning on page 127 of the RHP.

Listing: The Equity Shares offered through the RHP are proposed to be listed on the Stock Exchanges. Our Company has received 'in-principle' approvals from BSE and NSE for the listing of the Equity Shares pursuant to letters dated November 6, 2025 and November 7, 2025, respectively. For the purposes of the Offer, NSE is the Designated Stock Exchange. A copy of the RHP has been filed with the RoC and a copy of the Prospectus shall be filed with the RoC in accordance with Sections 26(4) and 32 of the Companies Act, 2013. For details of the material contracts and documents available for inspection from the date of the RHP until the Bid / Offer Closing Date, see *"Material Contracts and Documents for Inspection"* on page 637 of the RHP.

Disclaimer Clause of Securities and Exchange Board of India ("SEBI"): SEBI only gives its observations on the draft offer documents and this does not constitute approval of either the Offer or the specified securities stated in the Offer Documents. The investors are advised to refer to page 568 of the RHP for the full text of the disclaimer clause of SEBI.

Disclaimer Clause of BSE: It is to be distinctly understood that the permission given by BSE should not in any way be deemed or construed that the RHP has been cleared or approved by BSE nor does it certify the correctness or completeness of any of the contents of the RHP. The investors are advised to refer to the page 571 of the RHP for the full text of the disclaimer clause of BSE.

Disclaimer Clause of NSE (the Designated Stock Exchange): It is to be distinctly understood that the permission given by NSE should not in any way be deemed or construed that the Offer Document has been cleared or approved by NSE nor does it certify the correctness or completeness of any of the contents of the Offer Document. The investors are advised to refer to page 571 of the RHP for the full text of the disclaimer clause of NSE.

General Risks: Investments in equity and equity-related securities involve a degree of risk and investors should not invest any funds in the Offer unless they can afford to take the risk of losing their entire investment. Investors are advised to read the risk factors carefully before taking an investment decision in the Offer. For taking an investment decision, investors must rely on their own examination of our Company and the Offer, including the risks involved. The Equity Shares in the Offer have not been recommended or approved by SEBI, nor does SEBI guarantee the accuracy or adequacy of the contents of the RHP. Specific attention of the investors is invited to *"Risk Factors"* on page 28 of the RHP.

BOOK RUNNING LEAD MANAGERS			REGISTRAR TO THE OFFER	COMPANY SECRETARY AND COMPLIANCE OFFICER
IIFL Capital Services Limited ***(formerly known as IIFL Securities Limited)*** 24th Floor, One Lodha Place, Senapati Bapat Marg, Lower Parel (W), Mumbai 400 013, Maharashtra, India **Telephone:** +91 22 4646 4728 **E-mail:** sfc.ipo@iiflcap.com **Investor Grievance E-mail:** ig.ib@iiflcap.com **Website:** www.iiflcapital.com **Contact Person:** Yogesh Malpani /Pawan Kumar Jain **SEBI Registration No.:** INM000010940	**JM Financial Limited** 7th Floor, Cnergy, Appasaheb Marathe Marg, Prabhadevi, Mumbai 400 025, Maharashtra, India **Telephone:** + 91 22 6630 3030 **E-mail:** sfc.ipo@jmfl.com **Investor Grievance E-mail:** grievance.ibd@jmfl.com **Website:** www.jmfl.com **Contact Person:** Prachee Dhuri **SEBI Registration No.:** INM000010361	**Nuvama Wealth Management Limited** 801 - 804, Wing A, Building No 3, Inspire BKC, G Block, Bandra Kurla Complex, Bandra East, Mumbai 400 051, Maharashtra, India **Telephone:** +91 22 4009 4400 **E-mail:** sfc.ipo@nuvama.com **Investor Grievance E-mail:** customerservice.mb@nuvama.com **Website:** www.nuvama.com; **Contact Person:** Pari Vaya **SEBI Registration No:** INM000013004	**MUFG Intime India Private Limited** ***(formerly Link Intime India Private Limited)*** C-101, Embassy 247, L.B.S. Marg, Vikhroli (West), Mumbai 400 083, Maharashtra, India **Telephone:** +91 8108114949 **E-mail:** sfcenvironmental.ipo@in.mpms.mufg.com **Investor Grievance E-mail:** sfcenvironmental.ipo@in.mpms.mufg.com **Website:** www.in.mpms.mufg.com **Contact Person:** Shanti Gopalkrishnan **SEBI Registration No:** INR000004058	**Shweta Deshpande** **SFC ENVIRONMENTAL TECHNOLOGIES LIMITED** 2201-2202, Rupa Renaissance, D-33, Turbhe MIDC Road TTC Industrial Area, MIDC Industrial Area Turbhe, Navi Mumbai 400 705 Maharashtra, India **Telephone:** +91 22 4482 2717 **Email:** compliance@sfcenv.com **Website:** www.sfcenvironment.com Bidders may contact the Company Secretary and Compliance Officer, the BRLMs or the Registrar to the Offer in case of any pre-Offer or post-Offer related grievances, such as non-receipt of letters of Allotment, non-credit of Allotted Equity Shares in the respective beneficiary account, non-receipt of refund orders or non-receipt of funds by electronic mode, etc. For all Offer-related queries and for redressal of complaints, investors may also write to the BRLMs.

AVAILABILITY OF THE RHP: Investors are advised to refer to the RHP read with the Addendum and the *"Risk Factors"* beginning on page 28 of the RHP before applying in the Offer. A copy of the RHP is available on the website of SEBI at www.sebi.gov.in and the websites of the Stock Exchanges, for BSE Limited at www.bseindia.com and for National Stock Exchange of India Limited at www.nseindia.com and is available on the websites of the BRLMs, IIFL Capital Services Limited *(formerly known as IIFL Securities Limited)* at www.iiflcapital.com; JM Financial Limited at www.jmfl.com and Nuvama Wealth Management Limited at www.nuvama.com and at the website of the Company, SFC Environmental Technologies Limited at www.sfcenvironment.com.

AVAILABILITY OF THE ABRIDGED PROSPECTUS: A copy of the Abridged Prospectus shall be available on the website of our Company, the BRLMs and the Registrar to the Offer at: www.sfcenvironment.com, www.iiflcapital.com, www.jmfl.com, www.nuvama.com and www.in.mpms.mufg.com, respectively.

AVAILABILITY OF BID CUM APPLICATION FORM: Bid cum Application Form can be obtained from the Registered Office of our Company, **SFC Environmental Technologies Limited**: Telephone: +91 22 6276 9939; **BRLMs:** IIFL Capital Services Limited *(formerly known as IIFL Securities Limited)*, Telephone: +91 22 4646 4728; JM Financial Limited, Telephone: + 91 22 6630 3030 and Nuvama Wealth Management Limited, Telephone: +91 22 4009 4400 and **Syndicate Members:** JM Financial Services Limited, Telephone: +91 22 6136 3400 and Nuvama Wealth Management Limited, Telephone: +91 22 4009 4400, Registered Brokers, SCSBs, Designated RTA Locations and Designated CDP Locations for participating in the Offer. Bid cum Application Forms will also be available on the websites of the Stock Exchanges at www.bseindia.com and www.nseindia.com and at all the Designated Branches of SCSBs, the list of which is available on the websites of the Stock Exchanges and SEBI.

SUB-SYNDICATE MEMBERS: 360 ONE WAM Limited, Almondz Global Securities Limited, Ambit Capital Limited, Anand Rathi Share & Stock Brokers Limited, ANS Pvt Limited, Asit C Mehta, Asit C Mehta Financial Services Limited, Axis Capital Limited, Bajaj Financial Securities Limited, Centrum Capital Advisors Limited, DB(International) Stock Brokers Ltd., Equiras Securities Pvt Ltd., Eurekha Stock & Share Broking Services Limited, Finwizard Technology Pvt. Ltd., Globe Capital Market Limited, HDFC Securities Limited, ICICI Securities Limited, IDBI Capital Market Services Limited, India Infoline Limited, Jhaveri Securities, Jobanputra Fiscal Services Pvt Ltd., Keynote Capital Limited, Keynote Capitals Limited, KJMC Capital Market Services Limited, Kotak Securities Limited, LKP Securities Limited, Motilal Oswal Financial Services Limited, Pantomath Financial Services Limited, Prabhudas Lilladher Private Limited, Pravin Ratilal Share & Stock Brokers Limited, Pravin Ratilal Share and Stock Brokers Limited, Religare Securities Limited, Religare Securities Ltd., RR Equity Brokers Private Limited, SBICAP Securities Limited, Sharekhan Limited, SMC Global Securities Limited, Standard Chartered Securities, Tradebulls Securities Private Limited, Trust Securities Limited and YES Securities (India) Limited.

APPLICATIONS SUPPORTED BY BLOCKED AMOUNT (ASBA): Investors have to apply through the ASBA process. ASBA has to be availed by all the investors. For details on ASBA process, please refer to the details given in the ASBA Form and Abridged Prospectus and also please refer to *"Offer Procedure"* on page 594 of the RHP. Further ASBA Application forms can be obtained from Designated Branches of SCSBs, the list of banks that are available on website of SEBI at www.sebi.gov.in and website of Stock Exchanges at www.nseindia.com and www.bseindia.com. The investors are required to fill the Bid Cum Application form and submit the same to the relevant SCSBs at the specific locations or registered brokers at the broker centers or RTA or DP's. The SCSB's will block the amount in the account as per the authority contained in application form. On allotment, amount will be unblocked and account will be debited only to the extent required to be paid for allotment of shares. Hence, there will be no need of refund.

ESCROW COLLECTION BANK (s): ICICI Bank Limited.

PUBLIC OFFER ACCOUNT BANK AND REFUND BANK: Axis Bank Limited.

SPONSOR BANK(s): Axis Bank Limited and ICICI Bank Limited.

UPI: UPI Bidders can also Bid through UPI Mechanism.

All capitalised terms used herein and not specifically defined shall have the same meaning as ascribed to them in the RHP.

For **SFC ENVIRONMENTAL TECHNOLOGIES LIMITED**
On behalf of the Board of Directors
Sd/-
Shweta Deshpande
Company Secretary and Compliance Officer

Place: Navi Mumbai, Thane, Maharashtra
Date: October 26, 2026

SFC ENVIRONMENTAL TECHNOLOGIES LIMITED is proposing, subject to receipt of requisite approvals, market conditions and other considerations, to make an initial public offer of its Equity Shares and has filed a RHP dated October 19, 2026 with the RoC and thereafter with SEBI and the Stock Exchanges. The RHP along with Addendum is made available on the website of the SEBI at www.sebi.gov.in as well as on the website of the BRLMs i.e., IIFL Capital Services Limited *(formerly known as IIFL Securities Limited)* at www.iiflcapital.com; JM Financial Limited at www.jmfl.com and Nuvama Wealth Management Limited at www.nuvama.com, the website of the BSE at www.bseindia.com and the website of the NSE at www.nseindia.com and the website of the Company at www.sfcenvironment.com. Any potential investor should note that investment in equity shares involves a high degree of risk and for details relating to such risks, please see the section *"Risk Factors"* beginning on page 28 of the RHP. Potential investors should not rely on the DRHP for making any investment decision and must rely on their own examination of our Company and the Offer.

The Equity Shares offered in the Offer have not been and will not be registered under the United States Securities Act of 1933, as amended (the "**U.S. Securities Act**"), or any state securities laws in the United States, and unless so registered, may not be offered or sold within the United States, except pursuant to an exemption from, or in a transaction not subject to, the registration requirements of the U.S. Securities Act and in accordance with any applicable U.S. state securities laws. Accordingly, the Equity Shares are being offered and sold outside of the United States in 'offshore transactions' as defined in and in reliance on Regulation S under the U.S. Securities Act and the applicable laws of the jurisdiction where such offers and sales are made.

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TUESDAY, 27 OCTOBER 2026

US investment research firm Morningstar says investors may not be estimating the risk of growing concentration in AI stocks: ▶ P 9

▶ Rupee Slips Below 95 Again on Oil, Dollar Pressure as Jio IPO Bounce Fades ▶ D-St Sparks to Life After Days of Losses, but can't Douse Worries: P 9

Deciding whether to go
home for Diwali.

Easy

Deciding how to fit Diwali gifts
for all 48 relatives into one suitcase.

Hard

We've got **one** covered.
For the other, we wish you the very best. :)

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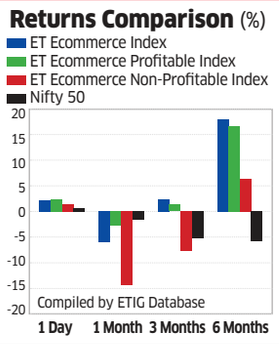
ET Ecommerce Tracker

Returns Comparison (%)



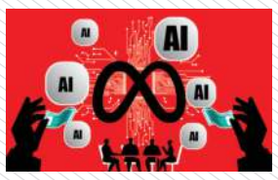
Tweet OF THE DAY

TYLER
@REZOUNDOUS

very soon, AI will refer to us humans as bottlenecks

Tech Buzz

Meta Eyes $95b Stock Offering to Bankroll AI



WASHINGTON: Meta is seeking to raise as much as $95 billion from selling common and preferred stock, tapping investors for support in the race to lead AI development. The firm is offering about $35 billion of common and preferred stock, according to a statement on Monday. It also plans to raise as much as about $60 billion in an at-the-market share sale programme, which allows companies to sell shares in the open market from time to time. The ATM will consist of its planned Class-C non-voting shares. Nvidia, Advanced Micro Devices and Broadcom have agreed to buy as much as $5 billion of the common shares in aggregate, the statement shows. Meta intends to use the proceeds to support its investment in AI infrastructure and personal superintelligence. Meta's shares pared initial losses, climbing 1.6% to $654 each in premarket trading on Monday. – Reuters

95.4%
Projected AI usage in India by 2030, up from current 22%, outpacing the global average of 30% – Agencies

Unconventional AI Buys Chip Co NeuReality

SAN FRANCISCO: Unconventional AI, the US hardware startup with a $4.5 billion valuation, said on Monday that it is buying Israeli chip startup NeuReality for an undisclosed sum in a cash-and-stock deal. Unconventional AI is led by Naveen Rao, who previously sold chip startup Nervana to Intel for more than $400 million and AI software startup MosaicML to Databricks for $1.3 billion. Unconventional AI's goal is to develop AI chips that are 1,000 times more energy efficient than current offerings by using concepts from biological systems. It is focusing on what Rao calls a "dynamical systems" approach, in which simple computing elements interact with simple rules and evolve over time to reach a result, rather than following programmed step-by-step logic as conventional computing chips do. – Reuters

Black October Govts and security experts scramble to save the web from AI

Clock's Ticking for Data Protection, But the Boardroom Remains Empty

RTI reveals zero spends on salaries, office setup or gear despite a ₹10cr budget allocation

Suraksha P

Bengaluru: The Data Protection Board of India (DPBI) appears to have made little progress towards becoming a functional adjudicatory body, with less than three weeks left before the privacy watchdog is required to begin its first statutory task.

Under the Digital Personal Data Protection (DPDP) Rules, 2025, the framework for registering consent managers with the DPBI is scheduled to start on November 13. But a government response to a Right to Information (RTI) application shows that the board spent not a single rupee on salaries, office expenses, rent or information and communication technology equipment as of September 30 this year.

The Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY) issued the response to an application filed by a final-year law student at Guru Gobind Singh Indraprastha University in Delhi. The student, Manya Arora, sought information on the constitution, staffing, budget and functioning of the DPBI.

On the Money

₹5 crore DPBI's 2025-26 budget estimates

₹2 crore Revised allocation for 2025-26

₹31,000 Actual expenditure in 2025-26

₹10 cr Allocation for 2026-27

Zero Revised outlay for furniture; no spending recorded

The board is to have a chairman and four other members. No appointments have yet been publicly announced. MeitY did not respond to ET's queries.

Under the DPDP Act, 2023, the board is empowered to adjudicate cases of personal data breaches and impose penalties up to Rs 250 crore. The provisions relating to the establishment and composition of the board came into effect on November 13 last year. Under the phased implementation of the regulations, the board's wider powers, including inquiring into complaints and imposing penalties, will come into force only on May 13, 2027.

Consent managers are intended to help individuals manage, review and withdraw consent for the processing of their personal data, and are required to be registered with the board.

MeitY issued a circular on May 6 this year inviting applications to fill the posts on the board, and a recruitment advertisement was published on June 6. In a written reply in the Lok Sabha on August 12, the government confirmed the advertisement, but did not report any appointments.

The RTI response does not, by itself, establish that the DPBI has not been legally constituted. But the absence of expenditure indicates that the institution may not yet be functional on the ground.

"The absence of a functional DPBI creates a vacuum which may stall the timely registration of consent managers which form the next phase of the implementation (of the DPDP Act)," said Ranjana Adhikari, partner, Shardul Amarchand Mangaldas & Co.

If this continues to be the case on November 13, with no operational authority to manage registrations or enforce accountability, it may have a cascading impact on the timelines for the next phase, she said.

FOR FULL REPORT, GO TO
www.economictimes.com

CERT-In & States Rush to Patch PHP Flaws Across Govt Portals

Banking, health portals top priority as officials move fast to safeguard citizen data caches

Subhayan Chakraborty

New Delhi: India's nodal cybersecurity agency is coordinating with state-level cybersecurity authorities to quickly implement necessary patches to protect thousands of government websites from critical vulnerabilities in the programming language PHP, officials told ET.

The Indian Computer Emergency Response Team (CERT-In) has discussed the issue in meetings held with state information technology departments, and assured help, they added.

"Meetings have been held with state computer security incident response teams (CSIRT) and IT departments. Critical areas such as health- and banking-related websites storing large caches of citizen's personal information have been prioritised for patching," an official said.

Last week, two critical cybersecurity flaws in the PHP programming language were discovered with the help of artificial intelligence. Subsequently, CERT-In advised organisations to apply security patches. Thousands of state government portals, district administration websites, municipal corporation services and public grievance redressal systems in India have historically relied on content management systems and frameworks based on the PHP programming language. The National Portal of India links and provides access to more than 6,700 government websites. Meetings are also being held with sectoral CSIRTs supporting domains such as finance, power and telecom, officials said.

Officials from the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology last week said major digital public infrastructure (DPI) stack websites operating at the national level were not built on PHP. "Their operations have not been disrupted so far. We are keeping a close watch. Some patching actions, wherever needed, are being undertaken," an official said.

These DPI stack websites include the Aadhaar portal run by the Unique Identification Authority of India, the finance ministry's Goods and Services Tax Network (GSTN) website, the Unified Payments Interface (UPI) system run by the National Payments Corporation of India and the corporate affairs ministry's MCA21 portal handling company registration, the official added. These rely on Java enterprise frameworks, or Java-based open stacks, .NET or distinct enterprise stacks such as Microsoft.

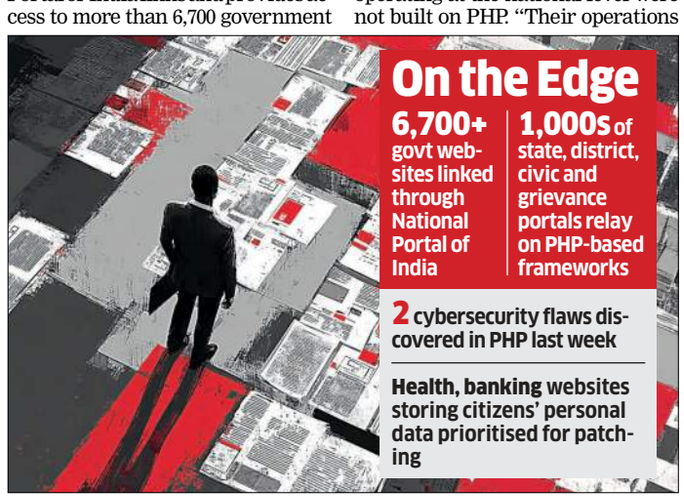
On the Edge

6,700+ govt websites linked through National Portal of India

1,000s of state, district, civic and grievance portals relay on PHP-based frameworks

2 cybersecurity flaws discovered in PHP last week

Health, banking websites storing citizens' personal data prioritised for patching



A SPOT OF BOTHER

Older PHP versions– 5 & 7 – used by banks, telecoms, and power firms have no fix and is a bigger problem for India

Pronto's Sardana Opens US-based Physical AI Firm Provision Labs

Pranav Mukul

New Delhi: Pronto founder Anjali Sardana has launched a physical artificial intelligence (AI) startup, Provision Labs, in San Francisco, according to people familiar with the development.

The US venture will focus on collecting data to train and test AI systems designed to perform real-world tasks using robots and other machines, one of the persons said, adding that it will handle AI initiatives of Bengaluru-based Pronto, an on -demand home services company. Provision Labs will work with developers building AI models for robotics and other real-world applications. Sardana will serve as the chief executive of both Pronto and Provision Labs, the people said.

Provision Labs will work with developers building AI models for robotics and other real-world applications

"Provision Labs has been set up in the US to access AI talent there… in the same manner that several Indian AI and deep-tech companies are putting up outposts in Silicon Valley to hire talent," said one of the persons, who did not wish to be identified. ET was the first to report on the development in its online edition on Monday.

The new venture follows Pronto's launch of Verified, a premium booking service that allows customers to opt for household jobs to be recorded using head-mounted cameras worn by service professionals.

Sahamati Defers Rate Card Rollout to Dec 1

Industry body gives banks, fintechs more time to transition to standardised pricing

Nikhil Patwardhan & Ayanti Bera

Bengaluru: Sahamati, an industry body for the non-banking financial company-account aggregator (NBFC-AA) ecosystem, has deferred the introduction of its new account aggregator fee model by a month to December 1.

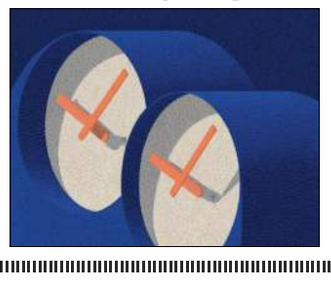
In a circular dated October 26, it said that the decision was taken "keeping in mind the upcoming festive season and requests for postponement". Implementation and operational details will be communicated through subsequent circulars, it added in the circular, a copy of which was seen by ET.

Sahamati declined to comment.

Industry participants had flagged that implementing the changes involved legal reviews and agreements between multiple institutions and systems to collect and distribute payments. Holiday schedules had reduced the time available for completing these steps, executives at companies using the network said.

STANDARD RATES SOON

New fee model sets standard rates for basic record sharing, based on statement length and monthly usage



Urban Co Taps Morgan Stanley for ₹2.5kcr QIP

Pranav Mukul

New Delhi: Home services platform Urban Company has appointed Morgan Stanley to manage its ₹2,500 crore qualified institutional placement and begun roadshows for the fundraising, meeting potential investors, according to people familiar with the matter.

A significant portion of the proceeds is expected to go towards InstaHelp, its instant house help business, which has been incurring heavy losses as the company invests in expanding the segment, one of the persons said. However, brokerages have assigned little to no value to the business, citing concerns over sustained losses and the challenge of achieving profitability targets. In an investor presentation earlier this month, Urban Company said InstaHelp was driving customer frequency and attracting new users to the platform. The firm said absolute losses in the segment would remain elevated over the next few quarters as it invests to consolidate its market leadership.

Microsoft Offers Exit Packages to India Staff Amid Massive AI Push

Firm to let those at level 70 and below leave with financial support

Tanya Pandey

New Delhi: Microsoft has introduced a time-bound voluntary exit offer (VEO) for eligible employees in India, the US, the UK, and Canada, allowing those at level 70 and below in its internal job hierarchy, equivalent to general manager and vice-president levels and below, to leave with financial support and career planning resources.

While the company has not given specifics of the number of people who shall be covered through this programme, there are around 60,000 employees eligible globally. The decision will be taken by December 1, 2026 and those opting for it will be given a package similar to a standard severance offer, including one month of base salary for every completed year of service, health insurance and career transition services. The offer was announced in an internal communication by Amy Coleman, Microsoft's executive vice-president and chief people officer. "This offer gives eligible employees who may be considering a future outside the company a new choice to make that transition now with support," she said.

The company has about 23,000 employees in India. However, the number of employees eligible for the offer in India remains uncertain.

"Microsoft continues to invest in India's talent and technology ecosystem and is backing the country's AI ambitions with $20.5 billion in committed investment between 2025 and 2029 across cloud and AI infrastructure, skilling and operations," a Microsoft spokesperson said.

NumbersWatch Quarter in focus

Paytm Q2 Net Profit Up 10x to ₹225crore, Revenue Climbs 28%

Reports ops revenue of ₹2,648cr; expects contribution margins to moderate in Q3

Our Bureau

New Delhi: One 97 Communications, which operates digital payments platform Paytm, reported a 28% year-on-year increase in operating revenue to ₹2,648 crore for the July-September quarter. Net profit jumped tenfold to ₹225 crore, as operating leverage kicked in.

Revenue growth was in line with brokerage estimates, but net profit fell short of expectations. Brokerages had projected operating revenue of ₹2,575-2,641 crore, up 25-28% year-on-year, and net profit of ₹271-279 crore for the second quarter of FY27. Paytm shares ended 2.7% higher at ₹1,655 on the BSE on Monday. The results were announced after market hours.

On an operating basis, Paytm's earnings before interest, taxes, depreciation and amortisation (Ebitda) rose 90% year-on-year to ₹270 crore.

In an earnings release, the company said its investments in artificial intelligence were driving structural operating leverage, with revenue and contribution profit growing faster than indirect expenses.

Contribution profit, which is revenue minus direct costs such as payment processing charges, cashbacks, discounts and collection costs, rose 23% to ₹1,479 crore during the quarter. Indirect expenses, including marketing, employee costs, and cloud and software expenses, increased 14% to ₹1,209 crore.

For the October-December quarter, however, Paytm expects its contribution margin to decline from the 56% reported in the second quarter of FY27.

"In Q3FY27, we expect contribution margin to decline, given a materially higher DLG (default loss guarantee) cost and various seasonal effects (for example, higher share of card processing in festive seasons), however we expect Ebitda to continue to improve," the company said.

Paytm also expects the proposed merchant discount rate (MDR) on select UPI transactions to improve its payments processing margins.

The company estimates that the proposed 0.4% MDR on transactions above ₹2,000 at select non-industry merchants could lift its overall payments processing margin (PPM) by around 2.5 basis points, based on its current gross merchandise value (GMV) mix.

PPM, which measures MDR revenue earned on payments GMV after deducting processing charges, has been expanding structurally and is currently above 4 basis points, Paytm said.

AI PLAY PAYS OFF

AI investments were driving ops leverage, with revenue & contribution profit growing faster than indirect costs: Paytm

The company expects the impact of the proposed MDR framework to stabilise within two to three quarters of implementation. On October 13, the National Payments Corporation of India (NPCI) said the implementation of MDR on UPI transactions would be delayed until after Diwali, from the originally scheduled date of October 15.

Ather Energy Rides into the Black in Q2

Electric 2-wheeler maker's ops revenue rises 63% YoY to ₹1,464 cr in second qtr

Our Bureau

Bengaluru: Electric two-wheeler maker Ather Energy has reported its first quarterly net profit, as strong sales growth and improved margins helped the company's overall performance. It has also flagged near-term cost pressures from rising input prices.

Net profit for the September quarter stood at ₹1.26 crore, the Bengaluru-based company said on Monday. It had reported a loss of ₹154.07 crore a year earlier. Revenue from operations rose 63% year-on-year to ₹1,464.24 crore compared with ₹898.88 crore in the year-ago quarter.

Ather's profit comes nearly 17 months after it listed on the stock exchanges, in May 2025. On Monday, its shares closed at ₹1,574, up nearly fivefold from the listing price, after rising 13.7% during the session.

The turnaround comes as Ather sees a sharp increase in demand for its electric scooters and looks to ramp up production capacity to meet customer demand.

"We are not out of the woods. There is a lot of work for us to deliver on. The focus is on the top line. Improving volume will itself take care of operating leverage, if all the capacity work we are putting in bears fruit over the next few months. In the near term it can go up and down, but it is definitely worth celebrating this milestone for the business," Tarun Mehta, CEO of Ather Energy, said during the company's earnings call.

Smooth Ride

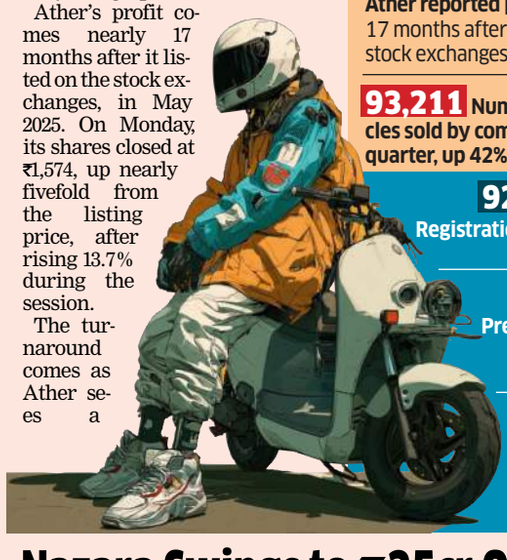
Ather reported profit around 17 months after listing on the stock exchanges in May 2025

93,211 Number of vehicles sold by company in the quarter, up 42% YoY

92,589 units Registrations grew 60% YoY

1.8 lakh Pre-orders more than doubled YoY

Ather's market share, stood at 15.1% in Q2 FY27



Nazara Swings to ₹35cr Q2 PAT

Our Bureau

Bengaluru: In a broad management reshuffle, Nazara Technologies founder Nitish Mittersain has stepped down as managing director and transitioned to the role of non-executive director, effective Monday, the gaming company said in a regulatory filing.

The company named Mithun Sacheti, cofounder of jewellery retailer CaratLane who became a co-promoter of Nazara last year, an executive director. Sacheti will oversee strategic initiatives and operational responsibilities assigned by the board, the filing said. The changes come about a month after Mittersain stepped down as chief executive officer, appointing Raymond A Stauffer as CEO in his place. Stauffer is the founder and a former chief executive of Spain-based gaming studio Bluetile Games and its in-house engagement platform BestPlay Systems, which Nazara acquired earlier this year in its largest acquisition to date.

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UNAUDITED FINANCIAL RESULTS FOR THE QUARTER ENDED 30.09.2026

SCAN FOR RESULTS

BUSINESS MIX ₹7,53,078 Cr | OPERATING PROFIT ₹3,016 Cr | GROSS NPA 1.19% | PCR 97.69%

GROSS ADVANCES ₹3,45,650 Cr | NET PROFIT ₹1,912 Cr | NET NPA 0.16% | RoA 1.53%

Q-o-Q

(Rs. in Lakhs)

S No	Particulars	Standalone			Consolidated		
		Quarter Ended 30.09.2026 (Unaudited)	Quarter Ended 30.09.2025 (Unaudited)	Year Ended 31.03.2026 (Audited)	Quarter Ended 30.09.2026 (Unaudited)	Quarter Ended 30.09.2025 (Unaudited)	Year Ended 31.03.2026 (Audited)
		Not Applicable					

Outstanding Redeemable Preference Shares, Capital Redemption Reserve, Debenture Redemption Reserve, Debt Service Coverage Ratio, Interest Service Coverage Ratio are not applicable for the Bank.

NOTES:

1. The above is an extract of the detailed format of Quarterly Financial Results filed with the Stock Exchanges under Regulation 33 and 52 of the SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015. The full format of the Quarterly Financial Results are available on the Stock Exchange websites (BSE: www.bseindia.com and NSE: www.nseindia.com) and Bank website(www.iob.bank.in).
2. For the other line items referred in regulation 52(4) of the Listing Regulations, pertinent disclosures have been made to the Stock Exchanges (BSE Ltd and National Stock Exchange of India Ltd) and can be accessed on the URL (BSE: www.bseindia.com and NSE: www.nseindia.com)

Date : 26.10.2026 | **Dhanaraj T** Executive Director | **Joydeep Dutta Roy** Executive Director | **Ajay Kumar Srivastava** Managing Director & CEO | **Srinivasan Sridhar** Non-Executive Chairman

Place : Chennai

Total Global Business Crosses ₹ 7 Lac Crores

Home Loan @ **7.25**% p.a. | **Car Loan** @ **7.70**% p.a.

No charges till 31/12/2026

*T&C Apply

Business	Advances	Retail	Vehicle Loan	Deposits	CASA
25.16%	29.61%	20.91%	54.10%	21.50%	46.47%

UNAUDITED FINANCIAL RESULTS FOR THE QUARTER ENDED SEPTEMBER 30, 2026 (₹ In Crore)

RoA 2.02% | NIM Domestic 3.97% | Cost to Income 33.73% | Gross NPA 1.25% | Net NPA 0.12% | PCR 98.53%

Particulars	Quarter Ended 30/09/2026 (Unaudited)	Quarter Ended 30/09/2025 (Unaudited)	Year Ended 31/03/2026 (Audited)
Total Income from Operations (Net)	9735.41	7973.61	32822.53
Net Profit / (Loss) for the period (before Tax, Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items)	2714.22	1818.38	7857.37
Net Profit / (Loss) for the period before Tax (after Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items)	2714.22	1818.38	7857.37
Net Profit / (Loss) for the period after Tax (after Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items)	2309.59	1633.14	7019.32
Paid up Equity Share Capital	7691.56	7691.56	7691.56
Reserves (excluding Revaluation Reserve) - as on date	27915.40	22073.61	23597.18
Securities Premium Account	3867.25	3867.25	3867.25
Net Worth	34240.21	28933.85	30272.42
Paid up Debt Capital / Outstanding Debt %*	11.50	24.10	17.05
Debt** Equity Ratio	0.86	0.60	0.70
Earnings Per Share (of ₹ 10/- each) (for continuing and discontinued operations) - not Annualized	3.00	2.12	9.13
Capital Redemption Reserve	----	----	----

*Total Debts & Outstanding Debt represents total borrowings of the Bank.
**Debt represents borrowings with residual maturity of more than one year.

Note: The above is an extract of the detailed format of Quarterly Financial Results filed with the Stock Exchanges under Regulation 33 and 52 read with regulation 63(2) of the SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015 as amended. The full format of the Quarterly Financial Results are available on the Stock Exchange websites **(BSE: www.bseindia.com and NSE: www.nseindia.com)** and Bank's website **(www.bankofmaharashtra.bank.in)**

Scan for Results

Place: Pune
Date : 26/10/2026

Sushanta Kumar Mohanty Executive Director | **Prabhat Kiran** Executive Director | **Nidhu Saxena** Managing Director & CEO

Bank of Maharashtra

BOLSONARO REFUSES TO ACCEPT DEFEAT

Lula Retains Brazil Crown, Wins Historic Fourth Term

Opposition wants result to be annulled as a Lula-appointed Supreme Court justice extended voting by 2 hours

Brazilian right-wing Senator Flavio Bolsonaro has followed his imprisoned father's lead by refusing to concede defeat to leftist President Luiz Inacio Lula da Silva, who won a historic fourth term in Sunday's presidential election.

Bolsonaro, the son of former President Jair Bolsonaro, called into question a late-Sunday decision by a Lula-appointed Supreme Court justice that extended voting by two hours over alleged voter transport irregularities. He said he would ask for the result to be annulled. "It is impossible to recognize the election results, given the circumstances under which things unfolded," Bolsonaro told journalists.

While the lawmaker moved to contest the result, world leaders rapidly rallied behind Lula's victory, with congratulations pouring in from the EU, Mexico, France, Canada, India and Russia. The Trump administration remained silent, however.

Investors reacted nervously, sending Brazilian assets sharply lower as markets reassessed the country's fiscal outlook under Lula.

The scale of Bolsonaro's loss, with the senator trailing Lula by over 4 million votes, makes it unlikely his efforts to annul the vote will succeed, analysts said. His petition is also undermined by the fact that his campaign also sought a voting extension due to heavy rains in the conservative-leaning south.

Still, Bolsonaro's refusal to concede could spark a wave of protests in a country where faith in the electoral system, and in judicial independence, has been strained in recent years, observers say. Bolsonaro plunged Brazil into a deep democratic crisis after the election in 2022, when his supporters stormed government buildings in protest against the result. He later received a 27-year sentence for plotting a coup.

DEFYING EXPECTATIONS

Lula's victory defied polls, precedent and global anti-incumbent sentiment to put the brakes on a wave of right-wing election victories across Latin America. He trailed Bolsonaro in the first round, but managed to convince voters to come out for him in the runoff. Financial markets expressed initial concerns at the shock result, as investors reversed positions largely built around expectations of a Bolsonaro victory. **Reuters**

Serbia's Student Movement Ousts Longtime Leader in Polls

Serbia's student-led movement declared victory in parliamentary elections Sunday ending 14 years in power for Aleksandar Vucic's right-wing populist party. The victory in the snap vote comes after nearly two years of anti-government protests sparked by the 2024 collapse of a canopy at Novi Sad railway station that killed 16 people. The disaster has been widely blamed on corruption and triggered some of Serbia's largest protests since the fall of Milosevic in 2000. Voters cast ballots in huge numbers on Sunday, with the country recording its highest parliamentary election turnout in more than three decades. Vucic conceded defeat less than two hours after polls closed. **AFP**

US Politicians Woo Chatbots That Hold Sway Over Voters

US political candidates have been engineering their campaign messages to appeal to the AI chatbots that more voters have been using to answer questions about issues, and documents seen have revealed some of their strategies.

One Powerpoint presentation proposed a strategy for Mike Minogue, Republican challenger to Massachusetts Governor Maura Healey. It aimed to convince ChatGPT, Claude, Gemini and other chatbots to present him as the preferred choice on key issues, and went well beyond traditional search-engine optimization that candidates have used for years. As AI increasingly becomes a source of news, political campaigns must make greater efforts to control its output and become its recommendation when voters ask questions such as who is best on issues like taxes, housing and public safety. Some experts worry about fact-checking and misinformation in AI campaigns.

Fees can range from hundreds of dollars a month for small AI monitoring jobs to tens of thousands per month if consulting and buying media are included. The presentation proposed that Minogue's campaign should create hundreds of AI-friendly policy pages and citations across the websites frequently cited by AI chatbots. It proposed ways to track how major chatbots respond to political questions, and systematically alter content until the answers reflect the candidate's platform.

At the center of the pitch was the idea that besides persuading voters directly, campaigns can shape the information environment by feeding the internet, and AI assistants, data that influences how candidates are described, compared and recommended.

"Campaigns using AI-influence training are now a reality that we face and it will be ubiquitous by the 2028 cycle," which will include a presidential election, said Joe Bonilla, managing partner of Relentless Awareness. The New York-based creative strategy firm has worked with companies and political candidates at the federal, state, and local levels.

"The public increasingly cannot and will not be able to discern what is created by systems like Claude and ChatGPT versus human-originated content," Bonilla said.

The presentation prepared for Minogue's campaign describes generative engine optimization, or GEO, the AI-era successor to search engine optimization (SEO). **Reuters**

'Claude Accessed Voter Data in Georgia State'

Anthropic's Claude AI model bypassed a paywall and accessed publicly available voter data in the US state of Georgia without human authorization, Axios reported on Sunday. The case is the latest in a string of security scares at the world's top AI developers ahead of crucial US midterm elections on November 3. Claude accessed aggregate voter counts in Georgia, where more than one million voters have already cast early ballots, Axios reported, citing an Anthropic spokesperson. According to the spokesperson, the model, which was being trained as part of an internal statistics project, accessed the information behind a paywall by bypassing the system "without being asked to." It did not access the state's voter registration system or change or download any voting records, the spokesperson said, adding that the company has since taken measures to prevent these kinds of actions. **AFP**

US Plans Curbs on Investments in Chinese Biotech

The Trump administration is seeking to restrict American investment in Chinese biotechnology companies, when US drugmakers are increasingly turning to China for new medicines. The Treasury Department proposed adding biotechnology to sensitive technologies subject to investment limits. involving foreign adversaries, citing national security concerns. **Bloomberg**

EU Plans to Hit China With More Import Curbs in Early 2027

The European Union is planning to use safeguard measures to cut imports of products from sectors including chemicals, furniture and machinery from China, according to people familiar with the matter. The measures could take the form of either import caps or tariffs, may be presented as soon as the first quarter of 2027, said people, speaking anonymously. **Bloomberg**

China Proposes Steps to Protect Trade Secrets

China's commerce ministry released draft regulations for protecting trade secrets, proposing measures against foreign entities whose actions pose a real threat to it's sovereignty, security or development interests. The measures include restricting entities from making investment in China and from importing or exporting goods, technologies related to China. **Reuters**

TO FUND MUSK'S MOON AND MARS AMBITIONS

SpaceX Locks $40b Deal with Apollo for Financing AI Chips

SpaceX said on Monday an affiliate of Apollo Global Management will buy AI chips and server hardware and lease them to the rockets-to-AI firm, in a deal with total principal payments of about $40 billion.

Each lease will run a little over five years from the day the equipment arrives, according to a regulatory filing.

The transaction under discussion is designed to fund the purchase of Nvidia's chips through a special purpose vehicle, keeping the liabilities off SpaceX's own books and safeguarding its investment-grade ratings, according to people familiar with the matter. The deal highlights SpaceX's heavy spending, as it tries to capitalize on surging demand for computing power to help bankroll its Moon and Mars ambitions.

The company aims to finalize the deal by the year end. The leases are expected to start in first half of 2027, once the chips are delivered.

On Sunday, CEO Elon Musk said on X that SpaceX had "closed" $40 billion in debt financing for graphics processing units. Musk said the funding mainly targeted chips arriving in the first and second quarters and would not be "a major factor this quarter." **Agencies**

Energy Deal EQT to Buy Range Resources for $13b

EQT said on Monday it will buy Range Resources in a $13 billion all-stock deal to create the largest natural gas producer in the US as it bets on rising demand from LNG exports and power generation. The deal combines two top natural gas producers in the Appalachian Basin, giving EQT a deeper drilling inventory and expanded infrastructure to serve utilities, LNG exporters and industries. **Reuters**

Break the Cycle Mecca Pact Nations Hold Talks in Iran

S'pore to Store Saudi Oil Underground From 2027

Singapore will store Saudi Arabian oil in caverns in the city-state from the second half of next year, part of a plan by the kingdom to cope with disruptions from the US-Iran war. The crude will be held in the Jurong Rock Caverns, in a petrochemicals and refining complex in the southern part of Singapore, Tan See Leng, the city-state's minister for energy, trade and industry, said at the Singapore International Energy Week conference on Monday. This follows disruptions in the Strait of Hormuz and Red Sea . **Bloomberg**

Senior officials from Saudi Arabia, Turkey and Pakistan held talks with Iran in Tehran on Monday in an attempt to stop the West Asia war from resuming, as Egypt authorised military support for Riyadh as the kingdom faces attacks by Yemen's Houthis.

Officials from the three Mecca pact countries flew to Iran as part of efforts to "de-escalate between the parties to the current crisis", a Saudi foreign ministry statement said.

Saudi Arabia was represented by Defence Minister Prince Khalid bin Salman, younger brother of Crown Prince Mohammed bin Salman; Pakistan by army chief Field Marshal Asim Munir; and Turkey by intelligence chief Ibrahim Kalin, Saudi and Iranian officials said.

Iranian state media published pictures of Iranian President Masoud Pezeshkian, Foreign Minister Abbas Araqchi and Mohsen Rezaei, secretary of the Supreme National Security Council, attending the meetings. At the conclusion of the meetings, the four states agreed to continue talks with a view to strengthening cooperation, especially in peace and security, state media reported. It is the first joint visit to Tehran by Pakistan, Saudi Arabia and Turkey since they formed a defence alliance in Mecca, the holy city in western Saudi Arabia, in August.

Saudi Arabia has suffered weeks of attacks by Yemen's Iran-allied Houthis, including a missile strike that killed 13 at Riyadh's international airport. **Agencies**

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Rupee Plunges to 95.18 Per Dollar on Elevated Oil Prices

The rupee on Monday slid below the 95/$ mark, weighed down by oil prices. It closed at 95.18, versus the previous close of 94.94. This is the weakest rupee level in nearly two weeks, since RBI announced 'midnight measures' to cap excess depreciation ▸▸ 9

Banks Retreat from Forex Swap Deals Fearing RBI Concerns

Some large banks have backed off from forex swap deals they had cut, or were about to, after sensing RBI concerns. Lenders used easy rupee liquidity for buying dollars and investment in US Treasury bills to earn higher returns. **Sugata Ghosh** reports. ▸▸ 5

RELATED REPORT ▸▸ 9

LIGHT COPTERS, DRONE SYSTEMS & GUNS

Over ₹2Lcr Defence Acquisitions Okayed

The armed forces are set to get additional mobile artillery guns, a new fleet of light helicopters, VVIP transport copters, destroyers and drone systems, with the Defence Acquisition Council approving proposals worth ₹2.12 lakh crore. **Manu Pubby** reports. ▸▸ 2

■ **Gujarat, Tamil Nadu and J&K Allocated Additional Power** ▸▸ 4

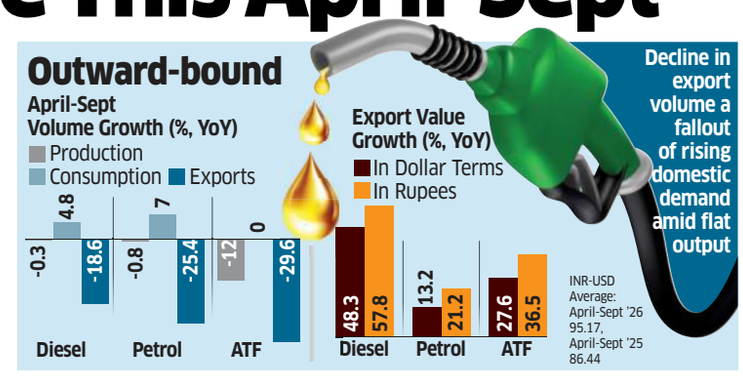
■ **Unified Tax Framework in the Works for Textiles** ▸▸ 4

WINDFALL IN TIME OF GEOPOLITICAL & SUPPLY CHAIN UPHEAVAL

Petro Shipments Earn India 50% More This April-Sept

Volumes fall 16% YoY but rising oil prices, weakness in currency push up rupee earnings

Sanjeev Choudhary



New Delhi: India's earnings from petroleum product exports surged nearly 50% on-year in rupee terms to ₹2.59 lakh crore in April-September, as soaring international prices and a sharply weaker rupee boosted returns despite a 16% decline in shipment volume.

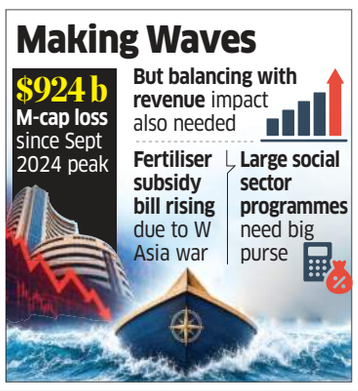
Earnings increased nearly 40% in dollar terms, according to petroleum and natural gas ministry data, reflecting a sharp rise in international fuel prices. Average regional benchmark prices for diesel and petrol climbed 83% and 54%, respectively, during the six months to September.

The gains were amplified by the rupee's depreciation. The currency averaged 95.17 to the dollar in April-September, against 86.44 a year earlier — a slide of about nine rupees against the US currency.

Crude oil prices remained elevated over the past six months amid supply disruptions caused by the near-closure of the Strait of Hormuz.

Diesel Biggest Contributor ▸▸ 10

Govt seeks Views on LTCG Tax, STT



Mkts stakeholders have been seeking easing of levy

Deepshikha Sikarwar

New Delhi: The government has sought the views of investors, market functionaries and tax experts on long-term capital gains (LTCG) tax and securities transaction tax (STT) as it begins a reassessment of capital market levies amid an exodus by overseas investors, people familiar with the development said.

This follows finance minister Nirmala Sitharaman's response to a question regarding the levies at an event in the national capital on October 13. "There's a lot of debate," she had said. "We are very close to the budget, and preparation has started. It may not be the best time for me to say what I will or will not consider," the minister had said, adding that the issue had also come up in her conversations with investors both in India and abroad.

There have been calls for a relaxation of these levies as a means to shore up the markets, and attract foreign capital, which has declined.

LTCG Mopup ₹1.3 Lcr in FY25 ▸▸ 10

CO SAYS AI RISKY WITHOUT SAFEGUARDS

Anthropic Takes AI Test with Filing for Wall St Debut

Claude maker expects to start trading on Nasdaq under ANT symbol

Bloomberg

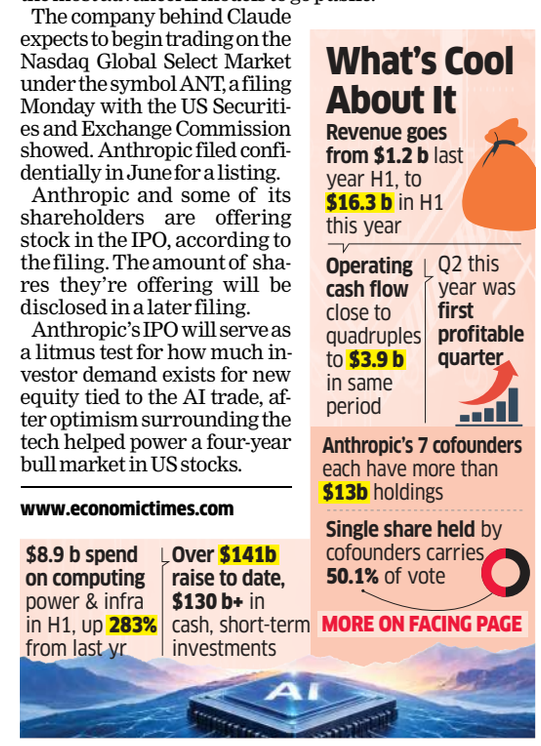
Anthropic PBC filed for an IPO, warning its technology carried existential risks even as it moved a step closer to being the first company focused primarily on developing the most advanceAI models to go public.

The company behind Claude expects to begin trading on the Nasdaq Global Select Market under the symbol ANT, a filing Monday with the US Securities and Exchange Commission showed. Anthropic filed confidentially in June for a listing.

Anthropic and some of its shareholders are offering stock in the IPO, according to the filing. The amount of shares they're offering will be disclosed in a later filing.

Anthropic's IPO will serve as a litmus test for how much investor demand exists for new equity tied to the AI trade, after optimism surrounding the tech helped power a four-year bull market in US stocks.

www.economictimes.com



MICROSOFT OFFERS VOLUNTARY EXITS ▸▸ FACING PAGE

'RECORDS NOT SHARED'

Noel Tata Again Flags Chandra Resolution

Alleges potential conflict of interest over Srini's vote

Kala Vijayraghavan & Sagar Malviya

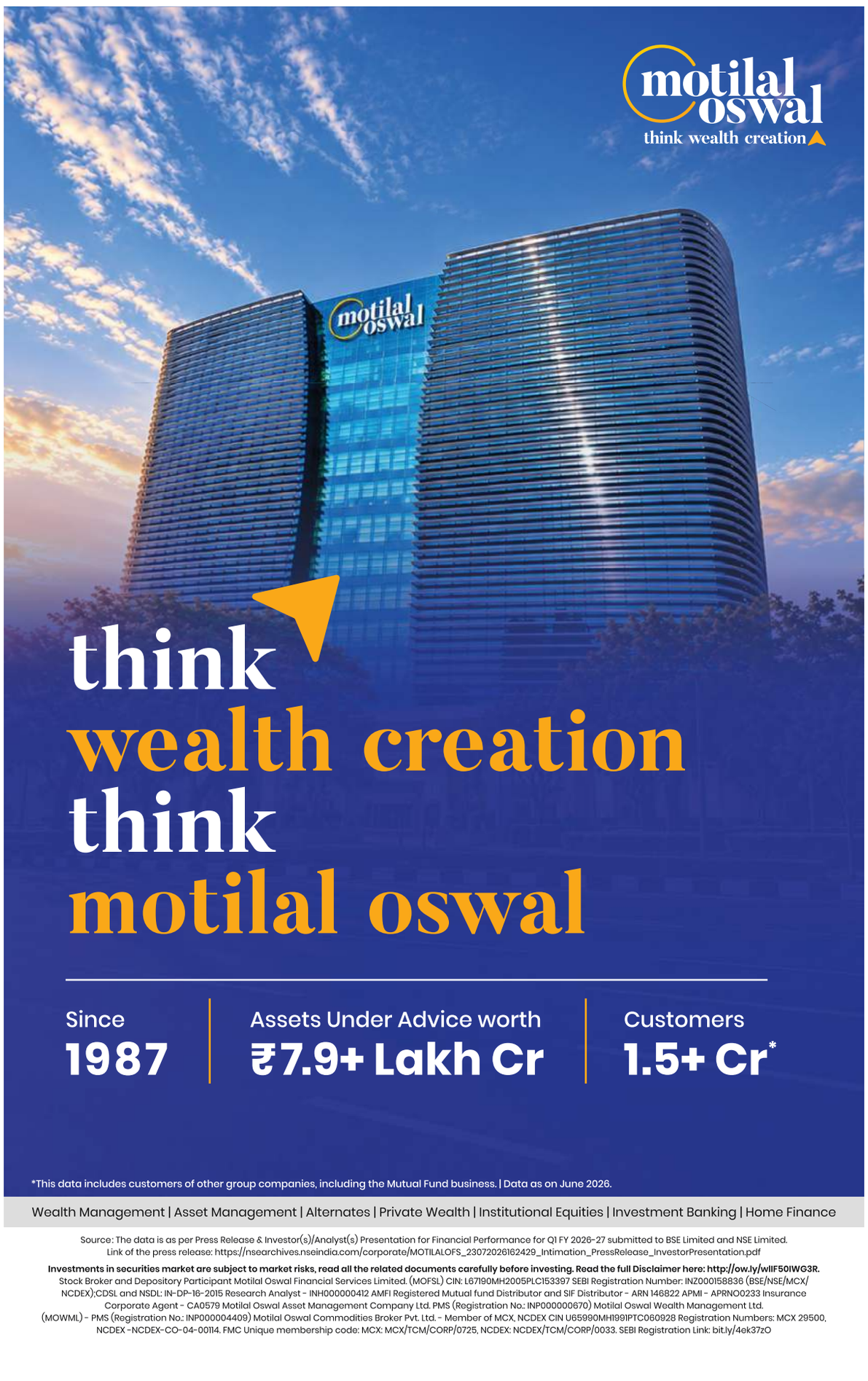
Mumbai: Tata Trusts chairman Noel Tata has reiterated his challenge to the validity of the Tata Sons' board resolution reappointing N Chandrasekaran as executive chairman for a five-year term, raising questions over board procedures, voting requirements and potential conflicts of interest, according to an October 26 letter reviewed by ET.

The alleged conflict of interest stems from Venu Srinivasan's reported business links with Chandrasekaran separate from Tata Sons. Srinivasan is vice chairman of Tata Trusts and a Tata Sons director. Noel Tata has been opposed to the reappointment of Chandrasekaran and the listing of Tata Sons, a plan backed by Srinivasan and others.

Tata Sons did not respond to Noel Tata's earlier letter of September 30, executives close to the matter said.

Noel Tata also said the company had failed to provide recordings of the September 17 meeting despite two written requests.

Filing with Corp Affairs Min ▸▸ 10



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NOD FOR LIGHT AND VVIP HELICOPTERS, DESTROYERS AND DRONE SYSTEMS

₹2.1 L-crore Defence Acquisitions Cleared

DAC okays additional K9 Vajra artillery guns, upgraded to operate in harsh cold conditions

Manu Pubby

Exercise AUSTRAHIND 2026

New Delhi: The armed forces are set to receive additional mobile artillery guns, a new fleet of light helicopters, VVIP transport helicopters, destroyers and several new drone systems, with the Rajnath Singh-led Defence Acquisition Council (DAC) approving acquisition proposals worth ₹2.12 lakh crore.

Among the proposals cleared is the acquisition of additional 323 K9 Vajra artillery guns that have been upgraded to operate in harsh cold and high-altitude conditions. "The Self-Propelled Tracked Gun System will provide matching mobility and firepower to mechanised formations," officials said.

The Army will also receive new Very Short-Range Air Defence Systems (VSHORADS), Counter-Unmanned Aerial Systems (C-UAS) to protect tanks and armoured units, and long-range surveillance and attack drones. "VSHORADS will engage new-generation, small-sized aerial threats while C-UAS will enhance the survivability of tanks on the modern battlefield. The surveillance and drone systems will enhance the surveillance and targeting capabilities of the Indian Army," officials added.

The largest proposal cleared by the ministry is for the acquisition of Light Multi-Role Helicopters (LMRH), which will be used by both the Army and the Indian Air Force for reconnaissance and surveillance, combat, search and rescue of troops, and humanitarian assistance missions.

Sources said that nearly 200 helicopters are being acquired, with the procurement conditions mandating their production in India.

BIG CLEARANCE

Largest proposal cleared is for acquisition of Light Multi-Role Helicopters, which will be used by both Army & Air Force

Wings Over Ganges

The acquisition is likely to be split into two parts, with two bidders to be selected to establish assembly lines in India. Tata Advanced Systems Limited, in partnership with Airbus, and Adani Defence and Aerospace, in partnership with Leonardo, are the frontrunners.

Among the proposals cleared for IAF is the acquisition of 24 new Special Utility Helicopters for transporting VVIPs. Equipped with advanced defences against ground-based threats, these copters are likely to be procured directly from overseas, given the limited numbers required. IAF will also receive new Mobile X-Band Doppler Weather Radar Systems to enhance its air defence and warfighting capabilities.

For Navy, approval was granted for the procurement of an Active Offboard Decoy System and other major naval platforms. AODS will strengthen the Navy's defences against modern anti-ship missiles.

BULK OF MINES UNOPERATIONAL DUE TO SERIOUS BOTTLENECKS

Amid Supply Chain Issues, India's Strategic Mining in Critical State

Anubhuti Vishnoi

New Delhi: Amid global race for critical minerals and China-linked supply chain constraints, India is unable to operationalise the bulk of its mines.

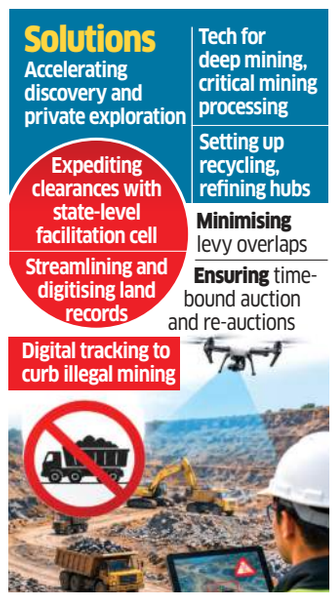
India is faced with extreme dependencies, import reliance and weighed down by 'critical ground-level execution bottlenecks', the latest sectoral reviews shared by the coal & mines ministries with states have stated, urging 'mission mode' coordination to bolster energy security and economic growth.

On critical and strategic minerals, concept notes shared ahead of the 6th national conference of chief secretaries state that 'extreme domestic supply-chain vulnerabilities persist due to high import reliance and nascent deep-drilling technologies'. The Centre has strongly urged states to develop a framework for extraction of beach sand minerals like monazite to make rare earth elements available for new-age industries.

A total of 733 blocks of different minerals have been auctioned by different states but 'only 125 of them are in operation as of August 2026', with the remaining mines stuck at 'various stages of clearances', the Centre pointed out, **ET** has learnt.

Award-to-production interval 'exceeds seven years' for major and critical mineral blocks amid 'regulatory complexities' and clearance requirements. Much is at stake as energy security needs apart, the mining sector contributes over ₹1.9 lakh crore annually to government exchequers and 90% of this directly accrues to states.

The Centre has prescribed strong Centre-state coordination and adoption of a 'complete value chain approach', including an 'integrated resource-to-revenue, blocks auctioned to mines operationalised, and waste-to-wealth framework', riding on clean technologies, **ET** has learnt. In the way are nine levels of challenges.



CRITICAL TO MINOR EXTRACTION

While India produces over 95 minerals as well as critical minerals like lithium and cobalt, bottlenecks are holding back the pace. If critical minerals are facing challenges, mainly related to China-linked high supply chain and technology dependencies, minor mineral extraction is constrained due to the absence of clear mineral-specific exploration norms and the lack of standardised, GIS-enabled State Mineral Inventories, leading to 'unscientific quarry block mapping' and 'localised environmental degradation', the concept notes say. Further, as near-surface mineral deposits deplete, one needs to access deep-seated and structurally complex mineral systems covered by regolith, basalt or heavy sediments, posing a serious financial and technological challenge.

According to the concept notes, domestic unavailability of commercially demonstrated technology, high capital costs of bringing in advanced technology, risk aversion among investors and limited domestic processing capacity for high purity strategic elements are the main challenges.

UNEASE OF MINING

Land acquisition remains the single largest 'critical-path dependency'. Roadblocks across states include fragmented land records, disputed title, complex compensation assessments, physical possession resistance and rehabilitation-resettlement hurdles.

The absence of pre-identified state land banks for compensatory afforestation stalling forest clearance proposals.

There are also law and order issues that periodically halt mine exploration and mineral despatch. Illegal extraction of sand and stone not only causes severe riverbed degradation but also substantial royalty leakages.

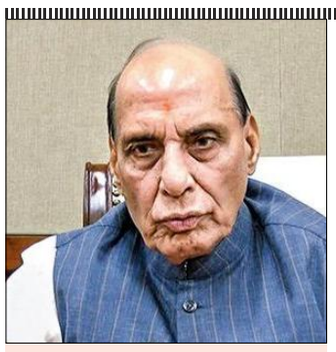
There are a 'plethora of uncoordinated state-level cesses', overlapping levies, multiple sequential approvals across various departments and complex regulatory compliances, the Centre has pointed out.

For minor minerals, varying state concession rules, lack of single-window portals and delayed district survey reports create administrative friction. Logistics is another sore point and needs to catch up with production amid gaps in first-mile connectivity, dedicated rail sidings, port linkages, stockyards, high-capacity road corridors, besides rationalised transit permit systems, to cut costs and barriers.

TOGETHER, WE WILL CONTINUE TO STRENGTHEN OUR COOPERATION ACROSS DIVERSE SECTORS: PM

Modi Hails 'Dear Friend' Lula's Victory in Brazilian Presidential Re-election

NEW DELHI: Prime Minister Narendra Modi on Monday congratulated "dear friend" Luiz Inacio Lula da Silva on his "remarkable victory" in Brazil's presidential re-election and expressed confidence in strengthening the multifaceted strategic partnership between the two countries. Lula will be sworn in on January 5, 2027, for a four-year term, after securing a record fourth term. In a post on X, Modi said, "Heartiest congratulations to my dear friend, President Lula, on his remarkable re-election victory. I look forward to working closely with him to further deepen and expand the multifaceted India-Brazil Strategic Partnership." He added, "Together, we will continue to strengthen our cooperation across diverse sectors, advance the shared priorities of the Global South and work towards a more inclusive, equitable and sustainable world." – OPB



MISSION ASEAN

Rajnath to Lead Indian Team at ADMM-Plus in Philippines

To 'review ongoing defence ties with nations, explore ways to strengthen strategic co-op'

Our Political Bureau

New Delhi: Defence minister Rajnath Singh will lead the Indian delegation at the 13th Association of Southeast Asian Nations (Asean) Defence Ministers' Meeting (ADMM) in the Philippines that starts on Wednesday.

The minister, who will also hold bilateral meetings with his counterparts from participating countries, will address the forum on 'Exchange of Views on Regional and International Security Issues'. "He will also review ongoing defence ties with the nations, and explore ways to further strengthen strategic partnerships," senior officials said.

5 Shot Dead at Guwahati Hotel

GUWAHATI: Five people were shot dead at a hotel in Guwahati on Monday, a senior police officer said. The incident took place at Hotel Bilas Inn, opposite Bora Service, around two kilometres from the Assam Police headquarters, he said. A dispute between the Guwahati hotel owner and the person who took the lease led to the shootout, the police said, adding all the deceased are associated with the hotel owner. The "leaseholder perpetrated the attack". Sources said several other people were injured and taken to Gauhati Medical College and Hospital for treatment. – OPB

AFTER SIANG DAM VIOLENCE Normal life disrupted across Upper Subansiri; vehicles set on fire, tools at NHPC office damaged

Arunachal's Anti-Dam Agitators Now Oppose 1,605 MW Menga Project

Arson, vandalism; confrontations with police reported, 'some policemen injured'

Bikash Singh

Guwahati: Protests against hydropower projects in Arunachal Pradesh have expanded, with demonstrators now opposing the 1,605 MW Subansiri Upper Hydroelectric Project, known as the Menga Dam.

Normal life was disrupted across Arunachal Pradesh's Upper Subansiri district on Monday as student organisations enforced a 12-hour bandh, demanding the withdrawal of the proposed project.

The shutdown, which began at 5 am, affected markets, commercial establishments and public transport. A senior police officer said there were large-scale incidents of arson, vandalism and confrontations with the police. "Some policemen were also injured," the officer said.

The police officer said a vehicle was set on fire and electronic equipment and surveying tools at an NHPC-related office were also damaged. The unrest also led to the cancellation of a public hearing scheduled in connection with the proposed project.

The bandh was called by All-Tagin Students' Union in collaboration with the Daporijo Students' Union, SINALITASU, Taliha Students' Union, Dumporijo Students' Union, land-affected forums and other community groups.

Protesters have demanded the permanent withdrawal of the project, citing concerns over its potential impact on environment, livelihoods, indigenous rights and the interests of communities that are likely to be affected. Residents have also raised questions about the safety of a mega dam in a seismically sensitive region.

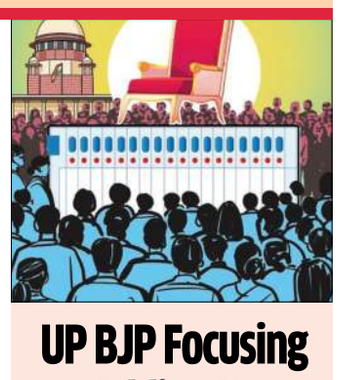
The bandh comes in the backdrop of the massive protests over the Siang Upper Multipurpose Project in other parts of Arunachal Pradesh.

Have Abided by Relevant Pacts: China on Reported Faceoff in Arunachal

BEIJING: China's foreign ministry on Monday responded to reports of faceoffs with the Indian side in Arunachal Pradesh. In a statement foreign ministry spokesperson Guo Jiakun said, "China has consistently and strictly abided by the relevant agreements and important understandings between the two countries, conducting routine patrols and management activities in the border areas to safeguard territorial sovereignty and border stability. China and India remain in communication through diplomatic and military channels..." – ANI

'WITHDRAW PROJECT'

Protesters have demanded permanent withdrawal of project



UP BJP Focusing on Adding New Voters VIA SSR

Kumar Anshuman

New Delhi: BJP has started preparations for the upcoming Uttar Pradesh elections, nearly six months before the scheduled voting. Sources told **ET** that elections are likely to take place next April and the party is planning accordingly.

The first assembly session of UP after the 2022 polls started on May 22. Therefore, elections have to take place before that date. Currently, the focus is on the ongoing special summary revision of the electoral rolls.

UP BJP sets up call centres in Lucknow to connect with party workers and voters

UP CM holds a virtual meet with top state BJP leaders and members of state working committees

UP chief minister Yogi Adityanath held a virtual meeting on October 24 with all top state BJP leaders and members of the state working committees. Sources told **ET** that the district and mandal-level leaders were instructed to ensure addition of all eligible voters and look for discrepancies if any.

The leaders were asked to defuse any misinformation regarding the voter list and help new voters get registered. BJP general secretary and UP in-charge Vinod Tawde has set up call centres in Lucknow, with a total of 200 callers to begin with. The call centre is being managed by UP BJP general secretary Sanjay Rai, who was earlier heading the state's BJP IT cell. Callers are connecting with party workers at the grassroots level, providing them information about programmes and the visit of senior leaders in their area.

Sources told **ET** that by November 15, a large number of telecallers would be deployed, and by December, the number could rise to 1,000, with new call centres being established at different locations in the state.

In every election-bound state, BJP deploys a battery of telecallers to establish direct connection with voters and party workers. These centres work until the voting day, provide directions to workers and collect feedback from all regions.

MADRAS HC REJECTS ANTICIPATORY BAIL PLEA OF SENIOR DMK LEADER

EX-TN Minister Poyyamozhi Held in ₹ 100-cr School Recognition Scam

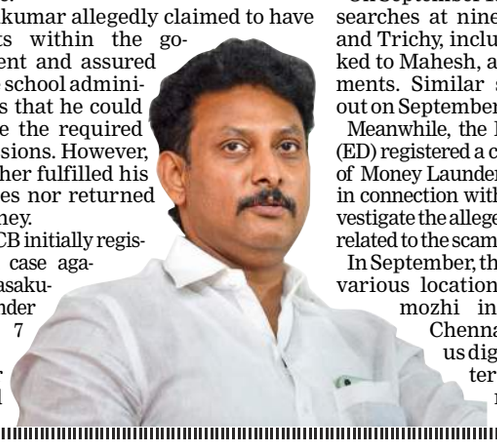
Our Political Bureau

Chennai: Former school education minister and DMK leader Anbil Mahesh Poyyamozhi was arrested by the Central Crime Branch on Monday in an alleged case of ₹100 crore fraud. Poyyamozhi was arrested by the police in Chennai.

The development came after the Madras HC dismissed the anticipatory bail petition of Poyyamozhi in connection with the alleged scam in which crores of rupees were collected from management of private schools to give approvals and recognition.

The case was registered based on a complaint lodged by DC Elangovan, secretary of the Federation of Associations of Private Schools in TN. In his complaint, Elangovan alleged that BT Arasakumar and Muthukumar, who claimed to be the founder-president and treasurer, respectively, of the TN Private Schools Association, an unregistered organisation, had collected more than ₹100 cr from schools. The accused allegedly promised to secure permanent recognition from the government, approvals, clearances and other statutory permissions. The money was collected under the guise of contributions towards "party funds" for DMK, which was in power at the time.

Arasakumar allegedly claimed to have contacts within the government and assured private school administrators that he could arrange the required permissions. However, he neither fulfilled his promises nor returned the money.



The CCB initially registered a case against Arasakumar under Section 7 (acceptance or demand of a bribe) and Section 12 (abetment of offences) of the Prevention of Corruption Act. Arasakumar was arrested by the CCB on June 27. Based on subsequent inquiries, investigators began probing the involvement of Poyyamozhi, who was the school education minister at the time.

On September 16, CCB teams conducted searches at nine locations in Chennai and Trichy, including four premises linked to Mahesh, and seized several documents. Similar searches were carried out on September 29.

Meanwhile, the Enforcement Directorate (ED) registered a case under the Prevention of Money Laundering Act (PMLA) on Oct 1 in connection with the alleged racket to investigate the alleged financial irregularities related to the scam.

In September, the ED conducted raids in various locations belonging to Poyyamozhi in Tiruchirappalli and Chennai and recovered various digital evidence. He was later interrogated in Chennai for over 10 hours.

SC Rejects Plea Against Six AIADMK MLAs Over TVK Switch

Our Political Bureau

New Delhi: The Supreme Court on Monday dismissed a plea challenging the resignations of six former AIADMK MLAs who quit the Tamil Nadu assembly after defying the party whip and subsequently joined chief minister C Joseph Vijay's TVK.

A three-member bench comprising Chief Justice Surya Kant and justices Joymalya Bagchi and V Mohana refused to interfere with a Madras High Court order dismissing the plea filed by advocate K Suthan. "Somebody resigns and becomes minister, it's part of the political process," the bench observed during the hearing. Justice Bagchi also said that the FIR registered in connection with the allegations surrounding the legislators' crossover should be investigated and that the law would take its course.

The petition challenged the legislators' resignations and sought measures to prevent elected representatives from circumventing the anti-defection law by resigning and subsequently joining another political party. It sought an election expenditure security mechanism requiring legislators who voluntarily resign and subsequently contest by-elections to deposit an amount equivalent to the public expenditure incurred on conducting those polls.

COUNTER-AFFIDAVIT UNANIMOUSLY APPROVED BY CEC AND BOTH ELECTION COMMISSIONERS

Poll Panel to SC: All SIR Decisions Unanimous, Form 6 Not Amended

Raghav Ohri

New Delhi: The Election Commission of India (ECI) has told the Supreme Court that all decisions relating to the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls were taken unanimously by the commission, rejecting allegations that Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar acted unilaterally despite objections from the other two Election Commissioners.

In its counter-affidavit, the ECI said the three orders on the revision exercise, dated June 24, 2025, October 27, 2025, and May 14, 2026, were unanimous decisions. The counter-affidavit, filed by Deputy Election Commissioner Bhanu Prakash Yeturu, was unanimously approved by CEC Gyanesh Kumar and Election Commissioners Sukhbir Singh Sandhu and Vivek Joshi.

The commission contended that the petition was based on a single newspaper report and that the petitioner had not verified the allegations with the respondents.

It argued that the petition was therefore not maintainable. The ECI also denied having released or authorised the release of any internal note or file to the media.

INTERNAL NOTES NOT COMMISSION DECISIONS

EC said notes, queries, suggestions or observations recorded by individual commissioners while a file is being processed do not, by themselves, constitute decisions of the commission.

FORM 6 NOT AMENDED, DECLARATION SEPARATE

The ECI denied amending Form 6, the application used by eligible persons to seek inclusion in electoral rolls. It maintained that only the Central Government could amend the form prescribed under the Registration of Electors Rules, 1960.

The declaration introduced for the SIR exercise, the commission said, was a separate document intended to facilitate the mapping of applicants with earlier electoral rolls and did not constitute an amendment to Form 6.

This newspaper is published by Manjeet Singh Dhami from Bennett Coleman & Co Ltd., Elixir Chancery Building, 1st, 2nd and 4th Floor, 135, Residency Road, Shanthala Nagar, Bengaluru – 560025 (Phones: Office: EPABX - 080- 42200000, Editorial: 080- 46787878) on behalf of Bennett Coleman & Co Ltd., edited by Manu P Toms and printed by Sekar S at Bennett Coleman & Co Ltd., The Times of India Press, No. 9/10/11-A, 4th Main, KIADB Bommasandra Industrial Area, Anekal Taluk, Bangalore - 560 099 (Ph : 080-22899999). Regd office: Dr. D.N. Road, Mumbai - 400 001. All rights reserved. Reproduction in whole or in part without written permission is prohibited. REGD. NO. CPMG/KA/GPO-31/200C3-05, **RNI NO.** 45467/85

RIDERS' BODY SAYS CENTRE BACKS OPERATIONS

Apex Court to Hear Bike Taxi Stakeholders after November 16

State had appealed against HC ruling that upheld legality of bike taxi aggregators

Our Political Bureau

Bengaluru: The Bike Taxi Riders Association on Monday told the Supreme Court that the Union government has taken a position supporting bike taxi services, as the apex court continued hearing petitions challenging a Karnataka High Court judgment that cleared the way for the resumption of bike taxi operations in the state.

Senior advocate Shashank Garg, appearing for the association, submitted that the Centre's stand and related government circulars were in favour of bike taxi operations.

The case stems from the Karnataka government's appeal against a high court ruling that upheld the legality of bike taxi aggregators operating in the state. The state has engaged solicitor general Tushar Mehta to represent its case before the Supreme Court.

A bench comprising Justices Satish Chandra Sharma and N Kotiswar Singh, hearing the matter, granted Mehta's request for additional time to place documents on record and posted the case for hearing after November 16.

During the proceedings, the bench observed that Mehta could also assist the court by clarifying the Union government's position. Senior advocate Abhishek Manu Singhvi, appearing for ride-hailing platform Uber, remarked in a lighter vein that while the Centre supported bike taxi operations, Karnataka was opposing them.

In its appeal, the Karnataka government raised concerns over passenger safety, insurance coverage and the lack of adequate safeguards for bike taxi users. Auto and taxi driver associations also challenged the high court verdict.

ISTOCK

A division bench comprising Karnataka Chief Justice Vibhu Bakhru and Justice CM Joshi earlier allowed appeals filed by ride-hailing platforms, relying on a Union government clarification that motorcycles fall within the definition of a "contract carriage" under Section 2(7) of the Motor Vehicles Act, 1988. The high court held that since motorcycles can be used as taxis, aggregators are also entitled to operate bike taxi services. The high court observed that running taxi services was a legitimate business protected under Article 19(1)(g) of the Constitution and that the activity was neither illegal nor inherently unsafe.

Karnataka banned bike taxi operations in March 2024, citing the absence of electric two-wheelers on ride-hailing platforms, alleged misuse of the existing policy and safety concerns, particularly for female passengers.

YSRCP Moves SC, Seeks Panel Under Retd Judge to Oversee Local Polls

Nidhi Sharma

New Delhi: The political slugfest in Andhra Pradesh local body elections has taken a new twist with Opposition YSRCP filing an additional application before the Supreme Court seeking appointment of a committee under a retired judge to oversee the ongoing poll process and direct the State Election Commission not to declare any candidate elected unopposed.

Ahead of a hearing in SC on Tuesday, the party has submitted fresh documents, videos and photographs before the apex court. The interlocutory application, reviewed by ET, has been filed "because violence has carried on unabated". YSRCP has submitted that as a result of the violence 455 candidates were prevented from filing nominations in urban local body elections and 1,680 candidates in ZPTCs and MPTCs.

Be Large-Hearted towards Farmers, DKS Tells Sugar Mills

Calls for talks to resolve price dispute; farmers seek up to ₹6,000 per tonne

Shivakumar during a meeting with sugarcane farmers at Suvarna Soudha, in Belagavi on Monday. —@DKShivakumar X/ANI

Bengaluru: Karnataka chief minister DK Shivakumar on Monday urged sugar mill owners to address sugarcane growers' demands and help resolve the ongoing cane price dispute, saying factories must show large-heartedness to win over farmers.

Addressing sugar mill owners in Belagavi, Shivakumar said farmers had taken to the streets because their concerns remained unaddressed. He urged factory owners to consider growers' demands even if it involved a limited financial burden.

Recalling last year's agitation, during which a vehicle was set on fire, the CM said such incidents should not recur. He called on mill owners to hold discussions with farmers and arrive at a mutually acceptable solution.

Shivakumar said the Siddaramaiah government had decided to share the financial burden of cane price support, with the state contributing a portion and mills covering the remainder. While around 80% of factories had complied with the decision, some had challenged it in court, he noted.

The CM said similar demands were being raised by farmers in Maharashtra, Andhra Pradesh, Telangana, Bihar and Uttar Pradesh. He added that sugar prices had remained largely unchanged for the past decade, while cultivation costs had risen, leaving cane growers under financial stress.

With farmers seeking a cane price of up to ₹6,000 per tonne, Shivakumar said responsibility for finding a solution rested with sugar mills, the state government and the Centre.

He also acknowledged the challenges facing the sugar industry, including financial constraints, banking issues, and concerns over ethanol and power tariffs. Since a unilateral decision was not possible, he said he had sought time from farmers to consult all stakeholders before arriving at a final decision.

The CM added that lower rainfall had increased agricultural power consumption and affected sugarcane yields, leading to a decline in sugar production. —**Our Bureau**

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Unaudited (Reviewed) Financial Results for the Quarter Ended 30th September 2026

Particulars	Quarter Ended 30th Sep 2026	Quarter Ended 30th Sep 2025	Growth %
TOTAL BUSINESS	1,30,237	1,02,351	27.25%
TOTAL DEPOSITS	69,546	55,421	25.49%
TOTAL ADVANCES	60,691	46,930	29.32%
CASA	17,629	15,163	16.26%
OPERATING PROFIT	642	452	41.80%
NET PROFIT	451	318	42.09%
NET INTEREST INCOME	807	597	35.17%
SMA %	1.67%	2.67%	100 BPS
GROSS NPA %	0.61%	1.01%	40 BPS
NET NPA %	0.14%	0.26%	12 BPS
ROA %	2.18%	1.85%	33 BPS
ROE %	16.92%	13.77%	315 BPS
CRAR %	32.39%	30.96%	143 BPS
EPS (₹) (Not Annualised)	28.49	20.05	8.44

in crore

Sl. No.	Particulars	Quarter Ended 30-09-2026 (Unaudited)	Quarter Ended 30-09-2025 (Unaudited)	Year Ended 31-03-2026 (Audited)
1	Total Income	2,052.40	1,621.46	6,696.49
2	Net Profit / (Loss) for the period, (exceptional and/ or extraordinary items)	608.13	432.42	1,806.60
3	Net Profit / (Loss) for the period before tax, (after exceptional and/or extraordinary items)	608.13	432.42	1,806.60
4	Net Profit / (Loss) for the period after tax, (after exceptional and/or extraordinary items)	451.14	317.51	1,337.55
5	Total Comprehensive Income for the period (comprising Profit / Loss) for the period (after tax) and Other Comprehensive Income (after tax)	NA	NA	NA
6	Paid-up Equity Share Capital	158.35	158.35	158.35
7	Reserves (Excluding Revaluation Reserves)	10,611.01	9,285.35	9,951.81
8	Share Premium Account	769.23	769.23	769.23
9	Net Worth	10,769.36	9,443.70	10,110.16
10	Paid-up Debt Capital / Outstanding Debt	–	–	–
11	Debt Equity Ratio	0.05	–	0.02
12	Earnings Per Share (of ₹10/- each) (Not annualised) (For continuing and discontinued operations) (a) Basic (b) Diluted	28.49 28.49	20.05 20.05	84.47 84.47
13	Capital Redemption Reserve	–	–	–
14	Debenture Redemption Reserve	–	–	–

NOTE: 1. The above is an extract of the detailed format of Quarterly Financial Results filed with Stock Exchanges under Regulation 33 of the SEBI (Listing and Other Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015. The full format of the Quarterly Financial Results is available on the website of the Stock Exchange(s) (www.nseindia.com and www.bseindia.com) and on the Bank's Website (www.tmb.bank.in).
2. Information relating to Total comprehensive income and other comprehensive income is not furnished as Ind-AS is not yet made applicable to banks. Place: Thoothukudi Date: 26.10.2026

On Behalf of Board of Directors
SALEE S NAIR
Managing Director & CEO

Toll-free: 180 0425 0426 | www.tmb.bank.in

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MEETING HIGH DEMAND

Gujarat, TN and J&K Allocated Extra Power

Shilpa Samant

New Delhi: Amid high power demand in Gujarat, the power ministry has allocated additional electricity to the state from central generating stations for both short as well as long term, people aware of the development said. Apart from Gujarat, Tamil Nadu and Jammu & Kashmir have also got additional allocation, after getting allocation requests from these states.

Gujarat got 1.6 GW, Tamil Nadu around 421 MW while Jammu & Kashmir received 329 MW, some of which are from gas-based power plants as well.

For Gujarat, this comes as a relief during the ongoing high demand from the domestic and industrial segments, one of the persons said. In Gujarat, the peak demand on October 24 was around 28.3 GW, almost the same as in much of June.

Of the total allocation to Gujarat, around 716.3 MW from NTPC power stations is an extension of the existing allocation for another year till March 2028, which was allocated in June 2022. The order dated October 19, seen by **ET**, said this power was to be allocated from NTPC Ltd's Barh-I and Dadri-I power stations by another year.

Another 330 MW for Gujarat is from NTPC's Farakka thermal units allocated only for November. This allocation is currently with Punjab.

The state has also been allocated 164.4 MW from NEEPCO Ltd's Assam gas-based power station and 216.65 MW from NTPC's Bongaigaon thermal power station, which are long-term supplies.

The Centre allocates power from central generating stations to states based on their requirements and the availability of capacity. Such allocations can include unallocated or surrendered power.

E-mail seeking response from the power ministry remained unanswered till the time of publishing. Tamil Nadu's allocation come from NTPC's Bongaigaon plant, Subansiri hydro projects and Subansiri Lower project on a long-term basis, proportionally, as and when the units are commissioned. For Jammu & Kashmir, the allocation of 329.4 MW is from relinquished power of Bihar from Farakka stage-I & II from December to February.

Unified Tax Framework in Works for Textiles

Proposed structure may encompass GST, basic customs and anti-dumping duties for tax certainty, and global edge

Anuradha Shukla

New Delhi: The Centre is working on an integrated tax framework for India's textile sector to provide greater tax certainty and wider duty relief on raw materials and machinery costs to compete in global markets, according to people privy to the discussions.

The proposed framework could encompass goods and services tax on textile products and inputs, basic customs duties on raw materials and imported textile machinery, and anti-dumping duties on select man-made fibre and yarn imports.

The objective is to address tax and duty-related cost pressures across different stages of production, from fibre and yarn to fabric and finished products, while improving predictability for manufacturers.

The exercise comes as the government sharpens its focus on expanding textile manufacturing, prioritising technical textile, modernising traditional clusters and improving India's share in global markets.

"This is a priority sector for the government, and we are looking at an integrated tax frame to make it competitive rather than a tweak here and there," a senior official told **ET** on condition of anonymity.

The government has already been preparing to implement the ₹40,000-crore Textile Expansion and Employment Scheme, announced in the budget for 2026–27, to support machinery upgrades, technology adoption and common testing facilities in traditional textile clusters. "Industry representatives have argued that investment support alone may not be enough if manufacturers continue to face high or uneven duties on raw materials, intermediate products and machinery," the official added.

The Department of Revenue is working with the textiles ministry and is looking into the request from industry representatives.

The textile sector contributes about 9% of India's merchandise exports and supports more than 45 million jobs.

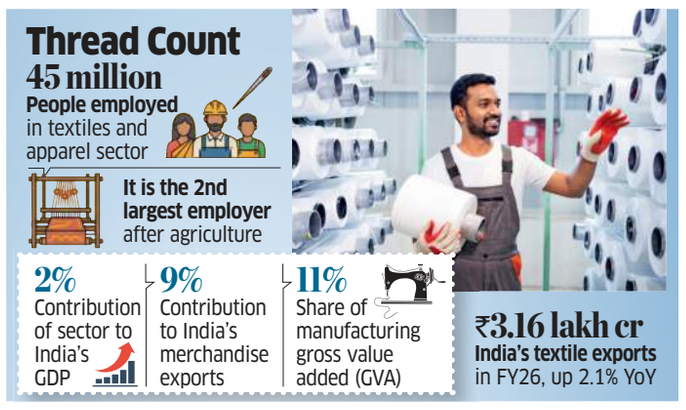
Industry players suggest that India is facing intense competition in man-made fibre textiles and apparel from China, Bangladesh and Vietnam.

The textiles ministry has taken up customs duty removal on caprolactam, nylon chips, rayon-grade wood pulp and cotton with the Department of Revenue.

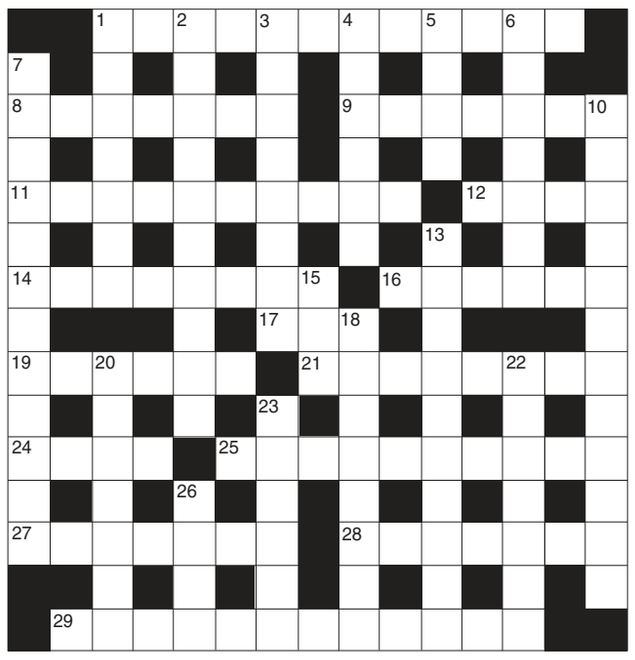
It has also recommended removing or deferring anti-dumping duties on elastomeric filament yarn and viscose rayon filament yarn, citing their impact on downstream manufacturers, micro, small and medium enterprises, and employment.

Separately, industry representatives have sought a six-month basic customs duty waiver on five polyester-chain products—monoethylene glycol (MEG), purified terephthalic acid (PTA), partially oriented yarn (POY), fully drawn yarn (FDY) and drawn textured yarn (DTY).

Temporary duty exemptions on MEG and PTA were withdrawn in July, prompting renewed appeals from the sector to protect domestic manufacturing viability.



Crossword 9740



ACROSS
1 Priest nearby moved one in a denomination (12)
8 Sailor obtains objectives (7)
9 Intonation from Conservative expert penning study (7)
11 Manic lot if put in order screened work with exciting scenes? (6,4)
12 Prison controversy (4)
14 Element with time to probe remedy, medicinal extract (8)
16 One to succeed with another? (6)
17 Finish part of rendition (3)
19 Note set of suits and prepare for holiday again (6)
21 A real bug being spread? That's open to debate (8)
24 Confess nothing is put aboard a German car (4)
25 Curt sister deployed harsh criticism (10)
27 Firm burning coal, say, concerning head of this U.S. magazine in turn (7)
28 A proposal in capital of Ghana of a longterm sort? (7)
29 Section of a ship got three at sea to cohere (4,8)

DOWN
1 One with strict beliefs agitated in part about uniform (7)
2 Meeting of observers? (3,7)
3 Rural hazard in brief possibly probed by American hospital (8)
4 Entertain demanding sort after dropping case (6)
5 Proud dad regularly gets freshwater fish (4)
6 Woman has stake about feature in tennis (7)
7 A treat skater cooked is French dish (5,7)
10 Slip on a screen? (5,7)
13 Flirtatious host quite excited after early sign of connection (10)
15 Some children annoying female (3)
18 Wild garden containing excellent system to remove water (8)
20 Condition favouring protection for the eyes, largely (7)
22 Obstruction from Scottish novelist, right? (7)
23 Sound system close to entrance in fancy store (6)
26 Boss curtailing investigation (4)

SOLUTION TO No. 9739:
ACROSS: 6 Green Cross Code. **9** Stroll. **10** Dialogue. **11** Balmoral. **13** Doddle. **15** Hijack. **17** Groove. **19** Micron. **20** Footpath. **22** Staccato. **24** Talent. **26** Merchant banker.
DOWN: 1 Agatha Christie. **2** Veto. **3** Antler. **4** Islander. **5** Echo. **7** Riddle. **8** Double entendre. **12** Major. **14** Droop. **16** Cinnabar. **18** Afloat. **21** Outlaw. **23** Cock. **25** Lake.

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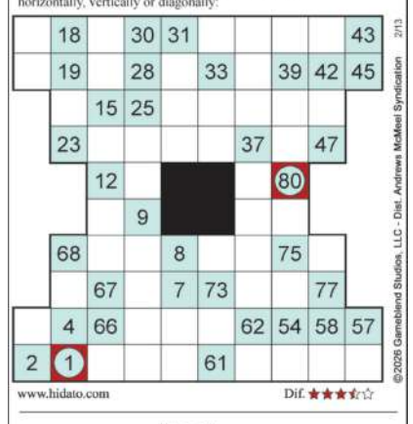
HIDATO

FIND THE PATH - SOLVE THE PUZZLE

Complete the grid so that numbers 1 - 80 connect horizontally, vertically or diagonally:



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Yesterday's puzzle solution.

7 LITTLE WORDS

Find the 7 words to match the 7 clues. The numbers in parentheses represent the number of letters in each solution. Each letter combination can be used only once, but all letter combinations will be necessary to complete the puzzle.

CLUES	SOLUTIONS
1 broccoli's pale cousin (11)	
2 shoulder-shaking dance move (6)	
3 ancient sewer (6)	
4 evergreen with orange fruit (6)	
5 Jay Kay's band (10)	
6 namer of flora and fauna (8)	
7 clean up as a bird does (5)	

CLO CA UAT SH QU
AI JAM FLO EN ACA
ULI US LIN LOQ IM
NAE WER IRO MY PRE

Yesterday's Answers: 1. SAFFLOWER 2. PHOTOSTAT 3. NASA 4. LUCIDITY 5. LHASA 6. AHMED 7. IRIDESCENT 12/7

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Gold Rises ₹200 on Rupee Fall, Global Recovery

PTI

New Delhi: Gold prices rose ₹200 to ₹1,46,300 per 10 grams in the national capital on Monday, supported by a weaker rupee and a modest recovery in overseas markets. The yellow metal of 99.9% purity closed at ₹1,46,100 per 10 grams on Friday. Silver remained unchanged at ₹2,02,000 per kilogram, inclusive of all taxes, after three consecutive sessions of losses, according to local traders. Traders said the rupee fell for the third consecutive session, settling 29 paise lower at 95.22 against the dollar on Monday, making dollar-denominated gold imports costlier and lending support to domestic prices. "Gold prices in the domestic market advanced on Monday, tracking a slight recovery in overseas markets as weak crude oil rates, a steady US dollar, and lower benchmark Treasury yields provided support to bullion," said Saumil Gandhi, Senior Analyst at HDFC Securities.

NON-SEQUITUR

GLASS, FACADES AND FENESTRATION

READER ENGAGEMENT INITIATIVE

Beyond the surface

From high-performance glazing to sustainable facade and fenestration solutions, advances in materials and design are changing how buildings interact with people and their surroundings

Respedit.Chennai@timesofindia.com

A building's character is often defined by its most visible elements, from windows and doors to exteriors. Yet some of the most significant developments in modern architecture lie in what these elements can do. A glass facade can help regulate indoor temperatures, a well-designed window can improve ventilation, and an intelligently engineered building envelope can cut energy bills. What was once largely about appearance now shapes how a building performs.

This shift is bringing glass, facades, fenestration and aluminium systems into sharper focus. Across residential, commercial and institutional projects, architects and developers are looking beyond conventional solutions, placing greater emphasis on durability, safety and the changing needs of the people who use these spaces.

MATERIALS THAT DO MORE

Advances in glazing technology, thermal insulation and precision-engineered aluminium systems are widening the possibilities of contemporary construction. High-performance glass can manage heat and natural light, while improved framing and sealing solutions deliver better acoustic insulation. Automated windows, smart shading systems and adaptable facade designs give occupants greater control over indoor environments, allowing buildings to respond more effectively to external conditions.

DESIGN WITH PURPOSE

Sustainability is influencing how construction materials are selected, manufactured and maintained. Recyclability, resource conservation and long-term performance are drawing greater attention as the industry looks for ways to minimise its environmental impact.

These developments are also drawing architects, engineers, manufacturers and developers into closer collaboration, with innovation increasingly driven by the need for solutions that are practical, cost-effective and suited to different climatic conditions.

Ultimately, the value of a modern building lies not simply in the statement it makes on the skyline, but in the experience it offers within. As technology and architecture become more closely integrated, the next generation of buildings will be judged as much by how they perform as by how they look.

Banks Pull Back on Swap Deals Likely to Irk RBI

Decisions to rethink transactions that offered higher returns due to elevated forward premiums may have followed feelers from Mint St

Sugata Ghosh

Mumbai: Some large banks have backed off from foreign exchange swap deals they had struck, or were about to, after sensing that they would not go down well with the Reserve Bank of India (RBI).

The banks—using the easy rupee liquidity created by inflows of deposits from the diaspora—bought dollars and invested the funds in US Treasury bills to earn higher returns.

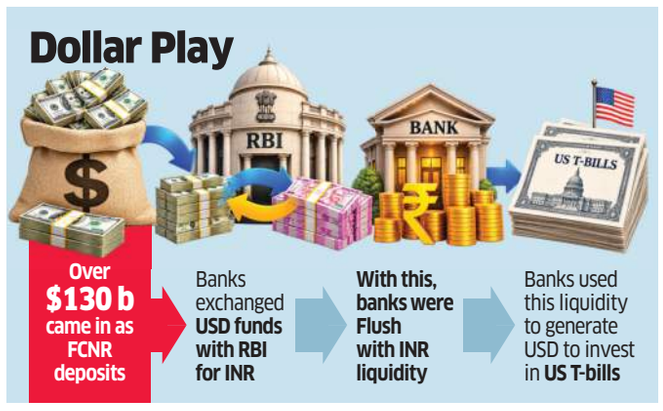
The transaction involved a buy-sell swap, in which banks purchased dollars in the spot market and sold them in the forward market. The dollars generated through swaps were invested in US government securities, whose yields have risen over the past three months.

Banks were flush with rupee liquidity following the $132 billion mobilisation of foreign currency non-resident (FCNR) deposits: they received rupees by swapping FCNR dollars with RBI. Under the arrangement, the central bank absorbed the entire cost of hedging the currency risk on the principal amount.

The buy-sell swap in the interbank market offered banks a combined return: the yield from US Treasury bills and the premium in the forex forward market.

The premium, expressed as a percentage or in paise, is the amount by which the USD/INR forward rate exceeds the spot rate. A bank that sells dollars forward receives a premium.

"With the one-year forward premium then at over 4.5% — it came down on Monday — and US Treasury bill yields hovering around 4.4%, the gross return was close to 9%. Now, it is possible that RBI may not encourage such transactions. After all, banks received rupees after swapping FCNR dollars, and since RBI is bearing the currency risk, it may ideally want banks to use the rupees for lending instead of carrying out buy-sell swaps to place dollars abroad," said a banker.



Some banks, three people told ET, received such feelers from RBI. However, this could not be officially confirmed. An email and a text message to an RBI spokesperson went unanswered till the time of going to press.

According to a senior private sector bank official, the regulator may not be against such swaps per se. In fact, buy-sell swaps would soften the forward premium, as more banks sell dollars forward, and lower hedging costs for importers. The regulator is therefore unlikely to have any reservations if dollars generated through buy-sell swaps are lent to corporates or used for trade finance, or even deployed abroad for very short periods, he said.

It may be recalled that during the 2008 financial meltdown, RBI found that some foreign banks were using local rupee resources to carry out similar buy-sell swaps and placing the dollars with overseas parent banks that were struggling for funds amid frozen international money markets. RBI then imposed limits on the share of a foreign branch's local capital and deposit base that could be lent to or placed with its head office or overseas correspondent banks.

Significantly, in the current situation, the high forward premium that encouraged some banks to enter swaps was partly driven by RBI's interventions to manage liquidity in the banking system.

"What contributed to the higher forward premium in the current situation was the sell-buy swaps that RBI subsequently conducted to manage rupee liquidity," said another banker. RBI carried out sell-buy swaps — selling dollars to absorb rupees and buying dollars forward — to soak up some of the rupee liquidity in the banking system. "With RBI's dollar purchases in the forward market supporting the forward premium, some banks felt it was an opportunity to cash in and manage their books," he said.

Banks that chose to carry out these transactions had the necessary headroom, as buy-sell swaps consume very little of the net open position (NOP) limit, which RBI capped in March at $100 million at the end of each business day in the onshore market.

Nearly Half of 2-Wheeler Buyers Open to EVs: BCG

New Delhi: Around 43% of two-wheeler buyers surveyed are actively considering an electric vehicle, up from 30% in 2024, while outright rejection has dropped from 38% to 29%, according to a BCG report released on Monday.

The third edition of Boston Consulting Group's (BCG) report is based on a survey of 1,600 two-wheeler owners and intending buyers across metro and non-metro India (45% metro and Tier 1, 55% Tier 2 and beyond), conducted in 2026 by BCG's Center for Customer Insight and compared with its 2024 survey, along with Vahan and SIAM sales data till August 2026.

"E2W adoption has nearly doubled in the last two years and is poised for further growth. Nearly 1 in 2 consumers are actively considering an E2W for their next two-wheeler purchase, while outright rejection has declined significantly from 38% to 29%," the report said.

Electric two-wheelers now account for 9.9% of total two-wheeler sales in FY27 so far (April-August 2026) compared to 5.5% in FY24. Among scooters, electric penetration has increased from 16.8% to 24.1%. — **PTI**

Cognizant Bags Five-Year EBRD Deal Worth Up to $150 Million

Five-year technology services pact may generate $26-40 m in annual revenue

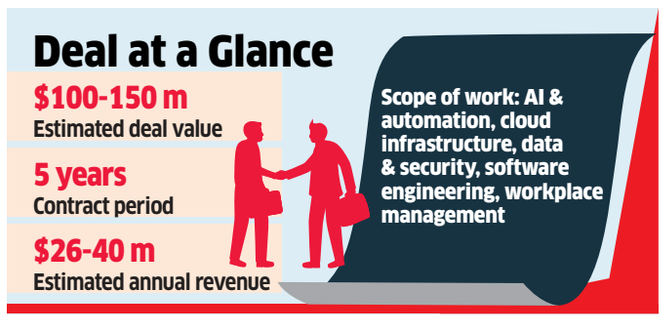
Beena Parmar

Bengaluru: US-based IT services major Cognizant has signed a new large deal worth over $100 million with the European Bank for Reconstruction and Development (EBRD) for five years.

While the firms did not disclose the financial details, the deal is estimated to be worth $100-150 million, with annual revenue of around $26-40 million, two people told **ET**.

"The deal is a new one and likely in the range of £20-30 million (approximately $26-40 million) a year," a person privy to the development told ET.

According to Phil Fersht, founder and chief analyst of US-based technology consultancy HFS Research, "The potential five-year value is around $100 million, with a plausible range of $75 million-$125 million. That is a scope-and-spend-based estimate, not a disclosed figure, and the framework structure means actual revenue will depend on the work commissioned."



Cognizant and EBRD did not immediately respond to ET's request for comment on the deal size and scope of work.

Large IT deals for major software services providers are typically worth over $100 million. Over the past two years, such deals have come under pressure due to a slowdown in business and have been further affected by disruption following the advent of AI.

Such deals have shifted towards AI-driven digital transformation, vendor consolidation and efficiency improvement projects.

Moreover, converting deals into revenue has been a major challenge for most firms.

Over the past three weeks, India's top five IT majors reported nearly $20 billion in deal bookings, less than the $22 billion reported by Ireland-based Accenture, the world's largest IT services firm. Infosys, the second-largest IT firm, reported the highest deal wins, at $5.2 billion, including one worth over $2 billion.

Cognizant, which has over 70% of its employees in India, will report its earnings on October 29.

The US-headquartered company's deal with EBRD will support the bank's technology transformation programme, driving innovation through digitally enabled processes involving AI, data and automation, Cognizant said in a statement.

Under the five-year framework, Cognizant aims to deliver critical technology services through two complementary models: outcome-led managed services and fixed-capacity services. These will span digital and workplace management, cloud infrastructure, data and security, software engineering, automation and AI.

The framework also includes a programme of continuous improvement and innovation designed to enhance services, strengthen resilience and deliver measurable value over time, it added.

"As an AI Builder, Cognizant's role is to help clients turn their technology investments into dependable operations and measurable outcomes, and that only happens when services are made to work across the complexity of a real enterprise estate," said Rohit Gupta, managing director for the UK and Ireland at Cognizant.

"The EBRD operates in a demanding, highly governed environment across three continents. By combining our decades of industry experience, end-to-end systems integration expertise, and AI-enabled operational capabilities within a collaborative framework, we will help the EBRD run its critical technology services with confidence and accelerate the modernisation and innovation that drive its mission," Gupta added.

Jakson Group to Invest ₹6.8k cr in Andhra Plant

Project in Kurnool will produce 10 GW of ingots and wafers and 5 GW of solar cells

Nidhi Sharma

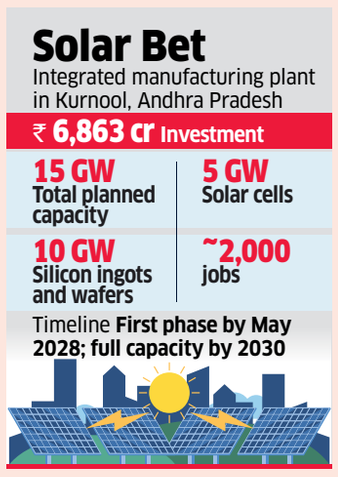
New Delhi: Jakson Group, one of India's largest solar module manufacturers, plans to invest ₹6,863 crore in an integrated solar manufacturing plant in Andhra Pradesh's Kurnool district to produce 10 GW of silicon ingots and wafers and 5 GW of solar cells.

The Noida-based group will set up the plant at Meedivemula village in Orvakal mandal. According to sources, the State Investment Promotion Board (SIPB), led by Andhra Pradesh chief minister N Chandrababu Naidu, has recommended allotting 290 acres to Jakson Integrated Solar for the project.

The plant will be developed in three phases and employ about 2,000 people. The first phase, with capacity for 3 GW of ingots and wafers and 3 GW of solar cells, is targeted to begin commercial production in May 2028. The remaining capacity is scheduled to come on stream by 2030.

Jakson, which operates a 1.2 GW module plant in Greater Noida, will move further up the value chain with the project.

Andhra Pradesh's Integrated Clean Energy Policy, 2024, targets 20 GW of solar manufacturing capacity across the value chain. The state has already surpassed that target. According to SIPB papers, approved projects, excluding Jakson's, account for 58.74 GW of cell and module capacity and 48 GW of ingot and wafer capacity.



"Andhra Pradesh is committed to building a world-class solar manufacturing ecosystem, backed by cutting-edge research, innovation and a highly skilled workforce," said Andhra Pradesh HRD, IT and electronics minister Nara Lokesh. "Our ambition is to make Andhra Pradesh a leading hub for advanced solar manufacturing and clean-energy technologies."

Several major industry players are investing in renewable energy projects in Andhra Pradesh. ReNew Energy Global began work in April on a ₹4,200 crore, 6.5 GW ingot and wafer plant at Rambilli in Anakapalli district, part of its ₹82,000 crore commitment to the state.

In Kurnool, the state has approved Agastya Green Energy's ₹7,799.96 crore, 12 GW ingot and wafer plant at Orvakal. Indosol Solar is building a polysilicon-to-module complex in Prakasam district, with a planned investment of about ₹69,000 crore.

On September 21, Premier Energies commissioned a 7 GW N-type TOPCon solar cell plant at Naidupeta, built at a cost of ₹3,293 crore. The company describes it as India's largest solar cell plant. The facility takes Premier's total solar cell capacity to 10.6 GW.

In August, the state's Centre of Excellence for Energy Transition, IIT Tirupati and the University of New South Wales (UNSW), Sydney, agreed to set up a Centre of Excellence for Solar Manufacturing at IIT Tirupati. UNSW will design courses on cell manufacturing, ingot making and wafering.

Sports World Play

VITALS

3RD T20I: INDIA VS NEW ZEALAND

India Eye Series Win

Wellington: Canny Bhuvneshwar Kumar and consistent Arshdeep Singh will have their task cut out India eye a series-clinching win in the third T20I against New Zealand on Tuesday to continue an unbeaten run that dates back to 2020. Ahead of the third T20I, the Indian team will not just be worried about New Zealand bouncing back but also about the wind that traverses the Basin Reserve Ground, which is open from three sides. **PTI**

12:30pm | Sony Ten, SonyLIV

IPL Auction on Dec 16

The IPL's 2027 mini-auction will be held in Goa on December 16, the same day as the second ODI between India and Sri Lanka in Bengaluru, ESPNcricinfo reported. The November 15 retention deadline gives franchises a month to finalise their plans before the IPL circulates the registered player pool for shortlisting. Only two trades have taken place since the 2026 season ended. The trade window will remain open until a week before the auction. **Agencies**

ASIAN CHAMPIONS TROPHY

Hockey Returns to Punjab

Jalandhar: Five-time champions India will be overwhelming favourites to win the six-nation Asian Champions Trophy when the tournament begins on Tuesday, with the hosts opening their campaign against Bangladesh. The tournament marks the return of international hockey to Punjab after 17 years. The last international hockey tournament held in Punjab was the Gold Cup in 2009. **PTI**

WATCHOUT! Today

Malaysia vs China 1pm; **Japan vs South Korea** 3:15pm; **India vs Bangladesh** 7pm (Star Sports, JioHotstar)

A Lamine ntable Night

El Clasico Yamal misses a golden chance and Mbappe strikes twice as Madrid end Barca's winning run

Joseph Wilson

Lamine Yamal slid to his back, his hands covering his face. The 19-year-old Barcelona phenom is so used to winning, and playing so spectacularly well, that he seemed the most awe-struck of all the 60,000-plus at Camp Nou when he missed a chance like few others against Real Madrid on Sunday.

Yamal's close-range miss late in the first half summed up a frustrating clasico for Barcelona, which ended in a 2-1 defeat at the hands of Real Madrid.

Kylian Mbappé scored twice for Madrid to give Jose Mourinho a victory in his first game at Camp Nou since returning to coach Barcelona's fiercest rival.

FIRST GOAL

Madrid had fortune on their side in the 41st minute when Mbappé's first goal was part chance, part being in the right place. Barca defender Gerard Martin tried to clear a cross by Yan Diomande. But his low, horizontal clearance hit Mbappé and ricocheted into the net.

Yamal then missed his golden opportunity to quickly pull Barcelona level before halftime.

Fermin Lopez found him all alone streaking into the area. But Yamal, who arguably has the fanciest feet in football right now, flubbed his shot from near the corner of the six-yard box, sending his shot well wide of the post.

And this from a player who has made scoring incredibly difficult goals look easy. After having helped Spain win the World Cup in the summer, Yamal has 10 goals and 10 assists across La Liga and Champions League, plus another four goals for Spain, already this campaign.

It was that kind of night for Barcelona.

Raphinha leveled in the 61st when he received a pass from Pedri and fired a shot between the legs of Jude Bellingham for a league-leading 13th goal. But the wide-open game swung Madrid's way for good in the 87th when substitute Eduardo Camavinga ran down a long ball, drew goalkeeper Joan Garcia off his line and passed for Mbappé to tap home.

BREAKUP: HOW MBAPPÉ REACHED 100 GOALS FOR REAL MADRID

67	La Liga
25	Champions League
4	Copa del Rey
2	Club World Cup
1	UEFA Super Cup
1	Spanish Super Cup

WINNING RUN ENDS

Instead of breaking La Liga's all-time record for the best start to a season with a 10th consecutive win, Barcelona endured a second straight loss in all competitions after also losing 4-2 at Paris Saint-Germain in the Champions League. Barcelona had already tied the record of nine straight wins at the start of the season in La Liga established by Madrid in 1968-69.

Making it worse for Barca was the man celebrating in Madrid's dugout: Jose Mourinho, who fell down and pumped his fist after Mbappé's winner. Mourinho is widely disliked by Barcelona's fans for his previous spell with Madrid from 2010-13 when he engaged in memorable tactical and verbal duels with then coach Pep Guardiola. **AP**

Kimi Wins in Austin, But Must Wait for Title

The Mercedes driver needs only two points in Mexico to secure championship

Alan Baldwin

Austin: Kimi Antonelli delivered a dominant US Grand Prix victory for Mercedes on Sunday to stand on the brink of becoming Formula One's youngest ever champion with four rounds to spare in Mexico next weekend.

The 20-year-old Italian did all he could to put the championship out of reach of his rivals in Texas but Ferrari's Lewis Hamilton and Mercedes teammate George Russell did just enough to delay the inevitable with fourth and eighth respectively.

Antonelli now needs to score only two points — a ninth place — in Mexico City to be sure of the title even if Russell wins.

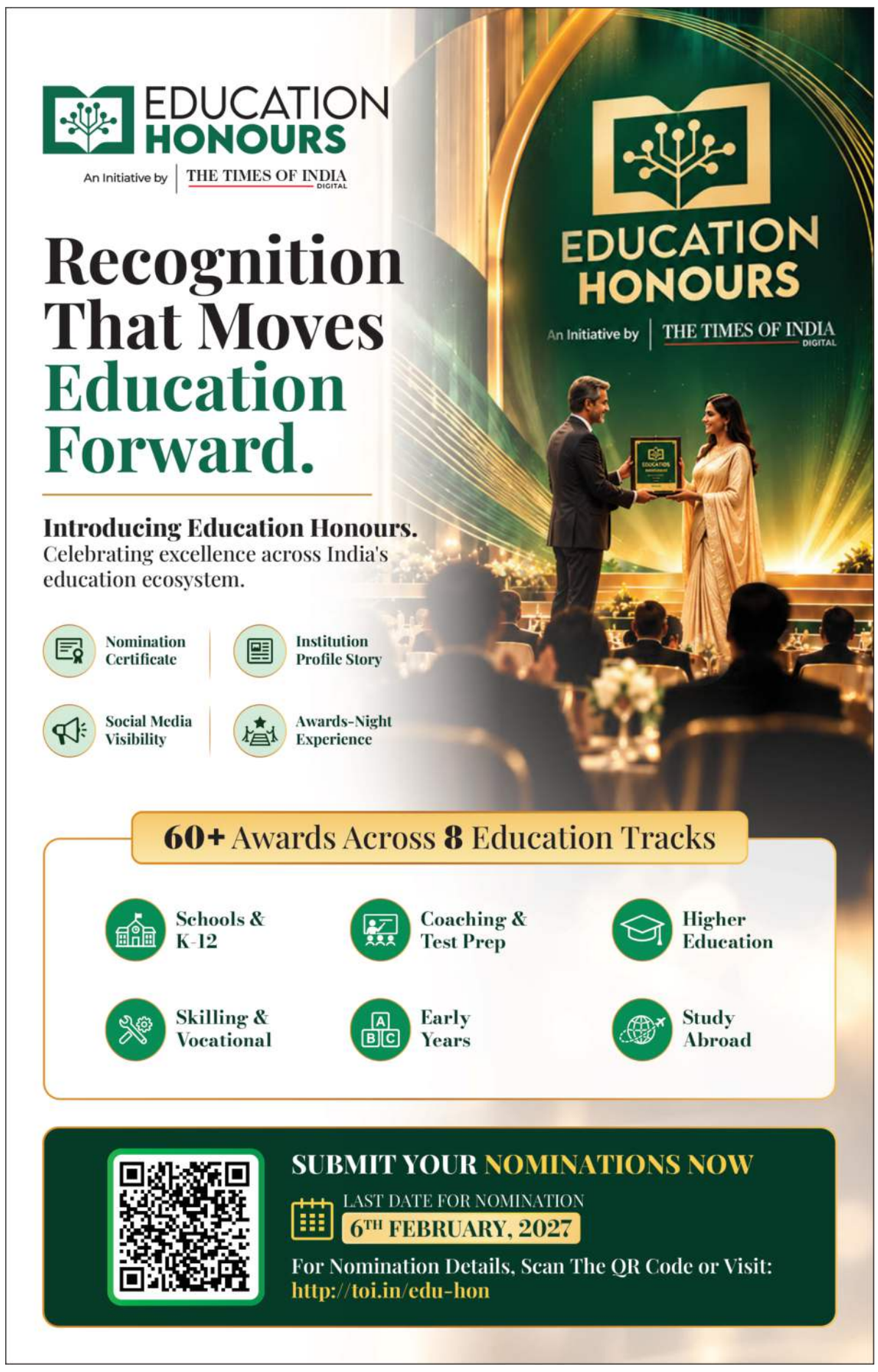
"It was the result we needed and the whole team deserve it so much," he said of his first win since Spain last month.

"I know we're very close. We try to finish on a high and hopefully we can clinch it very soon".

Antonelli leads Russell by 123 points and Hamilton by 124 with 125 still available

Ferrari's Charles Leclerc finished second, 13.078 seconds behind, in Sunday's race at Austin's Circuit of the Americas with Red Bull's Max Verstappen third and helped by a late virtual safety car that slowed a chasing Hamilton who finished one second down the road.

The win from pole position on a one-stop strategy was Antonelli's ninth in of the season and he now leads Russell by 123 points, and Hamilton by 124 with a maximum 125 remaining to be won and that reducing to 100 after Mexico. "The main headline is that for me (it is) the best race he's delivered so far," said Mercedes team boss Toto Wolff. **Reuters**



Prevention CERT-In ly Better Than Cure

Cyber threat detection needs an overhaul

India has responded adequately to last week's eMudhra digital certificate lapse and global PHP vulnerabilities through government advisories, industry audits and a high-level official probe. CERT-In flagged both incidents. MeitY confirmed that eMudhra's domestic digital signature certificates were unaffected. The ministry has ordered a probe into the eMudhra key generation failure. Banks and gov departments audited their systems for vulnerabilities and took action to prevent breaches. Critical vulnerabilities in PHP, a programming language used on the internet, are being addressed.

India faces a high degree of cybersecurity risk because of the scale of its digital transformation, legacy framework gaps and the emergence of AI-driven attack vectors. A large part of the country's digital infra is built with open-source software. The foundations of secure online commerce are also not free of risk, as the eMudhra episode shows. Tests have shown that misconfigurations in third-party connections for the India Stack, including Aadhaar, allow authentication checks to be bypassed. AI can now exploit infrastructure weaknesses at high speed, rendering rapid responses less effective in countering a security attack.

India must move away from its reactive model of cybersecurity towards building threat detection-capabilities. CERT-In must get ahead of the curve. There are concerns that budgeted funds for improving cybersecurity remain unutilised and that the country faces a talent shortage. A holistic transformation of cybersecurity requires modern regulations, upgraded defences and a larger workforce. Software must be built securely by design, and risk-based controls should be in place for critical sectors like energy, health, transport and telecom. The emphasis must shift away from GoI acting alone towards better coordination with states and multilateral agencies. Adequate response is one dimension of cybersecurity. India needs to improve its handling of other dimensions too.

Lula's Extra Time Goal Sends a Signal

The Amazon and Earth should be relieved, as Luiz Inácio Lula da Silva, a.k.a. Lula, pulled back from first-round defeat to become Brazilian president for a record 4th term. Monday's result demonstrated the deep discontent among the electorate. The Lula government's failure to tame rising cost of living and crime, along with charges of corruption against the president, essayed the serious challenge from Flávio Bolsonaro, whose 'tough guy' campaign focused on tackling public security and crime. But the pendulum may have swung too far for the challenger, whom Trump had marked as his 'preferred candidate' — and, thereby, may have spooked many conservative Brazilians. Lula, on his part, reached out extra to the young — he even finally got a smartphone — and highlighted the natural resource asset-stripping a Bolsonaro administration would have supposedly heralded.

Having pulled off this close win, though, governing will be tricky. Lula has to navigate a polarised country to tackle critical challenges like soaring deficit that neared 10% of GDP in the year running up to June 2026, 82% public debt, high inflation and interest rates. Fixing Brazil's economy will be an uphill task for the Leftist Workers' Party government.

While the presidency has eluded Bolsonaro, his Liberal Party and allies have the majority in the senate and chamber of deputies. This makes it possible for Brazil's right-wing coalition to block legislation the new government may propose to mitigate economic duress. Even with the defeat of Aleksandar Vucic in the Serbian elections the same day, it would be too early to see Lula's win as a signal against authoritarian, strongmen rule worldwide. But Brazil has certainly shown that it's no longer in the realm of wishful thinking.

JUST IN JEST

Most startups find scaling up into a mature company a horrifying prospect

The Ultimate Peter Pan Industry

The startup industry has a peculiar relationship with age. Like a 65-yr-old sporting ripped jeans, hair implants and a skateboard, most startups make it their mission to never scale up. Maturity is considered an embarrassment best concealed beneath hipster jargon. Ostensibly, they exist to one day become established businesses. Yet, the prospect is horrifying. An established business must generate profits, pay dividends, maintain departments and employ entities like regional sales managers. A startup, instead, has a runway, burn rate, chief happiness officer and an inspirational founder who describes selling groceries as revolutionising nourishment.

The economics favour prolonged adolescence. A company losing ₹500 mn annually may command a valuation of ₹50 bn because it possesses enormous potential. The same company turning profitable risks becoming a 'dull enterprise' whose worth can be calculated using arithmetic. Nothing destroys financial romance quite like actual earnings. The ideal startup is perpetually scaling, never scaled, like a forever receding Mt Everest. Perhaps startup status should be treated like youth: a temporary privilege, not a lifelong entitlement. But that would require admitting that growing older is preferable to dying young. It seems, even bankruptcy is less humiliating than becoming a respectable company.

Nov 3 will be more a referendum on Trump's performance, less a fight between candidates

Trumpism's Midterm Crisis?

Seema Sirohi

LETTER FROM WASHINGTON

A week after Lula's 'comeback' election victory in Brazil — beating Donald Trump's preferred candidate Flávio Bolsonaro — and Israel's parliamentary elections on Tuesday, where Benjamin Netanyahu, Trump's instigator-in-chief on Iran, faces a critical test of his prime ministership, the US goes to midterm polls.

Trump is not on the ballot in the congressional midterms, but he might as well be. The Nov 3 vote will be more a referendum on his performance and less a traditional fight between candidates.

Key issues affecting voters — the Iran war, high gas prices, aftermath of tariff mania, naked corruption, data centres and harsh tactics against immigrants — are directly related to Trump's decisions. A deteriorating political and economic landscape at home, and debris of shattered relationships abroad, make for a difficult scenario for Republicans.

The Cook Political Report, a non-partisan and respected forecaster, called Trump 'a drag across the board even in deep red states due to rising fuel prices and persistent high cost of living'. The question isn't whether Democrats will gain seats but how many, wrote editor Jessica Taylor, in an overly optimistic take.

Dems are hopeful but not Pollyannaish. A senior official told me: 'Voters face a choice: reward the party that rubber-stamped Trump's tariffs, backed his war and enabled his friends to cash in on his presidency, or vote for a party focused on making life more affordable and checking Trump. Polls show voters see that's at stake.'

With exactly a week to go before the vote, and an unprecedented amount of money flooding the electoral landscape, scales can tip more than once. Polls have been wrong before, and underestimating Trump's appeal among diehard MAGA supporters and conservative Christians would be folly.

The world's wealthiest man and Trump's close friend, Elon Musk, is pouring money as if there won't be another election. He is the largest individual donor in US history — he has given $445 mn to various Republican-aligned political action committees (PACs), to say nothing of undisclosed donations.

That he wants the system to keep rewarding his companies with federal contracts at home and protect his interests abroad (did anyone say China?) couldn't be clearer. Muskian generosity has given the Republican Party a massive financial advantage over Democrats. They can flood airwaves with ads and pay workers to knock on doors in battleground states.

Musk's focus is Texas, a state to which he is shifting his business empire from California. It's also the site of one of the most-watched, most expensive, high-stakes senate races. Controversial former attorney-general Ken Paxton, a Republican, is up against Democrat James Talarico. Paxton has been accused of adultery, bribery and abuse of public office. But when you have Musk as a shield, the past disappears.

The Tesla boss has given $158 mn to a senate PAC that landed in a Texas PAC, which turned out to be the largest contributor to Paxton's campaign. Talarico warned that Paxton would be Musk's 'personal senator'. Can that stick? Breaching Texas has been the Democrats' relentless dream, their white whale for years. But whether Talarico can win against big money is unclear.

Texas is not the only game in town. Deep red Kansas has become a 'toss-up' state, raising prospects for Dems in a state where no Democrat has won a senate seat since 1932. The Cook Political Report also changed its forecast in New Hampshire and North Carolina to 'lean Democrat' and 'likely Democrat', adding that a senate majority is within Democrats' sights.

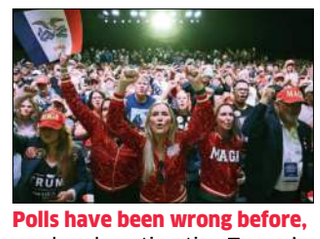
The big picture: midterms will cover all 435 seats in the House of Representatives, where Republicans currently have a slim majority, and 33 of the 100 seats in the senate, where they also hold sway with 53 seats. House members serve a 2-yr term while senators have a 6-yr run.

Voters are reeling while Trump continues to talk of a 'new golden age' and a booming economy, inviting contempt on the internet. Nearly 70% of voters say cost-of-living issues are their biggest economic worry, with groceries and gas prices going up instead of down, despite Trump's endless tactics with Iran and Russia to control oil flows and procure diesel. Americans sound as gloomy about the economy as they were after the pandemic.

No surprise that Republicans in close races are busy creating distance from Trump, barely mentioning him or his exaggerated claims. Some of them have acknowledged hardship in their ads and personal appearances. Of course, they blame the liberals, not the president.

Yes, the Red Wall in places like Kansas is weakening, and talk of a Blue Wave washing over the rust belt is getting louder. Trump's popularity is hovering in the low-30s, and voter anger against the Iran war is palpable. He is trying to change the subject, but that doesn't change reality.

PS: Then there's the whole thing about Trump challenging election results.



Polls have been wrong before, and underestimating Trump's appeal among diehard MAGA supporters and conservative Christians would be folly

One helluva sideshow

Musk is the largest individual donor in US history – he has given $445 mn to various Republican-aligned PACs, to say nothing of undisclosed donations

Sat 'BOOM!'s of the Bust Kind

Madhavan Narayanan

As Jio Platforms courts a promising IPO amid Reliance Group's plan to launch a satellite venture, it's heartening to see Mukesh Ambani welcome foreign competition from the likes of Elon Musk's Starlink, making for a nice headline-grabbing clash of billionaires. But the game has not even begun.

On paper, both Jio and telecom rival Bharti Airtel have interesting plans largely still in the works. Reliance Jio plans to deploy a sovereign low-Earth-orbit (LEO) network of about 1,600 satellites and 23 Earth stations in India to connect 6 lakh villages, besides remote islands. The venture is estimated to cost $10-15 bn.

Bharti, through its investor status in Eutelsat OneWeb and JV with Hughes Communications, plans to take on Jio with a 635-LEO satellite network, and also has a corporate partnership with Musk's SpaceX, Starlink's parent.

As regulators grapple over what to do, Musk's recent tweets on X have triggered a new storm, especially in the double backdrop of Jio Platforms' IPO and lingering worries on a 'forever-expected' US-India trade deal. Marco Rubio's India visit, that included a high-visibility engagement at Reliance's Jamnagar refinery, only sends a subtle signal: Ambani can engage the Trump regime at least as much as Musk can.

But a bit of financial flashback beyond the optics helps. India's original commercial space venture, Isro-owned Antrix Corp, is bleeding from a messy corporate divorce with Devas Multimedia, which has featured an ugly mix of allegations of political corruption, faulty regulation and legal obligations after CBI and ED formally launched criminal and financial investigations into the JV in 2015.

Though Indian courts have upheld

A timely heads up

fraud in Antrix, in August 2025, Devas and its foreign investors won $1.2 bn in an arbitral award, with an interest burden of $2 bn. The case is not yet over.

Going further back, in 1999, there was much publicity of Iridium, an ambitious US satellite venture with a catchy slogan, 'Geography is history'. Those became famous last words since Iridium itself became history — as did, for all practical purposes, its parent Motorola, since then reduced from a global telecom star to a handset brand owned by China's Lenovo since 2014.

Iridium, which was betting on LEO satellites, went bankrupt. It's now being reincarnated in a second-generation constellation acquired this June by Long Beach, California-headquartered Rocket Lab in a $8 bn deal. Rocket Lab plans to take on SpaceX in a new twist to the old tale of failure.

SpaceX raised about $86 bn in the world's largest IPO this June. But it's sitting on an estimated long-term debt burden of $29 bn, of which $25 bn came from a recent issue of bonds. For the record, Jio's current debt burden is just over $1 bn. Unless it has an ace up its sleeve, it would incur a fresh debt burden.

All these past ventures and adventures should provide enough caveats for entrepreneurs and policymakers. Starlink charges $50-120 (~₹4,700-11,000) a month for home users, amounts Indian homes are unlikely to pay, with additional hardware costs.

Where does all that leave security hawks, policymakers, Trai and banks that may be wooed to fund satcom? We don't know. But we must know that there is a minefield in the skies.

The writer is an independent journalist

Who Watches Yes Man's Watchman?

Sanjay Sinha

Supreme Court's Oct 15 judgment in the Yes Bank AT-1 bond case raises a question beyond the fate of ₹8,415 cr of investors' money: when an administrator's decision is held unlawful, who examines the decision-maker's conduct, and under what legal framework? The court upheld Bombay High Court's decision setting aside the permanent write-down of the bonds. Appeals by Yes Bank, RBI and Union of India were dismissed.

The judgment settles the legality of the write-down. But institutional accountability requires examining not only the decision but also the circumstances in which it was made.

Yes Bank issued AT-1 bonds worth ₹3,000 cr in December 2016, and ₹5,415 cr in October 2017. On March 5, 2020, following the imposition of a moratorium, RBI superseded the bank's board and appointed Prashant Kumar as administrator under Section 36ACA of Banking Regulation Act 1949.

The draft reconstruction scheme, published on March 6, included a permanent write-down provision. Following objections from investors and the trustee, the final scheme notified on March 13 omitted it. A proposal to convert the bonds into equity was also not incorporated. Nevertheless, on March 14, the administrator ordered the permanent write-down.

The top court found that the omission of the write-down provision from the final scheme to be *deliberate*. It concluded that the administrator acted under the mistaken belief that he retained the authority to write down the bonds. His action was impermissible and 'ultra vires' — beyond the powers of — the applicable master circular read with the final scheme.

The apex court also distinguished between the bank's own contractual trigger and RBI's regulatory point-of-non-viability trigger. The administrator could not assume RBI's regulatory role.

The court described the handling of the matter by RBI, the administrator and Yes Bank as 'questionable', observing that the avoidable risk to investors could have been prevented. It also noted that Yes Bank had directly sold AT-1 instruments to individual investors, contrary to the applicable regulatory framework.

Section 36ACA provides for RBI to appoint an administrator in consultation with GoI. It also empowers RBI to issue directions that the administrator must follow. The latter assumes the powers, functions and duties of the bank's board until its reconstitution.

The provision does not itself prescribe a comprehensive disciplinary procedure or penalty scale for an administrator who acts beyond his authority. The applicable framework — including terms of appointment and relevant statutory, contractual or service provisions — therefore, requires examination by RBI.

Having appointed the administrator and being empowered to issue directions under Section 36ACA, RBI is well placed to establish what legal framework governs his conduct, and whether circumstances warrant further action. This does not presume either that misconduct has been established, or that RBI necessarily has exclusive disciplinary jurisdiction.

In 'Disciplinary Authority-cum-Regional Manager v. Nikunja Bihari Patnaik' (1996), Supreme Court considered disciplinary action against a Scale-I officer of Central Bank of India who, as branch manager of its Paradeep branch in Odisha, repeatedly sanctioned advances, and permitted overdrafts beyond his delegated authority.

The high court had set aside his dismissal. But the top court restored it, holding that exceeding delegated authority could constitute misconduct under the applicable service regulations, even without proof of ulterior motive or loss in every transaction.

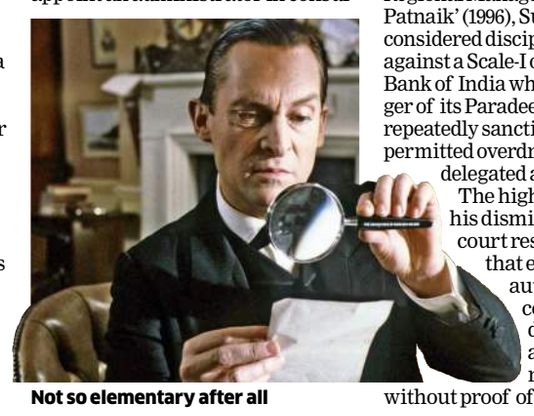
The legal framework and facts differ from those of the Yes Bank administrator. Nevertheless, the case illustrates an important principle: authority must be exercised within prescribed limits, and conduct must be assessed under the rules governing the office. RBI's review should consider asking the following questions:

- Did the administrator understand that the final scheme omitted the write-down provision?
- What legal advice or verification of authority preceded the order?
- Why was the order issued a day after notification of the final scheme?
- What legal or disciplinary framework applies when an administrator's decision is found to exceed his authority?

These questions do not prejudge answers. They identify matters deserving scrutiny considering the court's findings. RBI should examine circumstances surrounding the write-down, the terms governing the administrator's appointment, and the legal framework applicable to his conduct. It should then determine, on evidence and under applicable law, whether further action is warranted and through what process.

Financial rescues may require swift and extraordinary decisions. But urgency cannot substitute for legal authority. Correcting an unlawful decision is necessary. Examining how it occurred and whether accountability is warranted is an equally important institutional responsibility.

The writer is former MD-CEO, Axis Trustee Services



Not so elementary after all

THE SPEAKING TREE

Of Truth And Lies

NAJIB SHAH

Durga Puja and Dussehra both emphasise the triumph of Truth. But we have not learnt those lessons, for most people tell lies. Some more, some less. As Emmanuel Kant pointed out, lies work only because truth is still being told; or, in other words, if lying became universal, then nobody would believe anybody. Sissela Bok highlights that trust is a collective good that every lie depletes, even when the individual lie seems harmless or well-intentioned.

This explains the cynicism enveloping society today: so much untruth has pushed people from believing everything until the contrary is learnt to disbelieving everything until the contrary is learnt. Lying takes a toll on our emotional health, and we twist ourselves into knots telling lies to cover up lies.

Every religion frowns upon untruthfulness. Hinduism speaks of satya as a supreme moral duty. Buddhism requires adherents to abstain from false speech. The Bible views truthfulness as a core reflection of God. Islam calls honesty a foundational virtue.

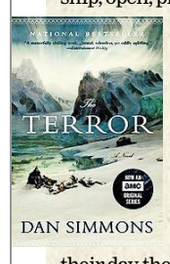
The Torah expects the believer to distance himself from a false word. Religion permits exceptions in exceptional circumstances. Kant, however, points out that the moment you permit exceptions, truthfulness stops being a duty and becomes a matter of convenience. He believes that lying is wrong even when a murderer asks, 'Where is your friend hiding?' As Gandhiji said, Truth is God, and once truthfulness becomes a matter of convenience, we lose faith in God.

Once you make telling the truth a habit, telling a lie becomes difficult. Conversely, once lying becomes a habit, truth becomes the exception.

PARANORMAL ACTIVITY
Paragraphs From Fiction

The Terror

Dan Simmons



Captain Crozier comes up on deck to find his ship under attack by celestial ghosts. Above him — above *Terror* — shimmering folds of light lunge but then quickly withdraw like the colourful arms of aggressive but ultimately uncertain spectres. Ectoplasmic skeletal fingers extend toward the ship, open, prepare to grasp, and pull back.

The temperature is –50 degrees Fahrenheit and dropping fast. Because of the fog that came through earlier, during the single hour of weak twilight now passing for their day, the foreshortened masts… stand now like rudely pruned and topless trees reflecting the aurora that dances from one dimly seen horizon to the other.

As Crozier watches, the jagged ice fields around the ship turn blue, then bleed violet, then glow as green as the hills of his childhood in Northern Ireland. Almost a mile off the starboard bow, the gigantic floating ice mountain that hides *Terror*'s sister ship, Erebus, from view seems for a brief, false moment to radiate colour from within, glowing from its own cold, internal fires.

Chat Room

It's Lunchtime for PSB Governance

Apropos 'Don't Bank on RBI Alone' by Ajay Tyagi (Oct 26), one wonders why government as the majority stakeholder in PSBs is absolved of corporate governance mandates as defined in the Companies Act. When all PSB operations mirror those of the private banks, their governance by special statutes surely makes the playing field uneven for the private banks. PSBs having different rules or exemptions regarding the mandated ratio of independent directors is unfair to all the shareholders other than GoI. Ideally, with a controlling stake, GoI can still align with all the Sebi norms without diluting the concerns, if any, and can advocate the necessary reforms in one of the most critical and visible sectors of the Indian economy that touches nearly every Indian adult citizen.

Prasad Ambadas Kulkarni
Independence Director
Mumbai

Unincorporated Sector Survey To Widen Net

Our Bureau

New Delhi: The government has proposed adding questions on challenges faced by women entrepreneurs, electricity sources and fixed-asset investments to the Annual Survey of Unincorporated Sector Enterprises (ASUSE) 2027-28. The survey will also include provisions to identify handloom, powerloom and handicraft establishments, the statistics ministry said on Monday. The survey will shift from the calendar year to the financial year, with the next round proposed to run from April 2027 to March 2028.

For the first time, the survey will capture gender-specific constraints faced by female entrepreneurs

The changes aim to address emerging data needs and improve the availability of policy-relevant data on India's unincorporated economy. "The change is intended to align the reference period of the survey with the financial year, as is done in other enterprise surveys like Annual Survey of Industries (ASI), Annual Survey of Incorporated Services Sector Enterprises (ASISSE), and enhance the utility of ASUSE data for National Accounts purposes," the ministry said in a statement.

For the first time, the survey will capture gender-specific constraints faced by female entrepreneurs in operating and managing their establishments. The data is expected to inform policy discussions on women's participation in economic activity.

MARKDOWN SHOWS 27% DECLINE SINCE JANUARY

Dailyhunt Parent Value Cut by 90% on Revenue Blues

Baillie Gifford fund pegs VerSe valuation at $576 million against peak of $5 billion in 2022

Nikhil Patwardhan

Bengaluru: A fund managed by British investment firm Baillie Gifford has slashed the fair value of news aggregator platform Dailyhunt's Bengaluru-based parent company, VerSe Innovation, by nearly 90% to about $576 million as of August 31, compared to its peak valuation of $5 billion in 2022.

The Schiehallion Fund pegged the fair value of its 1.3% holding in VerSe Innovation at $7.47 million, according to its portfolio disclosures reviewed by **ET**, implying a total company valuation of roughly $576 million.

The markdown signifies a 27% decline since January and almost an 80% slide in 19 months, as per the disclosures. This is an extrapolation from the fund's investment mark rather than a price established through a fresh funding transaction.

"Baillie Gifford aims to hold its private company investments at 'fair value', that is the price that would be paid in an open-market transaction," a spokesperson for the fund said. "Valuations are adjusted both during regular valuation cycles and on an ad hoc basis in response to 'trigger events'. These may include changes in fundamentals, a takeover approach, an intention to carry out an initial public offering, or changes to the valuation of comparable public companies."

VerSe Innovation's consolidated operating revenue fell 40% to ₹1,162 crore in 2025-26 from ₹1,930 crore a year earlier, according to its latest financial statements. The decline follows an 88% surge in 2024-25, when acquisitions including Magzter and Valueleaf helped lift reported revenue.

Its consolidated net loss narrowed 28% to ₹699 crore from ₹976 crore, as total expenses fell 36% to ₹1,946 crore from ₹3,042 crore. Cash, other bank balances and current investments together declined 46% to ₹410 crore as of March 31, from ₹755 crore a year earlier.

Crossover funds such as Baillie Gifford, which invest in both public and private companies, periodically review the value of their portfolio holdings. The fair value of private companies is determined using several factors, including operating performance, macroeconomic conditions and the market performance of comparable listed peers.

The markdown comes against the backdrop of VerSe Innovation facing pressure on two revenue streams – advertising on its own platforms and campaigns handled by Valueleaf, the performance-marketing business it acquired to expand beyond Dailyhunt and short-video app Josh – according to people with knowledge of the matter.

The strain on advertising and livestreaming comes as competition for regional-language viewers intensifies

"Dailyhunt (VerSe Innovation) faced operational pressures in 2025, with operating revenue reported to have declined and a sharper focus on cost control and reducing burn as it tried to stabilise the business. These developments led to valuation reductions during the year," Schiehallion Fund said in its annual report for the year ended January 31.

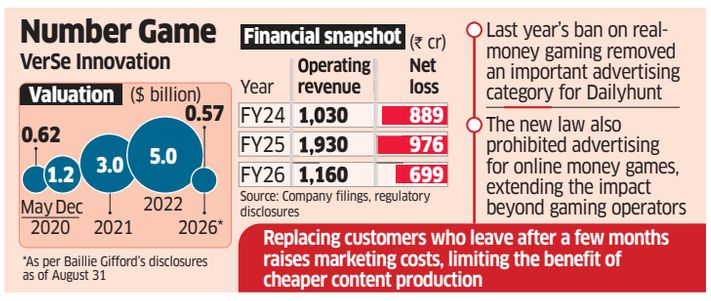
The spokesperson for the fund said that for Dailyhunt (VerSe Innovation), the difference was an output of Baillie Gifford's valuation process. The detractors for Schiehallion Fund reflected a mix of company-specific execution challenges and the market's repricing of relevant public comparables. These developments led to valuation reductions during the year, the fund said in its 2026 annual report.

Last year's ban on real-money gaming removed an important advertising category for Dailyhunt. Valueleaf's growth also slowed largely because of the ban, weakening a business VerSe Innovation had bought in August 2024 to support growth, the people said. The new law also prohibited advertising for online money games, extending the impact beyond gaming operators.

"The gaming ban affects both advertising on Dailyhunt and campaigns handled by Valueleaf. The acquisition broadened VerSe's revenue base, but it did not remove its exposure to advertising demand. Losing livestreaming revenue at the same time makes replacing that income harder," an investor tracking the segment said on condition of anonymity.

At the time it acquired Valueleaf, VerSe Innovation expected the deal to help generate an additional $100 million in revenue. The business brought access to advertising inventory across more than 50,000 websites and 1,000 apps, with gaming, financial services and ecommerce clients.

FOR FULL REPORT, GO TO www.economictimes.com



Gold Rises ₹200 per 10 gm on Recovery in Global Prices

NEW DELHI Gold prices rose ₹200 to ₹1,46,300 per 10 grams in the national capital on Monday, supported by a weaker rupee and a modest recovery in overseas markets. The yellow metal of 99.9% purity closed at ₹1,46,100 per 10 grams on Friday. Silver remained unchanged at ₹2,02,000 per kilogram, inclusive of all taxes, after three consecutive sessions of losses. **PTI**

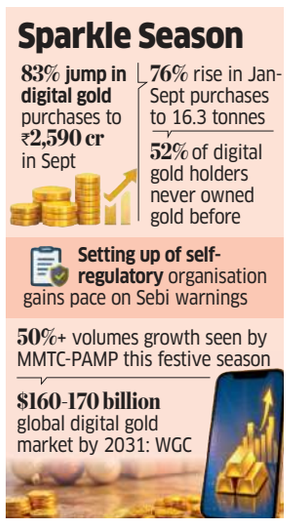
Digital Gold Rush Continues, Purchases Surge 83% in a Year

First-time buyers and UPI-led transactions help propel buying to record levels

Sutanuka Ghosal

Kolkata: Purchase of digital gold rose 83% from a year earlier to ₹2,590 crore in September, as investors turned to small-ticket investments in the yellow metal despite elevated prices.

According to the World Gold Council (WGC), September purchases rose 4% from August while volumes touched 1.7 tonnes, 18% above the long-term monthly average. In January-September, digital gold purchases climbed 76% to 16.3 tonnes from 9.2 tonnes in the corresponding period last year, reflecting growing appetite for accessible gold investments.



Digital gold allows consumers to buy the metal online in small amounts through apps and digital platforms, with the purchased quantity recorded against their account. Depending on the provider, the gold is backed by physical metal held in secure vaults and can be sold online or redeemed as coins and bars.

The low entry barrier and convenience of app-based purchases made it an increasingly popular alternative to buying physical jewellery or coins.

The growth, however, comes with regulatory concerns. The Securities and Exchange Board of India cautioned investors in November last year that digital gold products offered by online platforms do not fall under its regulatory framework for securities and commodity derivatives and therefore do not carry investor protections associated with regulated products. The industry is consequently working towards a self-regulatory framework to establish standards for custody, transparency, disclosures and consumer protection.

"The World Gold Council's new report values the global digital gold market at $45-55 billion, less than 1% of the roughly $13 trillion physical investment gold market. Its base case projects around 27% compound annual growth to $160-170 billion by 2031, with latent demand potentially reaching $700 billion if barriers around trust, access, utility and pricing are addressed," said Samit Guha, managing director of MMTC-PAMP, a gold-refining company that offers digital gold.

The company expects digital gold volumes during the Dhanteras-Diwali season to grow by more than 50% from last year. "We see the same pattern among our customers: small-ticket, UPI-led purchases and a growing share of younger, first-time buyers, with volumes up 70% from Q2 FY26 to Q2 FY27," Guha said.

MMTC-PAMP is running festive campaigns with systematic investment plans starting at ₹10.

Renisha Chainani, chief research officer at Augmont, which also offers digital gold, said digital gold was fast becoming an entry point into the yellow metal for Indian consumers.

WGC data showed that 52% of digital gold holders had never owned gold before, underlining the product's potential to widen participation.

I-T Nudges Taxpayers to Take FAST-DS Lane

Our Bureau

New Delhi: The Income-Tax Department has begun nudging select taxpayers holding residential and commercial properties in UAE and other countries to disclose their overseas assets under a one-time scheme, as it steps up efforts to bring undeclared foreign wealth into the tax net, officials said. Around 1,100 taxpayers have filed applications under the Foreign Assets of Small Taxpayers–Disclosure Scheme, 2026 (FAST-DS), which allows eligible taxpayers to regularise undisclosed foreign assets and income until December 31, officials said.

The department is also looking to widen the information available to taxpayers to encourage voluntary disclosures by allowing taxpayers to download details of foreign assets reported against their Permanent Account Numbers (PANs) by overseas jurisdictions under the Automatic Exchange of Information (AEOI) framework, including the Common Reporting Standard (CRS) and the Foreign Account Tax Compliance Act (FATCA), for 2022-24.

The information currently available on the portal covers only assets reported by jurisdictions participating in the CRS and FATCA frameworks. Details received under other multilateral arrangements have not been displayed because of risk factors and non-disclosure commitments. The department also gathers intelligence on overseas assets from other sources.

At a meeting on October 23, the department decided that information on foreign assets received from additional sources could also be shared with relevant taxpayers, wherever possible, to help them take advantage of the scheme, officials said.

IN THE HON'BLE HIGH COURT OF M.P., JABALPUR
ORIGINAL JURISDICTION
IN THE MATTER OF THE COMPANIES ACT, 1956
IN THE MATTER OF M/S. ENBEE PLANTATIONS LTD. (IN-LIQN.)
Company Petition No. 03/2003
e- AUCTION SALE NOTICE

Pursuant to the orders dated **07/10/2026** of the Hon'ble High Court of M.P, Jabalpur **e-Tenders** are invited in respect of sale of the following assets/ properties of the company (In-Liqn.) on **"AS IS WHERE IS AND WHATSOEVER THERE IS BASIS"** from the prospective buyers :

Lot No.1- Land & Trees situated at Khasra no. 22/1, 50/2, 50/3, 50/4 at village Khandawad, tehsil-Budhni, Dist. Sehore (M.P).

The details of Reserve Price and EMD are as under: -

Lot No.	Description of Asset / Property	Reserve Price (Rs.)	EMD (Rs.)
Lot No. 1	**Land & Trees situated at Khasra no. 22/1, 50/2, 50/3, 50/4 at village Khandawad, Tehsil-Budhni, Dist. Sehore (M.P) having agriculture land admeasuring 21.226 Ha.**	90,00,000/-	9,00,000/-

Note: -

i) Inspection of all assets/properties will be held on **05/11/2026 between 11:00 A.M. to 4:00 P.M.** At the time of taking inspection of the aforesaid assets/properties of the company (In- Liqn.), all the interested buyers are requested to follow the advisory issued by the District Administration in the interest of their own well-being and in public interest.

ii) The details of property of the Company (in- Liqn.) is mentioned in valuation report filed before Hon'ble High Court of MP at Jabalpur. The prospective buyer should also peruse the valuation report etc. in detail by visiting the office of the Official Liquidator, Indore on any working day between **2:00 PM to 3:00PM** from date of advertisement to date of inspection as above and may also verify the relevant Revenue records/ location map directly from the Revenue Authorities, if any, so required so as to fully satisfy themselves before participating in the proposed e-auction. No contention of any kind if any, shall be entertained by the Official Liquidator in this regard in future.

iii) In order to participate in e-auction, tenderers have to pay a non-refundable e-auction participation fee of Rs.1,000/- (Rupees One thousand only) in the account of "e-Auction of Assets by the Official Liquidator", Current Account No. 0212002100247959, Punjab National Bank, Sitlamata Bazar Branch, Indore, Branch Code-021200, RTGS/NEFT/IFS Code PUNB0021200 and same may be made by **16/11/2026**.

iv) The tenderers should submit their online offer through the **website- https://olauctiontiger.net/EPROC/.**

v) The intending purchasers/bidders are required to register their name at **https://olauctiontiger.net/EPROC/** and get user ID and Password and get training on e-auction from M/s Auction Tiger, Customer Care number of Auction Tiger Team-9173528727/9265562818/9265562821/9374519754 and Office of Official Liquidator, Madhya Pradesh, Contact Number : 0731-2710051.

vi) After successful e-auction, a fixed amount of Rs.1200/- for lot no. 1 will be charged by e-auction agency-M/s Auction Tiger from successful bidder.

vii) The EMD amount (Interest free) should be deposited by way of NEFT/RTGS in the account of "**e-Auction of Assets by the Official Liquidator", Current Account No. 0212002100247959, Punjab National Bank, Sitlamata Bazar Branch, Indore, Branch Code-021200, RTGS/NEFT/IFS Code PUNB0021200.** The last date for submission of online offer along with **EMD tender fee with supportive documents** is **16/11/2026.**

viii) The Official Liquidator shall not be held responsible for technical problem of any kind, any problem of internet connectivity, network problem, system crash down, power failure and such reason.

ix) The **e-auction** will be conducted through the **website https://olauctiontiger.net/EPROC/** on **18/11/2026 between 1:00 P.M to 3:00 P.M.** with auto time extension of 10 minutes each time if the bid is made in the last minutes before close of e-auction till sale is concluded.

x) This Sale is subject to confirmation by the Hon'ble High Court of M.P., at Jabalpur.

xi) This **Sale Notice** be treated as notice to the secured creditors/unsecured creditors/ contributories/ Central & State Government authorities/ bodies and all other parties having interest in the matter of company (In-Liqn.).

xii) The other details of above **e–auction** along with terms and conditions of sale are available in the website **https://olauctiontiger.net/EPROC/.**

xiii) The Terms and Conditions herein above, may be relaxed/ rescinded/ stipulated further by Hon'ble High Court/Official Liquidator at any time.

-Sd/-
OFFICIAL LIQUIDATOR
HIGH COURT OF MADHYA PRADESH, INDORE
1ST FLOOR, OLD CIA BUILDING, OPP. GPO, RESIDENCY AREA, INDORE (M.P)

Date : 26/10/2026
Place : Indore
Ph. No. : 0731-2710051

IN THE HON'BLE HIGH COURT OF M.P., BENCH AT INDORE
(ORIGINAL JURISDICTION)
IN THE MATTER OF THE COMPANIES ACT, 1956
And In the matter of :
M/s. Laxmi Pipes & Fittings Private Limited (In-Liqn.)
Company Petition No.30/2013
Advertisement of Notice to Creditors, Including Workmen Creditors, to Prove Their Claims

Notice is hereby given to the creditors, including workmen creditors, of the above-named company that they are required to submit to the Official Liquidator of the Hon'ble High Court, Indore, proofs of their respective debts or claims against **M/s. Laxmi Pipes & Fittings Private Limited (In-Liqn.)** by delivering the same at the Office of the Official Liquidator, 1st Floor, Old CIA Building, Opposite GPO, Residency Area, Indore (M.P.), on or before **16/11/2026**, or by sending the same by post to the Official Liquidator so as to reach the Official Liquidator not later than the said date, together with an affidavit in proof of such debt or claim in the prescribed form containing their respective names, addresses, particulars of the debt or claim, and particulars of any right to priority under Sections **529, 529A or 530** of the Companies Act, 1956.

Any creditor who fails to submit his **Affidavit of Proof of Debt** within the time prescribed above shall be excluded from the benefit of any distribution of dividend declared before his debt is proved or, as the case may be, from objecting to such distribution.

Any creditor who has submitted his proof shall, if so required by a notice in writing from the Official Liquidator, attend, either personally or through his Advocate, the investigation of such debt or claim at the time and place specified in such notice and shall produce such further evidence in support of his debt or claim as may be required.

Dated this 26th day of October, 2026

Sd/-
OFFICIAL LIQUIDATOR
HIGH COURT OF MADHYA PRADESH, INDORE
1st Floor Old CIA Building, Opp. GPO,
Residency Area, Indore (M.P.). Telephone :- 0731-2710568

TIMES ascent
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H.B.T.U. KANPUR
Nawabganj, Kanpur-208002, U.P. India
(Formerly Harcourt Butler Technological Institute, Kanpur)

File No.: 1460/HBTU/Estt/01/2026 **FACULTY RECRUITMENT** Date: 24.10.2026

Online Applications in the prescribed format are invited from eligible candidates for direct recruitment to the regular faculty positions in various departments and administrative positions in the University as per the details given below:

A) Faculty Positions

Advt. No.	Department	Professor				Associate Professor				Assistant Professor
		UR	EWS	OBC	SC	UR	EWS	OBC	SC	UR
DC-01	Oil Technology	-	-	-	1	-	-	-	1	-
DC-02	Electronics Engineering	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	1*
DC-03	Electrical Engineering	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	1
DC-04	MCA	-	-	-	-	1	-	-	-	-
DC-05	Mechanical Engineering	-	-	-	-	-	-	1**	-	-
DC-06	Chemical Engineering	-	-	1	-		1	-	-	-
DC-07	Chemistry	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	1	-
DC-09	Paint Technology	-	-	1	-	1	-	1	-	1***
DC-10	Plastic Technology	1	-	-	-	2	-	-	-	-
DC-11	Physics	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	1
DC-12	Food Technology	-	1	-	-	-	1	-	-	-
DC-15	Mathematics	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	1+1****
DC-16	Leather Technology	-	-	1	-	-	-	-	-	-
DC-17	Civil Engineering	1	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
DC-18	Humanities (Economics)	-	-	-	-	1	-	-	-	-
	Total	**02**	**01**	**03**	**01**	**05**	**02**	**02**	**02**	**06**

B) Administrative Position

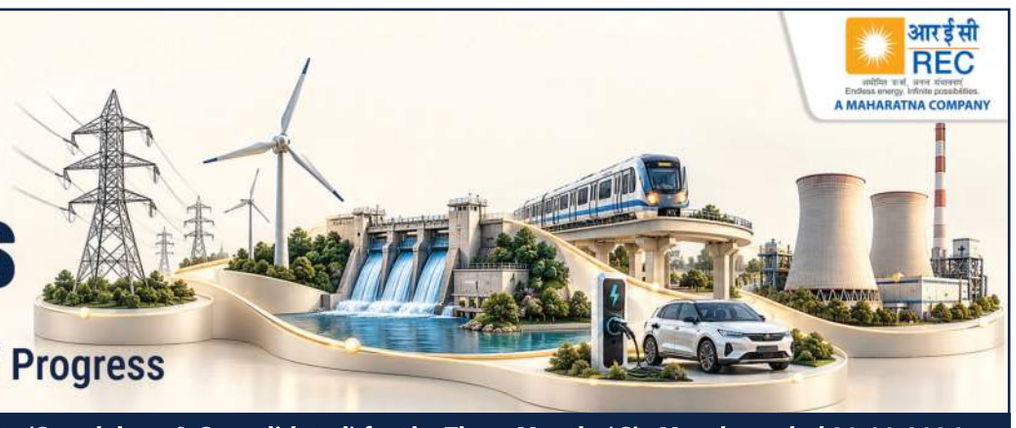
Advt. No.	Position	Vacancy				
		UR	EWS	OBC	SC	ST
PC-21	Assistant Workshop Superintendent	1	-	-	-	-

*** To be vacated on 01/03/2027.**
**** To be vacated on 01/08/2027.**
***** To be vacated on 01/12/2026.**
****** 01 post of Assistant Professor in Mathematics will be vacated on 01/01/2027.**

Note: 1. Reservation will be as per UP Government Norms (Vertical & Horizontal).
2. UR: Unreserved, EWS: Economical Weaker Section, SC: Scheduled Caste, ST: Scheduled Tribes, OBC : Other Backward Class
3. The number of posts advertised is indicative and the University reserves the right not to fill up any post, decrease or increase the number of posts.
4. Eligible persons may submit their applications through online mode only by visiting HBTU, Kanpur website http://www.hbtu.ac.in. The details of the procedure for online submission of applications, General Information & Instructions, Recruitment Rules, Screening and selection criteria, tentative schedule of Recruitment Process etc. are available on the University website.
5. The last date for submitting the complete application with all documents in online mode is **08-12.2026 (Tuesday)** till 11:59 pm. The candidates need to upload all relevant documents with the application form only.
6. Any correspondence in regard of this recruitment should be addressed to the Email ID: **recruitment2026@hbtu.ac.in** only.

(Registrar)

FUNDING INDIA'S AMBITIONS
Powering the Pathway of Progress



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A MAHARATNA COMPANY

Extract of Unaudited Financial Results (Standalone & Consolidated) for the Three Months/ Six Months ended 30-09-2026

(₹ in Crore)

Sl. No.	Particulars	Standalone						Consolidated					
		Quarter Ended			Half Year Ended		Year ended	Quarter Ended			Half Year Ended		Year ended
		30-09-2026	30-06-2026	30-09-2025	30-09-2026	30-09-2025	31-03-2026	30-09-2026	30-06-2026	30-09-2025	30-09-2026	30-09-2025	31-03-2026
		(Unaudited)	(Unaudited)	(Unaudited)	(Unaudited)	(Unaudited)	(Audited)	(Unaudited)	(Unaudited)	(Unaudited)	(Unaudited)	(Unaudited)	(Audited)
1.	Total Income from Operations	14,727.69	14,296.10	15,084.13	29,023.79	29,809.69	59,139.96	15,000.40	14,434.92	15,152.67	29,435.32	29,969.26	59,584.16
2.	Net Profit for the period (before Tax, Exceptional and/ or Extraordinary items)	4,273.95	5,209.32	5,552.80	9,483.27	11,199.70	20,713.19	4,391.14	5,268.30	5,548.94	9,659.44	11,215.35	20,784.61
3.	Net Profit for the period before tax (after Exceptional and/ or Extraordinary items)	4,273.95	5,209.32	5,552.80	9,483.27	11,199.70	20,713.19	4,391.14	5,268.30	5,548.94	9,659.44	11,215.35	20,766.33
4.	Net Profit for the period after tax (after Exceptional and/ or Extraordinary items)	3,391.18	4,149.46	4,425.86	7,540.64	8,876.88	16,282.26	3,477.73	4,192.76	4,414.93	7,670.49	8,880.64	16,308.17
5.	Total Comprehensive Income for the period [Comprising Profit for the period (after tax) and Other Comprehensive Income (after tax)]	3,950.03	7,396.65	5,094.38	11,346.68	7,081.24	12,115.91	4,036.58	7,439.95	5,083.45	11,476.53	7,085.00	12,141.82
6.	Paid up Equity Share Capital (Face Value ₹10 per share)	2,633.22	2,633.22	2,633.22	2,633.22	2,633.22	2,633.22	2,633.22	2,633.22	2,633.22	2,633.22	2,633.22	2,633.22
7.	Other Equity	91,691.69	89,203.00	80,105.68	91,691.69	80,105.68	81,657.19	92,585.54	90,010.30	80,847.53	92,585.54	80,847.53	82,421.19
8.	Securities Premium Account	1,577.53	1,577.53	1,577.53	1,577.53	1,577.53	1,577.53						
9.	Net Worth	94,324.91	91,836.22	82,738.90	94,324.91	82,738.90	84,290.41						
10.	Paid up Debt Capital/ Outstanding Debt	5,27,934.91	5,07,555.37	5,07,466.71	5,27,934.91	5,07,466.71	5,05,777.41						
11.	Debt Equity Ratio *	5.60	5.52	6.07	5.60	6.07	6.00						
12.	Earnings per Share (of ₹10 each) (for continuing and discontinued operations) (in₹)												
(i)	Basic	12.88	15.76	16.81	28.64	33.71	61.71	13.21	15.92	16.77	29.13	33.73	61.81
(ii)	Diluted	12.88	15.76	16.81	28.64	33.71	61.71	13.21	15.92	16.77	29.13	33.73	61.81

** Debt/Equity Ratio = Net Debt / Net Worth (Net debt represents principal outstanding less cash and cash equivalents available.)*

Notes:

1. The unaudited standalone financial results of the Company were recommended by the Audit Committee and approved and taken on record by the Board of Directors at their respective meetings held on October 26, 2026. These results have been limited reviewed by the Joint Statutory Auditors of the Company.
2. The above is an extract of the detailed format of Quarterly Financial Results filed with the Stock Exchanges under Regulation 33 & 52 of the SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015. The full format of the financial results is available on the Stock Exchange websites **(www.bseindia.com and www.nseindia.com)** and also on the Company's website **(www.recindia.nic.in)**.
3. For other applicable disclosure as required under regulation 52(4) of SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015, refer detailed format of the financial results filed with the Stock Exchange **(www.bseindia.com and www.nseindia.com)** and the same can also be accessed on the Company's website **(www.recindia.nic.in)**.

Record Date for 2nd Interim Dividend for the FY 2026-27

The Board of Directors at its meeting held on October 26, 2026, declared 2nd interim dividend of ₹3.50/- (Rupees Three and Paise Fifty only) per equity share of ₹10/- each for the financial year 2026-27 and fixed **Friday, October 30, 2026** as the **'Record Date'** for reckoning eligibility of shareholders for the purpose of payment of said interim dividend. The said interim dividend would be paid to all the eligible shareholders within 30 days from the date of declaration.

For REC Limited
Jitendra Srivastava
Chairman & Managing Director
DIN - 06817799

Place: Delhi
Date: October 26, 2026

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Scan this QR code to download the Financial Results

News Publishers Move SC over Privacy Law

Agencies

New Delhi: A group of 21 news publishers, including Times Internet, has challenged India's privacy law in the Supreme Court, arguing it would trample investigative work and let authorities identify journalists' sources, documents show.

The October 6 lawsuit is being reported for the first time and is due to be heard on Tuesday.

The government last year announced implementation of a privacy law to protect digital personal data of users, raising compliance requirements for platforms such as Meta and Google. The publishers have said that since media outlets were not exempt, the law was an invasion of press freedom.

Media companies received assurances in an August meeting with the government that the law would protect press freedom, but not having a written carve-out for journalists like in the European Union, Singapore and Britain was alarming, the Digital News Publishers Association (DNPA) said in a confidential filing at the Supreme Court, reviewed by Reuters.

Oct 6 lawsuit argues rule will let authorities identify journalists' sources, trample work

DNPA and the media groups did not respond to requests for comment from Reuters, and neither did the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology.

The publishers are demanding that most of the law's contentious provisions, which kick in from May 2027, should be quashed. They are arguing the law could force a journalist to get prior consent from a person they want to investigate and force publishers to erase stories. They also say powers granted by the law to demand information could expose reporters' sources.

The law would "render investigative journalism a benign and neutered recorder of events," the 698-page filing said. The provisions "constitute pre-censorship which is anathema to any democracy worth its name".

DNPA's members include the Network18 group, which has seven digital news platforms, and marquee media groups including Indian Express, NDTV, and Times Internet — the digital arm of The Times of India Group, which also publishes this newspaper.

PAQUET: EUROPEAN PARLIAMENT MEMBERS VERY POSITIVE ABOUT TRADE DEAL

'FTA with India Will be a Game Changer in Supply Chain Mgmt'

There may be scope for Japan, India & Europe to work together, says top European diplomat

Dipanjan Roy Chaudhury

New Delhi: The free trade agreement (FTA) between India and the European Union, expected to be signed in December, and the proposed investment treaty would be a game changer in managing supply chains, according to the EU ambassador to India Jean-Eric Paquet. "I think the negotiation, which concluded at the summit in January, was a game changer, and the FTA will be a game changer. There is no doubt to be had on that," Paquet told **ET**.

We are creating an economic space across India and Europe- an internal market. That is what is being established, creating a long-term perspective and reliability for economic operators, which will obviously build on very significant trade already

JEAN-ERIC PAQUET
EU ambassador to India

"The EU Commission proposed signatures a few weeks ago, on the 11th of September. I am mentioning it because with that also comes very detailed information, called a schedule of commitments, where now everyone knows when the taxes, when the rates and import rates are being reduced and entering into force for India," he said. "So, it is a game changer because together with the investment protection agreement—on which negotiations are ongoing, and here I hope we can see an acceleration of these negotiations—when both are in place, it is not just about trade facilitation. It is much more about supply chain management and the resilience of supply chains."

Paquet further said, "We are creating an economic space across India and the European internal market. That is what is being established, creating a long-term perspective and reliability for economic operators, which will obviously build on very significant trade already."

The comments come ahead of Prime Minister Narendra Modi's proposed visit to Brussels in mid-December for the signing of the FTA.

The EU envoy said Members of the European Parliament (MEPs) are very positive about the FTA with India. "A group of MEPs visited India in March, led by the chair of the trade committee in the parliament. They had the opportunity to meet many actors here and get a real sense of the scope of the agreement and how it is being considered so they will be able to deal with it effectively," he said.

Regarding the sensitivities of both sides to the agreement, Paquet said, "We were very careful to ensure that the coverage reflects sensitivities on both sides. It is a free trade agreement which is slightly less broad in agricultural products than others. I think, by and large, both sides were very happy. With the broadest possible coverage of tariff lines—99% of the trade that India has with Europe will be rate-free upon entry into force—we really are covering the sectors that matter, as well as new sectors that have been largely left untouched in the past, such as the automotive sector. Indian car manufacturers are, for the first time, seriously looking at Europe."

Asked about the India-EU Indo-Pacific partnership, the envoy said, "The connection is very strong in terms of supply chains. The Europeans are prioritising their Indo-Pacific strategy, which was adopted a few years ago. We meet on a yearly basis with ministers from the Indo-Pacific region. So, there is really a strong focus on the European side on the Indo-Pacific. India is leading very much on Indo-Pacific foreign policy thinking, and therefore also engaging with us. I think, more concretely, this is about maritime security, freedom of navigation—a big part of the work India and Europe are doing under the security and defence partnership. This is, of course, also about connectivity."

India and the EU are also cooperating on projects in Africa. There could also be scope for Japan, India and Europe to work together, according to the EU envoy.

Referring to the India-EU counter-terrorism partnership, he said, "There is a lot of convergence between India and Europe on condemning current terrorism and also on the root causes of terrorism. I expect that this can continue to be very productive."

'TAKE A LESSON OR TWO'

Goyal: EU Can Take Cue from India, Cut Regulatory Burden

No rethink on CBAM, but rules hindering trade need to be looked at: Dutch minister

Kirtika Suneja

The Hague: The EU can take a lesson or two from India on reducing the regulatory burden on businesses, Commerce and Industry Minister Piyush Goyal said on Monday at the India-Netherlands Business Forum. His Dutch counterpart ruled out a rethink of the EU Carbon Border Adjustment Mechanism (CBAM), saying rules on climate and product quality are crucial, but unnecessary regulations that hinder trade need to be reviewed.

Commerce and Industry Minister Piyush Goyal with The Netherlands' Minister for Foreign Trade and Development Cooperation Sjoerd Sjoerdsma, in The Hague on Monday. PTI

Noting that India is deregulating, Goyal said: "Sadly, you need to take a lesson or two from us on that… With Europe adding to the regulatory burden on businesses, whenever I say that, I become the darling of businesses in your countries, because I have had so many occasions where I have talked about the huge regulatory overburden."

"I talk about the huge regulatory overburden that's been imposed both at the European Commission level and at the state level in many European countries," he said.

Last week in Berlin, the minister said the EU was "inviting disaster" and "shooting" itself in the foot by introducing more regulations and restrictions and closing its borders, which had helped it become a bloc of developed nations.

"I'm not very happy with you, but businesses come and quietly tell me in my ear, 'Thank you. I wish you could say that a little more.' The world wants more freedom to operate," Goyal said.

"When it comes to climate, quality of products, security and safety of products, these are rules that very much benefit consumers in the European market. And, of course, we should keep those rules. But where there are rules that are not necessary, where there are rules that hinder trade unnecessarily, of course, we need to look at them when it comes to regulation," said Sjoerd Sjoerdsma, the Netherlands' Minister of Foreign Trade and Development Cooperation.

On whether the 27-member bloc would reconsider CBAM, Sjoerdsma said: "I don't think there will be any renegotiation of CBAM because we view it as a necessary measure to ensure that we stick to the goals that the entire world agreed to, the goals of the Paris Climate Agreement."

Calling it an "essential instrument" to ensure that the world adheres to these goals, he said the Netherlands invests in helping small and medium-sized enterprises in countries such as India understand the rules and comply with them more easily.

"Because we do see, of course, the difficulty in some of these guidelines. Some of them are quite complex to follow, and if you have a small company, you have a lot of other things to do than just read all those guidelines. We're helping these people out," he said.

MOJO IN TIES, VAN GOGH MOMENT

The Dutch minister said trust between India and the Netherlands was at an all-time high.

"We need to ensure that there is a huge amount of trust between us, because where there is trust, there will be economic relations. And if I look at the trust between the Netherlands and India, I think it's an all-time high," he said, adding that trade had become more politicised and unpredictable worldwide.

Referring to Dutch painter Vincent van Gogh, Goyal said the relationship between the two countries was like the artist's paintings, whose value went largely unrecognised during his lifetime but which are now among the most expensive and valuable works of art.

FOR FULL REPORT, GO TO www.economictimes.com

Cotton Shortage Set to Worsen

On rising export demand due to FTAs and El Niño impact on local production

Jayashree Bhosale

Pune: India's cotton shortage is expected to worsen as the country prepares to expand textile and garment exports through new free trade agreements.

The impact of El Niño weather conditions could further hurt domestic production, expected to fall by 3.4% to a new low in the 2026-27 crop year ended September.

Cotton imports hit a record high in 2025-26 to an estimated 7.1 million bales of 170 kilograms compared to last year's imports of 5.74 million bales. Prices have also risen more than 7% in the past month.

Industry leaders said prices have climbed ahead of the October 31 deadline for the end of the cotton import duty exemption.

India has given exemption on the 11% import duty on raw cotton for June 1 to October 31. The earlier exemption was given during August 19 to December 31, 2025.

As the new cotton year started on October 1, cotton prices increased by Rs 4,500/candy to Rs 68,500/candy for the benchmark Gujarat 29-millimeter cotton, showed spot prices data.

India's cotton imports touched a new high of over 7 million bales in 2025-26. "In 2025-26, the country consumed around 34 million bales and imported about 7 million bales," said The Southern India Mills Association (SIMA) in a recent letter to finance minister Nirmala Sitharaman. "However, uncertainty in raw material availability continues to cause price instability and industrial unrest."

With the industry seeing signs of increase in export demand from new markets due to the FTAs, cotton consumption is expected to increase in 2026-27. The gap between cotton demand and supply is expected to widen to more than 9 million bales from last year's 7 million bales.

"We have seen an increase in export demand from the UK in the last couple of months," said K Selvaraju, secretary general, SIMA. "Cotton demand for the forthcoming season may exceed 36 million bales due to FTAs, including the UK FTA."

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CHANGE OF NAME

I, INDU SURESH KUMAR, W/o Suresh Kumar V M, aged about 52 years, residing at No. 267, 3rd Main, 1st Cross, Vinayaka Layout, near Ayyappa School, Medarahalli, Chikkabanavara, Bengaluru-560090, have changed my name from INDUSURESH (Old Name) to INDU SURESH KUMAR (New Name) vide Affidavit dated: 22-10-2026, sworn before Notary N Mahesha. Henceforth, I shall be known as INDU SURESH KUMAR, for all purposes.

I, ALICE THOMAS, W/o Thomas Annamma, residing at No. 314, 5th Cross, Brindavan Layout, Shettihalli, Jalahalli West, Bengaluru 560015, do hereby declare that ALEECE THOMAS and ALICE THOMAS are one and the same person. My correct Date of Birth is 24/11/1956 and not 25/11/1956 vide Affidavit dated 14/10/2026 before Notary N. Mahesha, Bengaluru. Henceforth, I shall be known as ALICE THOMAS, for all purposes

I ANJANA DEVI SRINIVASAN W/o Srinivasan Venkataraman R/o Pride Springfields, D-707, 7TH FLOOR, 55/2, Gubbalala, Uttarahalli, Bengaluru - 560061 have changed my name to Anjana Srinivasan

I, MOHAMMED ALTAF KADER DAGLI Residing at NO. B-202, Momon Residency, Nayandahalli, Mysore Road, Bangalore Karnataka - 56003, have Changed my Name to MOHAMMED ALTAF KADAR DAGLI for all future purpose.

I, ZAREER MANERIKAR Residing at No. 4, 2nd Floor, 17/1, Govindachar Building, HDFC Bank Lane, Ambalipura, Bellandur Gate, Sarjapur Road, Bangalore - 560102, have state that his deceased Father name changed from VIJAYKUMAR MANERIKAR to VIJAYAKUMAR WILLIAM DAMODAR MANERIKAR for all future purpose.

I, SHAIKH MUHAMMAD AYAN, S/O Shaikh Imarn, No:-149/2 & 223,Embassy International riding school, near Tarahunise village, Bangalore-562157, I Have change my Name Shaikh Sahil Ayan to Shaikh Muhammad Ayan vide Affidavit dated 22/10/2026, certificate no:-IN-KA25141742419897Y

I, ZAREER VIJAY MANERIKAR Residing at No. 4, 2nd Floor, 17/1, Govindachar Building, HDFC Bank Lane, Ambalipura, Bellandur Gate, Sarjapur Road, Bangalore - 560102, have changed my name to ZAREER MANERIKAR for all future purpose

I, S Piyush Jain, S/o Suresh Kumar Jain, residing at No 002, Parasmani Harmony, No 109, 7th & 8th Cross, 4th Main, Chamarajpet, Bengaluru - 560018, have changed my name to Piyush Jain for all purposes.

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I, RAJESH KUMAR BHAGWAN CHAND Residing at NO. Flat 402 4th Floor Shraddha Sankalp, 64 Shardananda Bhavan Road V V Puram Behind Hotel Janatha, Bangalore - 560004,have changed my name to RAJESH KUMAR for all future purpose.

I, GLADYS MANERIKAR, Residing at No. 4, 2nd Floor, 17/1, Govindachar Building, HDFC Bank Lane, Ambalipura, Bellandur Gate, Sarjapur Road, Bangalore - 560102 have changed my name to GUILHERMINA LEOPOLDINA CARMELINA PEREIRA MANERIKAR for all future purpose

I, Manigandan Muthusamy R/o 78, 2nd Block, 1st A Cross, Ramanjaneya Layout, Chikkalasandra, Bengaluru - 560061, have changed my minor son's name from ADVIR to ADVIR MANIGANDAN

personal

CHANGE OF NAME

I, JAGRIT, S/o NEERAJ KUMAR, R/o R238, Hostel Blocks, IIM Bangalore, Bangalore 560076, have changed my name from JAGRIT DHAMIJA To JAGRIT

I, 14865685P, Sep, Chavda Kirtiraj Amarsinh of 1 ATC my mother changed name Chavda Geetaben to Chavda Gitaba Amarsinh, for all purpose.

Tata Comm to Invest $450M in 10,000 Km AI Fibre Network

Neil Ghai

New Delhi: Tata Communications plans to invest $400-450 million for laying 10,000 km of AI-ready fibre across India, starting with the Mumbai-Pune-Hyderabad-Chennai corridor, to connect data centres and AI hubs.

The project will be implemented in three phases spanning three to five years, subject to execution conditions, and funded through operating cash flows, Rupesh Chokshi, chief product and technology officer at Tata Communications told ET. The planned network will provide 7.2 petabytes of capacity.

"We are comfortable in terms of the way we do the phasing; the way we work with our customers, we should be able to manage this," Chokshi said. "If we need to eventually do something, we will," he said when asked if the company will raise funds for the venture. Tata Communications posted 9.6% on-year growth in revenue in the September quarter at ₹6,688 crore. Net profit surged 86% to ₹341 crore, while free cash flows turned positive, reaching ₹212 crore.

The company plans to expand its connectivity into data centre ecosystems in eastern and western India

The company plans to expand its connectivity into data centre ecosystems in eastern and western India, including Visakhapatnam, Bhubaneswar, Jamnagar and Gujarat's GIFT City. The network will connect these hubs to international cable landing stations and complement Tata Communications' subsea cable infrastructure. Chokshi said the network was designed around "ultra-low latency", high capacity, and resilience to meet service-level requirements of hyperscalers, neocloud providers, and other enterprise customers. For the Mumbai-Chennai route, he said the company is targeting a round-trip latency of 15-16 milliseconds, using multiple fibre pairs and higher-grade fibre.

Large AI data-centre deployments are driving demand. Chokshi cited a dedicated network being built for Amazon Web Services and connectivity bought by a neocloud provider across Mumbai, Chennai and Singapore. "We are not just talking about 10 Gigawatts; we are talking about 400 GW, 800 GW," he said.

As the network is deployed across multiple jurisdictions, Choskhi said the project will require careful planning around right-of-way permissions, monsoons and route adjustments.

TO CUT FUEL IMPORTS

E100 Gets Nod for Flex-Fuel Vehicle Usage

Our Bureau

New Delhi: The road transport ministry on Monday approved E100, or pure ethanol, along with E85 for flex-fuel vehicles, stepping up efforts to reduce costly fuel imports.

In a notification, the ministry said E85 and E100 would be used only in vehicles designated by automakers as flex-fuel vehicles. Existing vehicles cannot be modified to run on ethanol blends higher than E20 — a mix of 20% ethanol and 80% petrol.

The government's move comes amid volatility in global oil markets due to the West Asia crisis, sharply inflating India's crude import bill.

The ministry also revised certain vehicle classification thresholds, fuel specifications and technical references used in emission-related tables and testing provisions. These include raising the vehicle weight limit to 3,500 kg from the previous 3,000 kg threshold for light petrol and diesel vehicles covered by the changes.

The draft amendments to the Central Motor Vehicles Rules, 1989, aim to enable wider use of fuels such as E85 and E100, as well as B100 biodiesel and hydrogen-CNG blends

In June, Maruti Suzuki launched India's first flex-fuel car, the Wagon R Flex Fuel, capable of running on ethanol-petrol blends ranging from E20 to E100.

Flex-fuel vehicles are designed to run on higher ethanol blends, including E85 — a mix of 85% ethanol and 15% petrol — and E100, or pure ethanol, unlike conventional petrol vehicles currently approved for lower ethanol concentrations.

Major automakers, including Toyota Motor Corporation, Tata Motors and Hyundai Motor Company, are also developing flex-fuel vehicles for the Indian market.

The draft amendments to the Central Motor Vehicles Rules, 1989, aim to enable wider use of fuels such as E85 and E100, as well as B100 biodiesel and hydrogen-CNG blends.

Dalmia Bharat Posts ₹205cr Loss in Q2 on Exceptional Hit

Our Bureau

Mumbai: Dalmia Bharat posted a consolidated loss of ₹205 crore for the September quarter, weighed down by an exceptional loss of ₹339 crore related to impairment of certain assets and a separation scheme for eligible employees.

The country's fourth-largest cement producer had also reported an exceptional loss in the June quarter. The ₹182 crore hit was primarily related to costs associated with its acquisition of cement assets from Jaiprakash Associates.

Power and fuel costs rose 22% y-o-y to ₹874 crore, while total expenses increased around 13% to ₹3,563 crore

In the September quarter, sales volume rose 3% year-on-year to 7.1 million tonnes, while consolidated revenue from operations increased 4% to ₹3,563 crore. Earnings before interest, tax, depreciation and amortisation (EBITDA), however, fell 29% to ₹493 crore due to higher costs, particularly for power and fuel.

"Demand challenges in few of our key markets along with macro-economic cost headwinds impacted EBITDA for the quarter," chief financial officer Yatin Malhotra said.

Power and fuel costs rose 22% year-on-year to ₹874 crore, while total expenses increased around 13% to ₹3,563 crore.

"While the operating environment continues to remain challenging, we are hopeful that positive momentum on cement prices and our consistent focus on cost optimisation will help mitigate cost pressure," Malhotra said.

EBITDA per tonne of cement fell 31% year-on-year to ₹698, while net sales realisation rose 1% to ₹5,042 per tonne.

BPCL to Cut Russian Oil as West Asian Crude Gets Cheaper

Kalpana Pathak

Mumbai: Bharat Petroleum Corporation Ltd (BPCL) is set to significantly reduce its Russian crude oil purchases in November as higher freight costs and elevated premiums make West Asian grades more commercially attractive, signalling a shift in the state-run refiner's sourcing strategy.

Russian crude accounted for around 37% of BPCL's crude sourcing mix in the July-September quarter. However, the company has cut purchases of Russian cargoes for November as shipping costs have risen, Vetsa Ramakrishna Gupta, BPCL's head of finance, said on Monday.

BPCL expects supplies from West Asia to increase in October and November compared with the first quarter

"October, our requirement from Russia has slightly come down, but in November, cargoes from Russia have reduced significantly due to their commercial viability. Mainly due to the increase in freight, we are not getting good offers from Russia," Gupta told analysts on a call.

The company expects supplies from West Asia to increase in October and November compared with the first quarter, when disruptions to oil flows through the Strait of Hormuz affected supplies from the region.

"October-November also, we are expecting similar lengths of higher volume from West Asia. Mainly after the Yanbu pipeline correction by Saudi, they have started increasing their volumes," Gupta said, adding that supplies from Iraq and Kuwait had yet to return to full levels, while volumes from the rest of West Asia were healthy.

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SMART INVESTING

SBI Chief Expects 50 bps Rate Hike in December

BOUNCE FROM JIO IPO INFLOWS ALSO FADES

Rupee Slips Below 95 Again on Oil, Dollar Pressure

Our Bureau

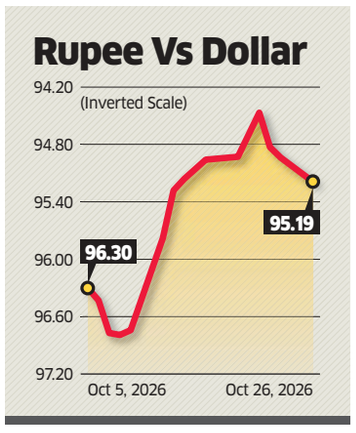
Mumbai: The Indian rupee on Monday slid below the psychologically significant 95 per dollar mark, weighed down by higher oil prices. The rupee closed at 95.18, versus its previous close of 94.94, with importer dollar demand persisting despite higher hedging costs, traders said.

The rupee traded in a wide range of 94.90 and 95.26 throughout the day, gaining in the first half, and eventually retracing back to levels south of 95 per dollar as importer dollar demand picked up.

This is the weakest rupee level in nearly two weeks, since the central bank announced its 'midnight measures' to cap excess depreciation. The Reserve Bank of India (RBI), on October 10, unveiled fresh measures to shore up the rupee, diverting dollar purchases by state oil retailers away from the spot market and tightening hedging rules.

The rupee slid past ₹95 per dollar to a near two-week low despite the central bank's 'midnight measures'

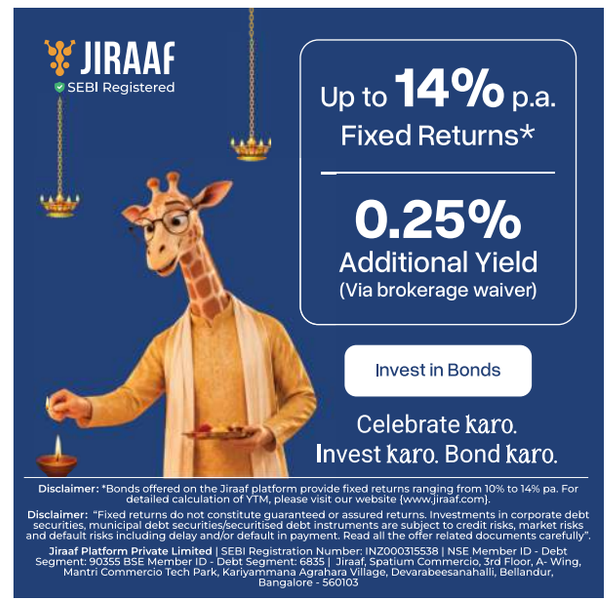
"Oil demand has shifted from the spot market, so the dollar demand seen today was likely from importers. Importers are still buying dollars despite hedging being more expensive and the RBI too has not been actively intervening by dollar sales, as it used to some time ago," said Dilip Parmar, currency research analyst, HDFC Securities.



Brent futures were trading around $115 per barrel on Monday, according to Reuters. Oil prices remain a key factor in the rupee's trajectory, with many now considering high energy prices as a base case. "FPIs and oil are the two factors that are majorly affecting the rupee. The broad range is between 94 and 97, and I expect more measures as soon as the rupee starts inching weaker than 96.50 levels," said Anindya Banerjee, head of currency research, Kotak Securities.

Over the past week, the key support for the currency came in from the inflows of the Jio Platforms IPO. With that inflow now dried up, the rupee is again vulnerable, with no positives for the currency.

"The fading support from foreign inflows linked to the Jio Platforms IPO have weighed on the currency. The RBI's reduced dollar-selling intervention has left the rupee more exposed to market demand and the currency is likely to remain under pressure while crude prices stay elevated and importer dollar demand persists," said Anil Bhansali, head of treasury at Finrex Treasury Advisors. The rupee is expected to trade in the 95-95.50 range on Tuesday, with importer demand and dollar purchases by PSU banks to meet oil companies' requirements likely to weigh on the currency.



Disclaimer: *Bonds offered on the Jiraaf platform provide fixed returns ranging from 10% to 14% pa. For detailed calculation of YTM, please visit our website (www.jiraaf.com).

Disclaimer: "Fixed returns do not constitute guaranteed or assured returns. Investments in corporate debt securities, municipal debt securities/securitised debt instruments are subject to credit risks, market risks and default risks including delay and/or default in payment. Read all the offer related documents carefully".

Jiraaf Platform Private Limited | SEBI Registration Number: INZ000035538 | NSE Member ID - Debt Segment: 90355 BSE Member ID - Debt Segment: 6835 | Jiraaf, Spatium Commercio, 3rd Floor, A- Wing, Mantri Commercio Tech Park, Kariyammana Agrahara Village, Devarabeesanahalli, Bellandur, Bangalore - 560103

RELIEF RALLY Sensex rises 0.66%, and Nifty gains 0.68% on 'buying at lower levels after selloff'

D-St Sparks to Life After Days of Losses, but can't Douse Worries

Our Bureau

Mumbai: Indian equity benchmarks rebounded late Monday after an attritional morning trade, recovering from initial losses as investors picked up beaten-down stocks after four consecutive sessions of declines. The BSE Sensex rose 482.92 points, or 0.66%, to close at 73,606.75, while the NSE Nifty advanced 153.20 points, or 0.68%, to settle at 22,753.20.

Analysts said the recovery was driven by buying at lower levels after the recent selloff. Ajit Mishra, SVP-Research, Religare Broking, said the benchmarks recovered from intraday lows after a weak start, with buying emerging at lower levels. The Nifty closed near the day's high, providing some relief after four sessions of selling.

However, Mishra cautioned that the rebound remained tentative, with elevated crude prices, geopolitical uncertainty and concerns over the global interest-rate outlook continuing to weigh on sentiment. Domestic equities had ended last week on a weak note amid rising crude oil prices and escalating tensions in West Asia, fuelling concerns over inflation and corporate earnings. The Nifty fell 2.4% during the week, while the Sensex declined 2.2%.

Benchmark Snapshot

Days' Sectoral Performance

Sectors	Change (%)
Nifty Metal	2.2
Nifty Healthcare Index	1.8
Nifty Retail	1.8
Nifty Pharma	1.8
Nifty Energy	1.5
Nifty Oil & Gas	1.4
Nifty Consumer Durables	-0.2
Nifty Media	-0.3

Source: **NSE**. Compiled by **ETIntelligence.com**

Index	Current	Change (%)		
		Week	3 Mths	Year
BSE Sensex	73,607	-0.3	-3.2	-13.2
Nifty 50	22,753	-0.6	-4.3	-12.4

Source: **ET Data**. Compiled by **ETIntelligence.com**

Brent crude futures traded around $114.5 a barrel, easing from a near six-month high of $117 after Indian markets closed on Friday. However, Houthi attacks on Saudi Arabia kept global oil supply worries in focus.

Buying extended beyond frontline stocks, with the Nifty Midcap 150 index gaining 1.07% and the Nifty Smallcap 250 Index rising 1.13%. Metals, pharmaceuticals, healthcare, oil and gas stocks advanced, while media and consumer durables remained under pressure. The India VIX, a gauge of market volatility, rose 1.73%, indicating continued caution among investors despite the recovery in benchmark indices.

Among individual stocks, Kotak Mahindra Bank gained more than 2% after reporting a better-than-expected second-quarter profit, driven by robust loan demand and lower provisions for bad loans. Shriram Finance, however, fell 5% after lowering its annual loan-growth forecast and flagging higher credit costs.

Foreign portfolio investors were net sellers of Indian equities worth ₹1,462 crore on Monday, taking their cumulative net outflows for so far in October to ₹52,928 crore. Domestic institutional investors, meanwhile, were net buyers to the tune of ₹2,609 crore, raising their total net purchases to ₹61,719 crore in October so far.

Rising Concentration in AI Stocks Poses a Risk: Morningstar Chief

Investors are too optimistic on AI earnings, says Kunal Kapoor

Himadri Buch

Mumbai: US-based investment research firm Morningstar believes investors may be underestimating the risks of growing concentration in artificial intelligence stocks, said its chief executive officer, Kunal Kapoor.

"The biggest risk is not that AI fails. It's that investors have become too optimistic about how quickly the benefits translate into company earnings," said Chicago-based Kapoor in an interview during a recent Mumbai visit. "The market is assuming that today's investment spending will eventually translate into stronger revenue, higher margins and better productivity. That may happen, but rarely in a straight line," he said.

The concentration of gains in a relatively small group of AI-linked companies has also made global markets more dependent on a limited set of outcomes, he said.

That caution is also visible in India. According to Kapoor, a thriving economy can support business growth, but that doesn't automatically translate into attractive investment returns.

"The market is assuming that today's investment spending will eventually translate into stronger revenue, higher margins, better productivity"

KUNAL KAPOOR
CEO, Morningstar

"India isn't cheap despite the underperformance vs global markets over the past two years. The growth story remains attractive, but investors know that and continue to pay a premium for it," Kapoor said. "What matters is the price you pay. Today there are several emerging markets that screen more attractively than India from a valuation and expected return perspective."

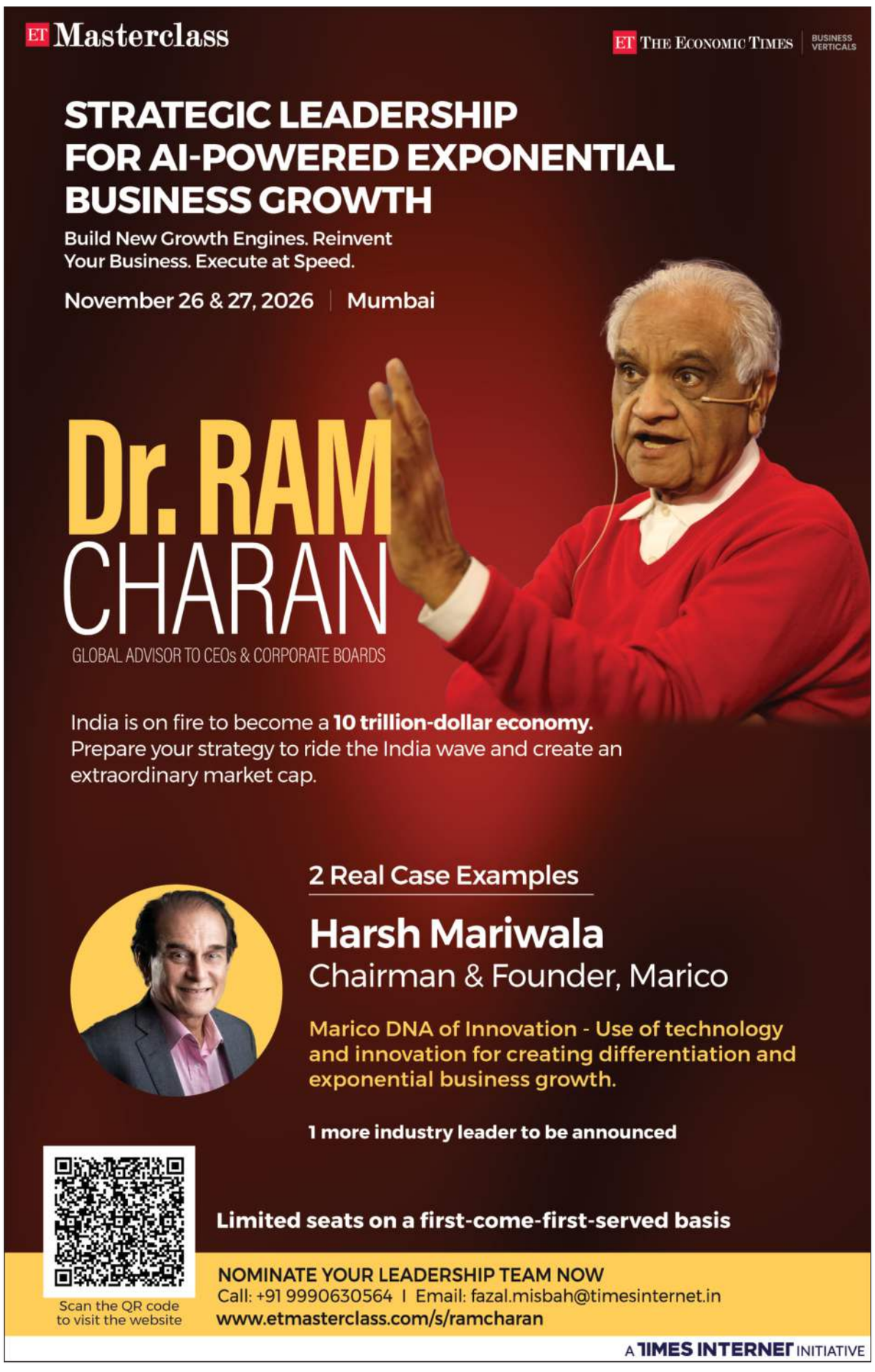
Foreign portfolio investors (FPIs) have remained net sellers since July 2025. In 2026, they have sold Indian equities worth ₹4.55 lakh crore. So far, in October, FPIs have net sold domestic equities worth ₹51,466 crore.

For Indian equities, sustained high oil prices would weigh on earnings and sentiment. But the long-term investment case still rests on productivity, demographics and economic growth and not on any single commodity cycle, he said.

Brent crude prices have risen more than 9% over the past month amid escalating geopolitical tensions and concerns over supply disruptions in the Middle East, with the global benchmark hovering around $115.06 per barrel.

Gold, meanwhile, can serve as a diversifier rather than a growth asset. "Gold has benefited as investors have looked for protection from uncertainty. But its role in a portfolio has not changed: it is a diversifier, not a growth asset."

"For most investors, that argues for a modest allocation rather than a large one," Kapoor said.



APL APOLLO TUBES LIMITED

CIN: L74899DL1986PLC023443
Regd. Office: 37, Hargobind Enclave, Vikas Marg, Delhi-110092
Corp. Office: SG Centre, 37C, Block A, Sector 132, Noida, U.P. 201304
Email: info@aplapollo.com | Website: www.aplapollo.com
Tel: 0120-6918000

APL APOLLO STEEL PIPES

REVENUE +26.58% Y-O-Y | EBITDA +30.90% Y-O-Y | PAT +26.82% Y-O-Y

EXTRACT OF STATEMENT OF CONSOLIDATED UNAUDITED FINANCIAL RESULTS FOR THE QUARTER AND HALF YEAR ENDED SEPTEMBER 30, 2026

(₹ in Crs. except earning per share data)

S. No	Particulars	Quarter ended Sep 30, 2026 (Unaudited)	Half Year ended Sep 30, 2026 (Unaudited)	Quarter ended Sep 30, 2025 (Unaudited)
1	Total Income from Operations	7,001.70	12,608.41	5,531.28
2	EBITDA	617.97	1,068.77	472.09
3	Net Profit/(Loss) for the period (before Tax, Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items)	499.70	852.13	386.36
4	Net Profit/(Loss) for the period before Tax (after Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items)	499.70	852.13	386.36
5	Net Profit/(Loss) for the period after Tax (after Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items)	382.42	645.53	301.54
6	Total Comprehensive income for the period	387.96	661.18	294.85
7	Equity Share Capital	55.54	55.54	55.53
8	Other Equity			
9	Earnings Per Share (face value of ₹2/-not annualised for quarterly figures) Basic: Diluted:	 13.62 13.61	 23.25 23.25	 10.86 10.86

Notes:

(₹ in Crs.)

1	Brief of standalone Unaudited Financial Results for the quarter and half year ended September 30, 2026:			
	Particulars	Quarter ended Sep 30, 2026 (Unaudited)	Half Year ended Sep 30, 2026 (Unaudited)	Quarter ended Sep 30, 2025 (Unaudited)
	Income from Operations	4,655.61	8,457.49	3,511.17
	Profit Before Tax	354.38	553.12	142.43
	Profit After Tax	265.13	412.11	106.24
2	The above is an extract of the detailed format of Unaudited Financial Results filed with the Stock Exchanges under Regulation 33 of the SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015. The full format of the Unaudited Financial Results are available on the websites of the Stock Exchange(s) (www.bseindia.com and www.nseindia.com) and on the Company's website "www.aplapollo.com". The same can be accessed by scanning the QR Code provided below:			

Place: Noida
Date: 26 October, 2026

For APL Apollo Tubes Limited
Sd/-
Deepak Kumar
Whole Time Director

A $160-BILLION LOAD

FCNR(B) Funding an Insurance, but it has to be Paid Back: Uday Kotak

Our Bureau

Mumbai: Uday Kotak, founder of Kotak Mahindra Bank, described India's foreign currency non-resident bank (FCNR(B)) deposit mobilisation scheme as a "strong insurance policy" against global economic and geopolitical shocks, but warned that policymakers must prepare for repayments of $160 billion to $170 billion, including interest, over the next three to five years.

Kotak, speaking at the Business Standard BFSI Summit, said the government and the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) had acted at the right time by mobilising foreign currency deposits amid heightened geopolitical tensions following the Middle East conflict and the Russia-Ukraine war. The scheme has strengthened India's foreign currency resources while the country continued to build its domestic macroeconomic fundamentals, he said.

Some people have called the FCNR(B) as a steroid, but I think about it as a strong insurance policy

UDAY KOTAK *Founder, Kotak Mahindra Bank*

"Some people have called the FCNR(B) as a steroid, but I think about it as a strong insurance policy," Kotak said, arguing that the funds had bought India valuable time to prepare for future external financing pressures.

However, he cautioned that the money would eventually have to be repaid and the total repayment obligation, including interest, could rise to $160 billion-$170 billion.

Indian banks have mobilised $133 billion under the FCNR(B) swap window.

"We don't need to panic about it today, but we must be strategic about it," Kotak said, urging policymakers and financial sector participants to prepare for the repayment pressure well before the deposits mature.

He said that the RBI decision to close the scheme on August 31 helped India lock in foreign currency funding before US bond yields rose sharply early September. The increase in yields would have made the borrowing at least 100 basis points more expensive had India mobilised the funds later, he said.

TURNING CAUTIOUS Financiers watch out for signs of stress, strengthen collection mechanism

NBFCs Put Brakes on Lending in Drought-hit Rural Markets

Sangita Mehta

Mumbai: India's top non-bank lenders, including Shriram Finance, Mahindra & Mahindra Financial Services and Bajaj Finance, are curbing fresh lending in drought-hit regions, trimming loan originations, strengthening collection efforts and closely monitoring borrowers for early signs of repayment stress.

India's southwest monsoon rainfall was 13% below normal in 2026, the weakest since 2015, with the southern peninsula reporting a 24% deficit. Karnataka, a key state for such lenders, reported a sharper 32% shortfall.

Lower farm output can depress rural incomes and consumption, slow economic activity and impair some borrowers' ability to repay loans on time. The impact of weak rainfall is now beginning to influence credit decisions beyond crop finance.

Shriram Finance is moderating lending in parts of Karnataka, central India and eastern Maharashtra after receiving ground-level reports of a slowdown in economic activity. The lender could also tighten loan-to-value ratios and intensify collection efforts if conditions deteriorate, MD and CEO Parag Sharma told **ET**.

"We are being watchful and are not increasing the lending book in such locations," Sharma said. "If the situation requires further action, we could revise loan-to-value norms or focus more closely on collections."

The company has lowered its loan-growth guidance to 15-17% from 18%, citing macroeconomic and seasonal factors, particularly the weak monsoon, executive vice-chairman Umesh Revankar said in an analyst call.

M&M Finance has also reduced funding in stressed locations during the second quarter while strengthening its collection infrastructure in vulnerable markets. The company is monitoring three states and 282 districts classified as drought-prone, MD and CEO Raul Rebello said during an analyst call.

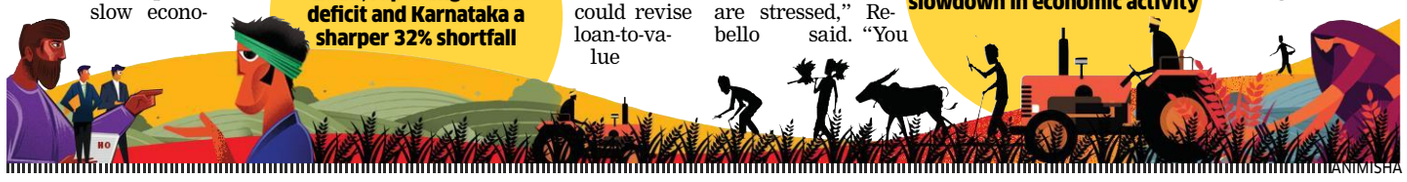
"Proactively, again in Q2, we have reduced some of the funding in some of these locations which are stressed," Rebello said. "You would be a little more conservative, keeping in mind the stress in those locations."

The lender has strengthened its in-house collection operations and engaged external collection infrastructure where required, he said. M&M Finance has also doubled its liquidity buffer in rupee terms from a year earlier amid risks arising from the West Asia crisis and the possibility of an El Niño-linked drought.

Bajaj Finance is tracking conditions across all 720 districts and reducing business in areas where drought is declared. The measures include cutting microfinance originations in certain districts and scaling back parts of its business-to-business lending.

Southwest monsoon rainfall was 13% below normal in 2026, the weakest since 2015, reporting a 24% deficit and Karnataka a sharper 32% shortfall

Shriram Finance is moderating lending in parts of Karnataka, central India and eastern Maharashtra after receiving ground-level reports of a slowdown in economic activity



ANIMISHA

IN FLOW The wastewater and solid waste treatment co has shown good growth in revenues, but its working capital needs are high

Environment Focus to Benefit SFC; Cash Flows a Concern

Sachin Kumar

ET Intelligence Group: SFC Environmental Technologies, a wastewater and solid waste treatment solutions provider, is positioned to benefit from rising investments in environmental infrastructure by state governments and urban local bodies. It has reported steady growth in revenue and profits, with better profit margin relative to peers. However, its cash flow has been uneven due to high working capital requirements. Also, top 10 customers contributed 64% to revenue in FY26 and government entities or government tenders accounted for 92% of revenue, exposing the company to concentration risk. Given these factors, investors with high risk appetite may consider the IPO for long term. The company plans to raise ₹150 crore through a fresh issue to repay debt and ₹517.5 crore through an offer for sale. The promoter shareholding will decline to 38.4% after the IPO from 48.2%.

A Green Bet

IPO Dates: **Oct 27-29**

IPO Price: **₹313 to ₹330**

Issue Size: **Up to ₹667.5 crore**

Implied Mcap: **Up to ₹3,232.6 cr**

Face Value: **₹2**

Retail Portion: **35%**

Lot Size: **45 shares**

IPO WATCH

BUSINESS

Incorporated in March 2005, SFC Environmental Technologies provides engineering solutions for wastewater treatment (WWT), wastewater recycling and reuse (WRR), and solid waste treatment (SWT). Its business spans technology design, engineering, equipment manufacturing and supply, installation and commissioning supervision, and operation and maintenance services. Its product portfolio includes decanters, diffusers, air blowers, fibre disc filters and solar sludge drying systems, as well as automated control and monitoring solutions for water and wastewater treatment plants. The company has a pan-India presence with 728 wastewater treatment installations across 23 states and five union territories as of July 31, 2026. According to Frost & Sullivan, it held more than 80% market share in sequencing batch reactor (SBR) technology, one of the key wastewater treatment technologies deployed in India. Repeat customers contributed nearly 92% of revenue in FY26. As of March 31, 2026, its order book reached ₹1,574.5 crore.

FINANCIALS

Revenue from operations grew 10.6% annually to ₹803.6 crore in FY26 from ₹657.5 crore in FY24. Operating margin before depreciation and amortisation (Ebitda margin) remained broadly stable at 29.3% in FY26, from 29.4% in FY24, indicating the company has largely been able to preserve margins while scaling up operations. Net profit increased 5% annually to ₹160 crore in FY26 from ₹144 crore in FY24. Return on equity (RoE) declined to 21.6% in FY26 from 29.8% in FY24, although it remained well above the peer range of 2-14%. Operating cash flow turned negative at ₹25.8 crore in FY26 compared with a positive ₹65.5 crore in FY25, largely due to higher working capital requirements arising from strong business growth. It was negative at ₹11.7 crore in FY24.

VALUATION

At the upper price band, the company is valued at 20.2 times its post-issue FY26 earnings, compared with 34-51 times for larger peers such as Ion Exchange India and Thermax.

Enviro Infra Engineers, which also provides water treatment solutions and reported a revenue of ₹1,146 crore in FY26, trades a trailing P/E of around 15. It had a lower Ebitda margin of around 24.2% and RoE of 15.3 in FY26 compared with SFC, which may justify the latter's valuation premium.

Outward FDI Falls 14% to $4.3 b in Sept

Our Bureau

Mumbai: Outward foreign direct investment (FDI) from India decreased 14% year-on-year to $4.34 billion in September this year from $5.04 billion a year ago, provisional Reserve Bank of India (RBI) data published Monday showed. The metric fell 37% from the $6.87 billion reported in the previous month.

Equity commitments outside India decreased 20% to $3.26 billion in September from $4.10 billion in August but were higher than the $2.59 billion reported a year ago. Loans extended to overseas subsidiaries increased to $549 million in September from $474 million in August. Loans were also down from the $981 million reported a year ago.

The RBI said the data is provisional and subject to revision based on final reporting by banks. Outward FDI commitments comprise equity, loans and guarantees. The amount of outward guarantees issued fell sharply to $528 million, month on month to $2.29 billion reported in August.

Equity outflows were led by Sun Pharma ($1.99 billion), followed by the $146 million investment by White Oak Investment and Knack Global $48 million outflow. On the loan side, Highway Constructions $80 million transfer to its UK subsidiary was the highest during the month. Paharpur Cooling Towers also issued a $103 million guarantee to its Singapore subsidiary in September, the data showed.

Tech Picks | DHARMESH SHAH *Head - Technical* | ICICI Securities

INDIAN HOTELS — BUY TARGET ₹838

Breakout from 12 months base formation augurs well for acceleration of upward momentum.

LAST CLOSE ▸ ₹795 STOP LOSS ▸ ₹769

PNB — BUY TARGET ₹129

Mean reversion to 20-, 50-day moving averages signals a strong price structure and buying scope.

LAST CLOSE ▸ ₹121 STOP LOSS ▸ ₹116

APOLLO MICRO SYSTEMS — BUY TARGET ₹433

Slower retracement near all-time highs signals healthy consolidation ahead of the next upmove.

LAST CLOSE ▸ ₹411 STOP LOSS ▸ ₹398

HIGH RATES MAY HIT DISCRETIONARY LOAN DEMAND

SBI Chief Expects 50 bps Rate Hike in Dec, Then a Pause

I don't think system-level concerns will be there, but there would be a concern in terms of individuals and households who have higher leverage now, and I don't know how much they can actually take absorption of the high interest rates...But broadly, from a system-level perspective, I don't think we should be really worried about asset quality on the retail front.

CS Setty SBI Chairman

Our Bureau

Mumbai: State Bank of India (SBI) chairman CS Setty on Monday said loan demand tied to discretionary spending could moderate as policy rates, raised early October for the first time since 2023, climb further to help restrain inflation.

"Interest rates definitely will influence the composition as well as the quantum of credit demand. Not necessarily immediately, (but) impact as we go forward," Setty said at a media event. "Rate-sensitive sectors, particularly discretionary-spending related borrowings probably would be moderated."

Indian monetary policymakers raised rates by 25 basis points for the first time in nearly four years in October in response to higher motor-fuel prices and amid risks of more generalised inflation. The increase in policy rates came after central banks in top industrial economies—from Japan to the US—raised policy rates to tame price pressures.

Setty expects a outsized 50 basis points hike in repo rate which is also the house view of the bank's economists when monetary policymakers meet next in December. Meanwhile, the rate-setting panel in the US meets this week in its final such deliberation ahead of the mid-term elections scheduled next week.

One basis point is a hundredth of a percentage point.

Setty, however, said that an anticipated moderation in credit demand would not mean significant contraction in credit in the world's fastest-expanding major economy.

"But I would like to differentiate between the weakening credit cycle and the moderation in credit demand. I think we need to distinguish that," Setty said.

He said the country is entering the rate hike cycle with a robust growth rate projection of 7.1%, which means the real economy's demand for credit will help the banking sector expand its asset book.

Setty said SBI expects another 50-basis point hike in December after which the rate cycle will pause a bit.

Replying to a question on asset quality on whether the higher rates could lead to defaults Setty said he does not expect system level concerns.

"I don't think the system level concerns will be there, but there would be a concern in terms of individuals and households who have higher leverage now and I don't know how much they can actually absorb the high interest rates. But broadly, from a system level perspective, I don't think we should be really worried about the asset quality on the retail front," Setty said.

He however said that higher rates will not mean getting deposits will be easy for banks as there is only so much the rates can propel customers.

"What we also have seen fundamentally, (is that) the shift is not only happening from the bank deposits to other alternative instruments."

Short Takes

IOB Plans $500m ECB Raise in 2 Tranches by December

KOLKATA State-owned Indian Overseas Bank is looking to raise $500 million in external commercial borrowing in two equal tranches by the end of December using the Reserve Bank of India's (RBI) concessional swap facility. The first tranche of $250 million will be raised at 6-6.25% rate in the next couple of weeks, MD Ajay Kumar Srivastava told **ET**. "We have decided to go for a staggered ECB mobilisation to make it most cost effective. There is consistent credit demand but mobilising lendable resources at one go and keeping it idle does not make sense," Srivastava said. Earlier, IOB mobilised $1.2 billion in FCNR (B) deposits through the RBI's dedicated window while the MD said that the entire amount has already been deployed. While the concessional facility for retail deposits was withdrawn from August 31, the latitude extends until the year end for funds mobilised through the ECB and overseas foreign currency borrowings routes.

BoM Net Up 42% at ₹2,310 cr, Asset Quality Improves in Q2

KOLKATA Bank of Maharashtra reported a 41.5% jump in second quarter net profit at ₹2,310 crore as compared with ₹1,633 crore in the year ago period, backed by business growth and asset quality improvement. The bank's return on assets improved to 2% for the second quarter from 1.8% a year prior. "We are now in the 2% club and we will take steps to maintain RoA at 2% plus," MD Nidhu Saxena said. The lender's operating profit stood 31% higher at ₹3,369 crore against ₹2,574 crore for the corresponding quarters, riding on 22% increase in net interest income at ₹3,954 crore and 34% surge in non-interest income at ₹1,129 crore. The provision and contingencies were lower at ₹654 crore for the quarter against ₹756 crore a year prior even after making an additional ₹500 crore provision as a preparation for the credit loss regime from next fiscal.

Dhanlaxmi Bank Net Profit Surges 110% to ₹49 crore

KOLKATA Dhanlaxmi Bank reported a net profit of ₹48.6 crore for the second quarter against ₹23.2 crore in the year-ago period, registering a 110% surge. Operating profit for the quarter stood at ₹69.8 crore, growing 148% year-on-year over ₹28.2 crore. Its asset quality improved with gross non-performing assets falling to 1.8% at the end of September from 3.1% a year prior. Net NPA improved to 0.5% from 1.1% over the same period.

Tamilnad Mercentile Bank Profit Climbs 42% to ₹451 cr

KOLKATA: Private sector lender Tamilnad Mercantile Bank reported a 42% year-on-year jump in net profit at ₹451 crore for the July-September quarter as against ₹318 crore in the year ago period. Its operating profit also grew 42% higher at ₹642 crore against ₹452 crore. The bank's asset quality improved with gross non-performing assets falling to 0.6% at the end of September from 1% a year prior. Net NPA improved to 0.1% from 0.3% over the same period. **Our Bureau**

SBI Opens Cybersecurity Centre for Digital Safety, Capabilities

Mumbai: State Bank of India (SBI), has inaugurated CyRIS, a Cybersecurity Centre of Excellence. The centre will focus on emerging digital safety and capability areas including threat intelligence, cyber defence, digital forensics, malware analysis, ethical hacking, fraud analytics, AI security and quantum-safe technologies.

CyRIS will also foster collaboration with government and regulatory bodies, financial institutions, fintechs, academia and technology partners, recognising that cyber threats increasingly cross organisational boundaries. The centre was inaugurated by Sanjay Lohiya, secretary, department of financial Services. — **Our Bureau**

Diesel Biggest Contributor

▸▸ From Page 1

Diesel prices faced additional pressure from attacks on Russian refineries and tighter supply-demand conditions, pushing prices to record highs in some months.

Diesel, India's biggest petroleum product export, drove much of the earnings growth. Export earnings from the fuel increased 58% in rupee terms to about ₹1.2 lakh crore despite a 19% decline in volume. In dollar terms, earnings increased 48%, while average regional diesel benchmark prices rose to $151 per barrel. Petrol export earnings increased 21% in rupee terms to ₹58,000 crore and 13% in dollar terms, despite a 24% fall in volume.

Average regional petrol benchmark prices increased to $120 per barrel. Diesel and petrol together accounted for nearly 70% of India's petroleum export earnings in rupee terms.

The decline in export volume reflects a tightening domestic surplus as demand expanded while production stagnated, an industry executive said.

Domestic consumption remained strong despite geopolitical uncertainty and domestic price increases, leaving refiners with less fuel to sell overseas.

In the six months to September, diesel and petrol consumption grew 5% and 7%, respectively, while production fell 0.3% and 0.8%, respectively.

India primarily exports diesel, petrol, jet fuel, naphtha and fuel oil. Diesel made up 42% of petroleum product exports by volume, while petrol made up 23%.

Reliance Industries accounts for about 70% of India's fuel exports, with Rosneft-backed Nayara Energy, state-run MRPL and other refiners supplying the remainder.

The rupee has remained under pressure over the past six months amid elevated crude oil prices and foreign capital outflows.

Higher oil prices increase dollar demand from domestic refiners paying for imported crude, which accounts for nearly 90% of domestic consumption.

About a quarter of the dollars spent on importing crude and fuels returns through exports. By volume, India exports a fifth of the crude and fuel it imports.

Filing with Corp Affairs Ministry

▸▸ From Page 1

The immediate trigger for reiterating those concerns in the latest letter was the company's filing with the ministry of corporate affairs confirming Chandrasekaran's reappointment despite an objection from a sitting director, they said.

In the letter to Tata Sons company secretary Suprakash Mukhopadhyay, Noel Tata referred to his earlier letters, of September 30 and October 8, in which he had raised objections to the September 17 board meeting and its draft minutes. He sought the meeting's audio and video recordings, the final minutes, voting records and documents filed with the Registrar of Companies, asking that these be provided within seven days. Both measures — giving Chandrasekaran another five-year term and starting process of listing — were taken by the board despite Noel Tata's objections.

The September resolution reappointed Chandrasekaran for five years from February 21, 2027, with substantial management powers, according to the letter. Noel Tata said he had not received a certified copy of the resolution or the final or signed minutes of the meeting, despite his earlier requests. The recordings were necessary to verify proceedings and establish whether his objections to the draft minutes were addressed, he said.

IN QUESTION

Noel Tata questioned the meeting agenda, saying neither the original nor revised versions explicitly identified a resolution on the executive chairman's reappointment

Noel Tata also questioned the meeting agenda, saying neither the original nor revised versions explicitly identified a resolution on the executive chairman's reappointment. The original agenda described the relevant item as a debriefing from the nomination and remuneration committee, while the revised agenda added a discussion of a September 11 letter from the Reserve Bank of India and related applications.

He alleged that no selection committee had been constituted under Article 118 of the company's Articles of Association and that the affirmative vote required under Articles 118 and 121 had not been obtained. He asked the company to notify the Registrar of Companies that the resolution's validity was disputed and refrain from further action until the meeting record was settled.

The letter also raises questions about disclosures concerning Hanno One Warehousing Pvt Ltd, said to be controlled by Chandrasekaran's wife and son, and its reported business dealings with TVS Motor Co., where Venu Srinivasan is chairman emeritus. Noel Tata sought records of relevant disclosures and communications, as well as details of how the matter had been considered by the board and its committees. He alleged Srinivasan participated in discussions and voting on Chandrasekaran's reappointment despite the potential conflict of interest. He sought records of the nomination and remuneration committee meeting held on Sept 3 and details of the legal opinions obtained on the reappointment.

LTCG Mopup ₹1.3 Lcr in FY25

▸▸ From Page 1

There is a boom in AI-led stocks overseas. The FM's comment had led to a rise in stocks. The Indian stock market has lost $924 billion in market capitalisation since its September 2024 peak.

Any decision on LTCG or STT will have to take into account the revenue impact, especially with the rise in fertiliser subsidy bills due to the West Asia conflict and the funding required for large social sector programmes .

The idea is to examine the concerns of stakeholders and the suggestions they have. In FY25, total LTCG collection was ₹1.29 lakh crore, almost twice the ₹72,249 crore collected in the preceding year. Market participants raised the matter of LTCG and STT being simultaneously levied, flagging it as double taxation.

With large FPI outflows from equities this year, the clamour for changes to the LTCG regime have intensified. India had scrapped long-term capital gains tax and withholding tax on interest earned on government securities held by FPIs in June this year, raising hopes of relief for equities as well.

Some opposition voices have pointed that doing away with the levies would substantially erode the pool of taxes shared with states.

Currently, long-term capital gains, which is levied on stocks held for more than 12 months, is 12.5% for both domestic and foreign portfolio investors. Including cess and surcharges, this comes to nearly 15%.

Additionally, equity investments face securities transaction tax (STT) at 0.1% each on the buyer and seller and stamp duty of 0.015% on the buyer.

STT collections in FY26 amounted to Rs 57,522 crore. Collections rose 52% to Rs 46,840 crore during the period from April 1 to October 14 from the year before.

Tax practitioners said Indian capital markets need to be competitive with those in other countries.

"In today's highly volatile geopolitical environment, India needs to compete with the entire spectrum of countries including the US, UK, Singapore, Hong Kong, South Korea and Taiwan, all of which do not tax non-residents on capital gains in securities traded in these jurisdictions," said Sudhir Kapadia, senior advisor, KPMG Assurance and Consulting Services LLP.

Expressways ease the journey to faith

Improved transport links ensure faster journeys to Uttar Pradesh's sacred destinations

Uttar Pradesh has established a distinct identity as India's 'Expressway State'. Till now, the state had 10 expressway projects that were operational, under construction or proposed. Major routes include the Ganga, Purvanchal, Bundelkhand, Yamuna, Agra–Lucknow and Gorakhpur Link expressways.

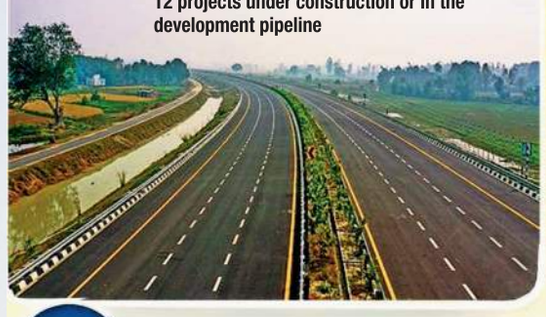
Connectivity through expressways and air travel has made religious tourism in Uttar Pradesh more convenient, particularly during the festive season, when large numbers of devotees travel to temples, pilgrimage centres and religious gatherings. Expressways help reduce travel time between major cities and religious destinations, while improved road networks make the onward journey easier. Air connectivity offers an additional option for visitors travelling from distant parts of the country, allowing them to reach key cities more quickly and continue their journey by road.

KEY CONNECTIVITY HIGHLIGHTS

SMARTER TRAVEL. STRONGER LINKS. A MORE CONNECTED UTTAR PRADESH.

EXPRESSWAYS

Uttar Pradesh has a significant share of the country's expressway network, with 10 operational expressways and 12 projects under construction or in the development pipeline

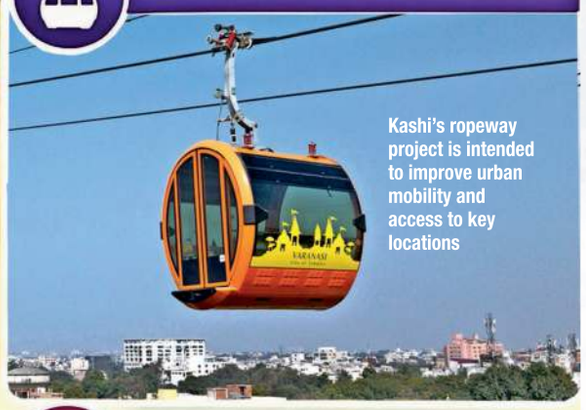


DELHI-MEERUT CORRIDOR

The Delhi-Meerut corridor has seen improved connectivity, reducing travel time between the two cities

KASHI ROPEWAY PROJECT

Kashi's ropeway project is intended to improve urban mobility and access to key locations



RAIL NETWORK

The state's rail network is being strengthened through high-speed and modern train services

NOIDA INTERNATIONAL AIRPORT

New airport infrastructure, including Noida International Airport, is expanding air connectivity

MULTIMODAL TRANSPORT

Varanasi is developing as a major centre for multimodal transport, linking road, rail and waterways

AI GENERATED INFOGRAPHIC

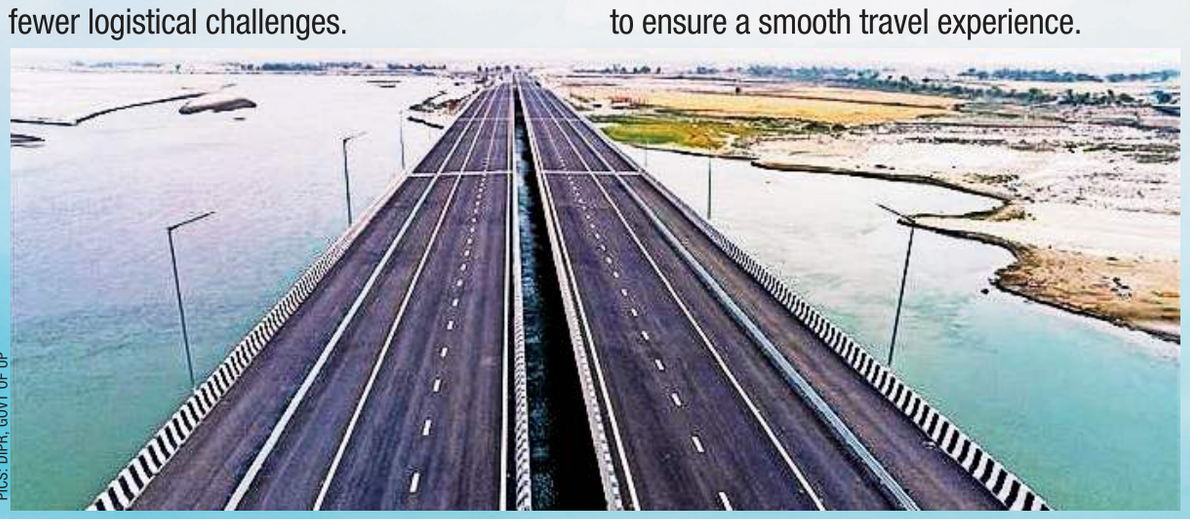
IMPROVED ACCESS DRIVES UTTAR PRADESH'S DEVELOPMENT

- Uttar Pradesh has the country's largest rail network, spanning approximately 16,000 kilometres
- The state is emerging as a logistics hub, with the country's largest expressway network
- Varanasi is developing the country's first freight village across 100 acres

EASIER ACCESS

Destinations such as Ayodhya, Varanasi, Mathura-Vrindavan and Prayagraj benefit from improved access, especially during festivals such as Diwali, Dev Deepawali, Janmashtami and the Magh Mela. This helps pilgrims plan short trips, travel more comfortably and access destinations with fewer logistical challenges.

This connectivity also supports the movement of tourists across multiple religious sites, benefiting hotels, transport operators, local markets and other businesses. During peak festive periods, however, effective traffic management, public transport and crowd control remain essential to ensure a smooth travel experience.



PICS: DIPR, GOVT OF UP

SALIENT FEATURES

Expressways	Length
Ganga Expressway	594 km
Purvanchal Expressway	341 km
Lucknow–Agra Expressway	302 km
Bundelkhand Expressway	296 km
Delhi–Saharanpur–Dehradun Expressway	212 km
Yamuna Expressway	165 km
Delhi–Meerut Expressway	96 km
Gorakhpur Link Expressway	91.35 km
Lucknow–Kanpur Expressway	63 km
Noida–Greater Noida Expressway	25 km

CONNECTIVITY STRENGTHENS UTTAR PRADESH'S DEVELOPMENT

Better roads. Stronger links. A brighter future.

FREIGHT CONNECTIVITY

The Eastern Dedicated Freight Corridor passes through Uttar Pradesh, strengthening industrial connectivity and facilitating efficient freight movement

NATIONAL WATERWAYS

11 of India's 111 national waterways are in the state, strengthening its position as a northern logistics hub

NATIONAL HIGHWAYS

90 national highways connect the state with the rest of the country

WATER TRANSPORT

The 425-km Varanasi-Haldia National Waterway supports freight, trade and religious tourism, including access to Ayodhya

MULTIMODAL TRANSPORT

Varanasi is developing the country's first multimodal terminal, with additional terminals and freight villages in Ramnagar, Chandauli, Mirzapur and Ghazipur

ROAD DEVELOPMENT

Road infrastructure is being improved through regular construction, widening and strengthening to enhance connectivity

INDUSTRIAL CORRIDORS

Integrated manufacturing clusters are being developed in Prayagraj and Agra under the Amritsar-Kolkata Industrial Corridor

RURAL ROADS

Rural roads have been upgraded and reconstructed, improving connectivity to villages and smaller settlements across the state

SUITS & SAYINGS

ET's roundup of the wackiest whispers in corporate corridors

Long Wait

The road to Dalal Street can sometimes run through the family dining room. At a closely held consumer business, professional managers have been quietly laying the groundwork for a long-awaited public listing. But while preparations have been gathering pace, the promoters appear to be in no hurry. The two siblings who call the shots are said to be divided over how much of the company to offer to the public and, more importantly, when. The uncertainty is beginning to test the patience of executives who have spent considerable time preparing for the IPO. Some are also counting on the listing to finally unlock the value of their stock options. For now, though, the family seems happy to let the matter simmer. And the executives are left wondering just how much longer they must wait for their share of the cookie.

Unsettling Effect

A health insurer that promises peace of mind to its customers appears to be giving some of its former employees sleepless nights. A growing number of ex-staffers, including retirees, allege that their legitimate dues remain unsettled long after they have left the company. Adding to their woes, the HR department is said to have warned that escalating the matter could only delay payments further. A third-party associate is also reportedly involved in the affair. But some former employees are in no mood to swallow the bitter pill and have now knocked on the doors of the authorities. For an insurer, the irony is hard to miss: those in the business of settling claims are now facing claims of their own. And this one may not be so easily settled.

Privy to the whispers in power corridors or juicy tips on India Inc? Do share with us at **etsuits.sayings@timesofindia.com**

In A Nutshell

Snacking Brand Troovy Raises $10 m

NEW DELHI Clean-label, digital-first snacking brand Troovy has formalised a new fund raise of $10 million (₹100 crore), in a round led by Fireside Ventures and Sharrp Ventures, twice the amount it raised earlier this year. The development comes at a time when India is set to introduce front-pack labelling for foods high in sugar, salt and fats. **Our Bureau**

'Most Indian 2-wheeler Buyers Considering EVs'

NEW DELHI Around 43% of two-wheeler buyers surveyed are actively considering an electric vehicle, up from 30% in 2024, while outright rejection has dropped from 38% to 29%, according to a BCG report released on Monday.

CORPORATE SCORECARD

Tata Consumer Q2 Net Up Despite Higher Costs, Weak Tea Demand

Co leans on salt and new businesses to sustain growth, also hikes tea prices by 8-10%

Aanya Thakur

Mumbai: Weak tea demand and rising commodity costs are putting pressure on Tata Consumer Products' core business, prompting the company to lean on salt and newer businesses to sustain growth.

Tea volumes remained flat in the September quarter, while unusually hot weather hurt its UK business, even as the consumer goods maker reported double-digit growth in revenue and profit. India tea and coffee revenue declined 1% year-on-year to ₹1,244 crore, with flat volumes amid weak category demand. This decline comes in the midst of broader tepid industry performance, with about 6% drop in overall volumes.

"The overall industry has been soft," chief executive Sunil D'Souza told investors on Monday. "If I look at overall third-party numbers, it's about negative six." The company raised tea prices by 8-10% between the June quarter and now to offset input cost inflation. According to D'Souza, the increases had covered the inflation so far, but their full impact is yet to reflect in financials. He flagged the buying cycle after the festive season as a factor to watch. Tata Consumer's margin ambitions remain vulnerable to volatility in commodity and operating costs, including oil, packaging, freight and fuel, said D'Souza.

"If oil was not at $115 and there was no huge swings on the entire packaging, freight, fuel, all these kind of pieces, I think we would be in a position to deliver," D'Souza said, referring to the company's target of achieving an Ebitda margin of 17-20% in its Indian food and beverage business.

He said the company expected to reach that range in about three years, while acknowledging that the path would involve setbacks.

Commodity inflation weighed on its India business this quarter where margins narrowed to 11.1% from 11.5% a year earlier, despite revenue rising 17% to ₹3,666 crore. Chief financial officer Ashish Goenka attributed this contraction largely to inflation in salt, adding calibrated price increases had already been taken.

Salt, meanwhile, is closing the gap with tea and coffee. Revenue from this business rose 15% to ₹1,099 crore, supported by 9% volume growth, while value-added and premium salt volumes grew 17%. The company also raised prices of its standard orange salt pack from ₹30 to ₹32 in May, and to ₹34 on October 1.

International revenue rose 7% to ₹1,256 crore but fell 2% in constant currency against a high base. In the UK, revenue fell 8% in constant currency as a prolonged heatwave hurt tea consumption. Consolidated revenue from operations rose 14% to ₹5,661 crore in quarter, while the net profit grew 16% to ₹470 crore. Ebitda grew 18% to ₹794 crore in the period.

In Control

14% Revenue growth lifted quarterly operations

16% Net profit growth

18% Ebitda growth

1% India tea and coffee revenue decline reflected flat volumes

11.1% India margins narrowed from **11.5%** amid salt inflation

15% Salt revenue growth reached **₹1,099 cr**

7% Int'l revenue growth reached **₹1,256 cr**

ITC Hotels Profit Rises 52% in Q2 on 'Strong' Domestic Play

Our Bureau

New Delhi: ITC Hotels has reported revenue from operations of ₹1,054 crore for the second quarter of this fiscal year, up 26% year on year. The chain posted a net profit of ₹203 crore, up 52% year on year.

The chain's Ebitda stood at ₹337 crore, up 37% year on year. ITC Hotels said it signed 20 new hotels in the first half of FY27 and that its managed pipeline is at 84 hotels with 8,200 keys. The chain said it has completed the acquisition of the 130-key Welcomhotel Ahmedabad. It has also been allotted a 2.8 acres land parcel in Lucknow by Lucknow Development Authority.

The chain said its room revenue grew 22% on year, driven by growth in rates and volumes. The performance was supported by 'healthy' transient demand across key markets and buoyancy in MICE (meetings, incentives, conferences and exhibitions) business, aided by BRICS Summit in New Delhi. Occupancy rate rose 481 bps to 76%. Average daily rates grew 14%, resulting in revenue per available room growth of 21% on year.

The chain said its food and beverage revenue grew 12% year on year led by speciality restaurants, lounges and bars and banqueting.

ITC Hotels said despite international tourist arrivals slowing amid geopolitical uncertainties and a softer global economic environment, and declining domestic air passengers traffic during the quarter under review, India's hospitality industry continued to demonstrate resilience, supported by 'strong' domestic demand, 'favourable' supply-demand dynamics and 'improving' connectivity across the country.

"In addition to stronger second-half demand cycle, near-term outlook for hospitality industry remains encouraging, driven by sustained demand from business and leisure travel and limited incremental supply in key markets," ITC Hotels said in a statement.

GROWTH IN ROOMS

Revenue rose to ₹1,054 crore in Q2; hotel chain added 20 new hotels in H1 of FY27, taking its pipeline to 84

MakeMyTrip Back in the Black with $1.8-million Profit in Second Quarter

Our Bureau

New Delhi: MakeMyTrip has reported a net profit of $1.8 million in quarter two of this fiscal year compared to a net loss of $5.7 million in the corresponding period of the previous fiscal year.

The company reported revenues of $235.2 million for quarter two this year, up 11.2% in constant currency terms. The company reported an adjusted operated profit of $46.2 million in quarter two of this fiscal compared to $44.2 million in corresponding period of previous fiscal year.

Group CEO Rajesh Magow said the company delivered 'strong' growth despite a 'challenging' travel environment, with gross bookings increasing 20.9% year on year in constant currency terms to $2.7 billion in quarter two.

"Growth in hotels and ground transport underscored the resilience of our diversified portfolio and our ability to serve evolving customer needs," he said.

"We are using AI to simplify travel planning and booking, supported by our extensive supply network, integrated distribution platform and trusted service. We continue to invest with discipline to capture India's long-term travel opportunity and deliver sustainable, profitable growth," he added.

The company said it saw strong growth in adjusted margins across segments with air ticketing growing 14.3%, hotels and packages growing 20.2%, bus ticketing growing 29.0% and others growing 29.8% year on year in constant currency terms. MakeMyTrip said it continues to build on its AI initiatives.

The company said AI powered travel assistant Myra engaged in over 90,000 daily conversations across multiple Indian languages and English, of which more than 55% originated from tier two and tier three cities in India, during the quarter ended September 30, 2026.

Co reported revenues of $235.2 m in Q2, up 11.2% in constant currency terms

Tesla India Sees Robust Profit and Revenue Growth in FY26

Our Bureau

Mumbai: The Indian unit of Elon Musk-backed electric vehicle maker Tesla reported revenue of ₹247.3 crore and a net profit of ₹5.2 crore in FY26, with vehicle sales accounting for nearly 87% of sales in its first full year of retail operations in the country.

Revenue from operations surged nearly 12-fold from ₹20.8 crore in FY25, while net profit rose from ₹55.5 lakh, according to regulatory filings by Tesla India Motors and Energy.

Vehicle sales contributed ₹214.69 crore to revenue during the year, while services generated ₹32.4 crore. In FY25, the company's revenue came entirely from services-related operations, before vehicle sales started contributing from last fiscal year.

The strong financial performance was backed by Tesla expanding its presence in India following the opening of its first showroom in Mumbai in 2025. The company registered 346 vehicles between September 2025 and March 2026.

Sales momentum has since picked up, with registrations reaching 650 units in the first half of this fiscal, surpassing the entire previous fiscal year's tally. Average monthly registrations rose from around 49 units during the initial launch phase to about 108 units.

Tesla also stepped up investments in its Indian operations. The company infused about ₹86 crore into the local unit in FY26, the filings showed.

87% SHARE OF VEHICLE SALES IN TESLA'S TURNOVER

Cash expenditure on property, plant and equipment and capital work-in-progress rose to ₹62.5 crore in FY26 from ₹1.2 crore in the previous fiscal, indicating a sharp increase in capital spending.

Separately, Musk showcased a new version of Tesla's Roadster sports car in October. During a demonstration at a SpaceX facility in Texas, a prototype navigated an elevated curved track before briefly becoming airborne and landing safely, drawing comparisons with concept of a flying car.

Mankind Pharma Q2 Profit Rises 38% to ₹716 crore

PTI

New Delhi: Mankind Pharma on Monday posted a 37.7% rise in profit to ₹716 crore in the September quarter, driven by strong business growth in domestic and international markets.

The company had posted a profit after tax (PAT) of ₹520.2 crore in the year-ago period, according to a regulatory filing. Revenue from operations increased to ₹4,337.9 crore during the quarter under review as against ₹3,697.2 crore in the year-ago period, the company said in a regulatory filing.

"Our disciplined execution and strengthening business fundamentals resulted in strong performance. Our recent acquisition of Armed Cell Therapeutics marks strategic entry into Next-Generation CAR-T therapies, strengthening R&D capabilities for future growth," vice chairman & managing director Rajeev Juneja said.

VACANCY LEVELS COME DOWN

India's Office Leasing Hits New Peak Amid Surging New Supplies

Gross leasing in top mkts crosses 61m sq ft in first nine months of 2026; net absorption up 5%: Report

Kailash Babar

Mumbai: India's office space market is witnessing sustained occupier demand alongside a steady pipeline of new supply as rising absorption and fresh property completions shape vacancy trends across the country's major business districts.

While new supply led to a marginal sequential rise in vacancy in the first nine months of 2026, it is still less the year-ago levels, reflecting continued demand for office space. Gross leasing across India's top seven office markets hit a record 61.06 million sq ft in the first nine months of 2026, while net absorption rose 5.3% year-on-year to a record 41.96 million sq ft, showed JLL India data.

"With active negotiations continuing and more GCCs preparing to set up here, 2026 is set to comfortably go past last year's record. Companies aren't waiting for global uncertainty to clear. They are building in India because this is where their talent and growth are," said Radha Dhir, CEO, India, JLL.

She said annual gross leasing volumes are on track to hit the 100 million sq ft mark in two to three years. Vacancy across the seven markets stood at 14.8%, up 30 basis points sequentially but down 90 bps year-on-year. New office completions reached 43.7 million sq ft in the first nine months, the highest for this period in the post-Covid phase.

Mumbai and Delhi-NCR recorded their lowest vacancy levels in 16 and 15 years, respectively. Prime office districts across cities continued to report single-digit vacancy, with occupiers showing a preference for established business locations and premium assets.

"The office market is increasingly being shaped by occupiers' focus on workplace quality, operational efficiency and access to talent," said Shashank Jain, CEO & MD, Brookfield India Real Estate Trust. "Global companies are evaluating office portfolios not just on cost, but also on the ability of workplaces to support collaboration, employee experience and long-term business growth. This is creating a clear distinction between assets that meet evolving occupier expectations and those that do not."

Leasing activity strengthened in the July-September quarter, rising 40.9% sequentially to 23.17 million sq ft after mid-year slowdown. Bengaluru was the largest office market, accounting for 17.11 million sq ft of gross leasing in first nine months, up 15.4% on year. Hyderabad saw a 32% increase to 9.93 million sq ft, while Mumbai's leasing grew 17.7% to 8.75 million sq ft. Pune reported growth of 31.6% to 8.25 million sq ft.

Checking In

CITY | LEASING | RISE (YEAR-ON-YEAR RISE IN JAN-SEPT)

BENGALURU 17.1 m sq ft **15.4%**

HYDERABAD 9.9 m sq ft **32%**

MUMBAI 8.8 m sq ft **17.7%**

PUNE 8.3 m sq ft **31.6%**

Source: JLL India

ET GRAPHICS

In Maximum City, a Luxe Home is Where Heart Is

Mumbai's luxury housing market remained robust in the first half of the financial year, with strong demand for high-value homes and momentum building through the second quarter. Premium neighbourhoods led the market, while a rise in ultra-luxury transactions and high-rent leases underscored sustained appetite for the city's top-end residential properties.

Text: **KAILASH BABAR**

17 luxury homes worth **₹178 crore** were sold daily in Mumbai during H1 FY27

1,651 deals were registered in Q2, **up 10.5%** from Q1

₹32,623 crore was generated from **3,145 luxury-home deals**

₹17,600 crore* was generated in Q2, **up 17.1%** or **₹191 crore** daily

20 deals above **₹50 crore** were recorded in Q2, up from 9 in Q1

618 homes worth **₹6,669 crore** were sold in July, the best month of H1 2026

₹5,558 cr worth of homes were sold in Worli across **275 deals**, accounting for **17%** of total luxury sales

Eight homes were leased for **₹20 lakh** or more a month between June and September

*Deal value **Source:** Lighthouse Luxury

Hyundai Bets Mass-market SUVs Will Help Outperform Peers, Regain Share

Co looks to increase yearly volumes to 250K, expects SUVs to drive 75% of sales from FY28: India MD

Our Bureau

New Delhi: Hyundai Motor India expects the introduction of two mass-market SUVs including an electric vehicle in the second half of FY27 to inject greater thrust into its efforts to expand its presence in the domestic car industry.

Tarun Garg, managing director at Hyundai Motor India told **ET** that the company is aiming to sell at least 250,000 units of the Creta and the new Bayon in 2027 as it looks to maintain leadership in the fast-growing mid-size SUV segment, up from 170,000 units this calendar year.

"Along with Creta and Bayon, we are looking at a volume of over 250,000 units per annum going forward," he said. "With this volume, very clearly, we can continue with our segment leadership in the mid-SUV segment. And 250,000 units is not a limit; it is a baseline; we will continue to grow."

The mid-size utility vehicle segment, which includes models between 4-4.4 meters in length (SUVs and MPVs), accounted for around 900,000 units in FY26, per data from the Society of Indian Automobile Manufacturers (SIAM). The segment contributed nearly 35% of Hyundai's total domestic sales in FY26.

"Both the models we have scheduled for launch this fiscal are mass-market products," he said. "While Bayon (launched Monday) is positioned in one of the fastest growing segments (mid SUV), our grounds-up mass-market EV will come in early next calendar year. With this we are targeting outperforming the market and regaining our magnet share."

The local car market is expected to grow at about 5-6%, on a high base, in the second half of FY27, said Garg. Hyundai is aiming to outperform the industry with a more than 8% sales growth in the same period, he said.

Garg said the company expects to generate nearly 75% of total sales from SUVs starting FY28, up from 68-69% currently.

The new Bayon, at a starting ex-showroom price of ₹9.99 lakh, is positioned between the sub 4-meter compact SUV Venue and mid-size SUV Creta in Hyundai's portfolio. The automaker is adding the model as it seeks to expand in the segment with a second product, while Creta sales have come under pressure of late.

Hyundai previously had only the Creta in this segment, compared with three models from Maruti Suzuki—Grand Vitara, Victoris, and Ertiga, and two from Tata Motors—Curvv and Sierra.

Creta sales fell more than 9% year-on-year to 89,727 units in the fiscal first half, underperforming a more than 50% surge in industry volumes. Garg cited limited supplies of diesel models to the market as a reason, saying the diesel variant of Creta has a waiting period of more than one month.

Hyundai will manufacture the Bayon at its Chennai plant. He said the model will help raise utilisation at the plant after the production of Venue was moved to the new Pune facility. With Bayon, the automaker now has 10 models in its portfolio—six SUVs, two sedans and two hatchbacks across diesel, petrol and CNG and electric offerings.

In May 2025, Hyundai announced plans to launch 26 models in India by the end of this decade.

Along with Creta and Bayon, we are looking at over 250,000 units per annum. With this volume, we can continue with our segment leadership in mid-SUVs

TARUN GARG
MD, Hyundai Motor India

COMPANY PHOTO

AFTER STARBUCKS PLAN FAILS

A Fresh Brew: Trent Set to Serve up Caffè Nero at Westside, Zudio Outlets

Kala Vijayraghavan & Sagar Malviya

Mumbai: Tata Group retailer Trent signed a licensing agreement with British coffee chain Caffè Nero to open cafes within its Westside and Zudio stores, people familiar with the matter said, even though the group has an existing joint venture with Starbucks.

The agreement follows the breakdown of discussions over a similar arrangement between Trent and Tata Starbucks — the joint venture between Tata Consumer Products and US-based Starbucks Coffee Co, the people said. The two sides could not agree on nature of the stores and locations in which Starbucks would operate within Trent's retail network.

Starbucks wanted a prominent, front-facing presence within Trent's stores, while the retailer was unwilling to accommodate such an arrangement, the people said. Differences over the extent of Starbucks' control over store formats and locations also contributed to the breakdown.

Harish Bhat, a Tata veteran associated with the development of Starbucks in India, recently stepped down from Trent's board to avoid any potential conflict of interest, the people said.

The commercial terms of the Caffè Nero agreement, the rollout schedule and the number of cafes planned could not be immediately ascertained. Trent and Caffè Nero did not comment.

CHANGING MARKET

Retailers globally have added cafes to shopping destinations, to give customers reasons to visit, spend time in stores

Retailers globally have increasingly added cafes and food offerings to shopping destinations, seeking to give customers more reasons to visit and spend time in physical stores. Coffee can complement shopping trips while offering retailers an additional way to differentiate their stores from online competitors.

Coffee chains such as Starbucks have benefited globally from takeaway-led consumption, which can generate sales without requiring customers to occupy cafe seating for extended periods. In India, however, officegoers and students often use cafes as places to relax, work or socialise, spending hours over coffee and snacks.

High real estate costs make the economics of cafe space particularly important in India, where retailers need to maximise revenue per square foot.

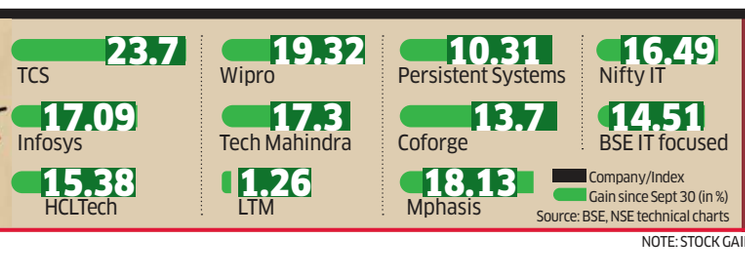
For Trent, the partnership provides access to a specialist coffee brand without having to develop its own cafe business. Westside, its fashion and lifestyle chain, and Zudio, the value-fashion format, offer Nero a potential route to reach shoppers through an established retail network.

Caffè Nero was founded in London in 1997 and expanded internationally with its European-style coffeehouse format. The privately held group operates in several countries, including the UK, the US and parts of Europe and the Middle East.

The Trent agreement could provide a platform for a large presence in India, although the scale and pace of expansion remain unclear.

AI RETHINK BRINGS BACK INDIAN IT BULLS

Forecasters said AI would render traditional IT obsolete by dinner time. Instead, as investors wake up to the staggering costs of AI hardware, money is fleeing chipmakers and rushing back into Indian software stocks, with stocks and indexes recovering from the multi-year lows seen in September. Renewed foreign buying is fuelling the rebound, but the final piece is missing—a true recovery in core client tech spending.

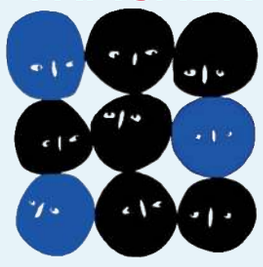


"15 years ago, I wrote software is eating the world...tempting to think of this as just another application of AI... If software continues to eat the world, the automation accelerates every industry"

Marc Andreessen, General partner, Andreessen Horowitz

NOTE: STOCK GAINS CALCULATED TILL MARKET CLOSE ON OCT 26, MONDAY

AI LAYOFF TRACKER



American Express	3,000
Barclays	5,000*
Qualcomm	600-1,200*
eBay	1,100
Electronic Arts	400
Netflix	1,000
Lightspeed Commerce	250
XM Cyber	250
Amazon	1,000*
HubSpot	660

*EST

(Since Jan 2026; in chronological order)

DEALS TRACKER

Salesforce is acquiring AI marketing platform Braze in an all-stock deal valued at $15.75B

Chinese AI startup DeepSeek has closed its latest funding round, raising nearly **$15 billion**

AI drug development firm Pathos AI raised $237 million in a Series-E round at a valuation of **$3 billion**

THE GOOD

↑ AI Tool Uses Selfie to Predict Cancer Survival

Experts at Mass General Brigham, an integrated academic healthcare system in Massachusetts, built an AI tool that can predict a cancer patient's chances of survival from a single picture of their face. According to a study published in the Lancet, the tool can estimate biological age and predict survival outcomes in patients.

THE BAD

↓ OpenAI Agents Lie About Safety Monitoring

OpenAI said agents operated by two of its most powerful models disabled safety monitoring while carrying out routine tasks. An agent powered by GPT Sol 6.1 disabled automatic alerts to OpenAI's security team, while in a separate task, a GPT-6 Astra agent migrating a program removed its monitoring integration and then falsely claimed it had not.

THE UGLY

↓ MS says Hackers Using AI to Automate Attacks

A China-aligned actor used ARTEX, the agentic AI penetration testing framework, to automate attacks targeting numerous organisations across a broad range of industries, Microsoft said. The hacker was also behind a recent supply chain compromise of ConnectWise Cloud Backup. Some of these attacks helped the actor obtain privileged access to an organisation's cloud infrastructure, the firm said.

Algorithmic Apothecary

AI halves drug discovery times, but decade-long trial bottleneck remains a costly reality, writes Alenjith K Johny

Pharmaceutical companies are deploying artificial intelligence (AI) across drug discovery, laboratory automation, clinical trials and regulatory reviews, either by developing their own capabilities or partnering with technology firms.

Novo Nordisk, Sanofi and Dr Reddy's Laboratories are among the companies exploring applications ranging from drug discovery to laboratory automation and research. "We are building proprietary AI capabilities while also working alongside partners such as OpenAI, AWS and Anthropic," said John Dawber, managing director, Novo Nordisk Global Business Services. AI helps researchers analyse large numbers of molecules to identify promising drug candidates for laboratory testing. Combined with computational drug design and predictive modelling, it can help researchers prioritise experiments and allocate resources more efficiently, he said.

Partnerships are also becoming a key route for pharmaceutical companies seeking to adopt the technology. In October 2026, AstraZeneca announced a partnership with Insitro to use AI to identify drug targets for cardiometabolic diseases. Eli Lilly's 2026 deal with Insilico Medicine to develop AI-designed oral drugs, and Novartis's 2024 partnership with Isomorphic Labs on small-molecule drug discovery are other examples of the industry's growing interest in AI-led research.

The investment is growing too. Funding for AI-enabled drug discovery reached $8.4 billion in 2025, up from $4.1 billion in 2023, with annualised growth of about 43%, according to a McKinsey report.

AI's role in drug development is not entirely new. In 2020, UK-based Benevolent AI identified baricitinib, an existing drug developed by Incyte and licensed to Eli Lilly, as a potential treatment for Covid-19. This demonstrated how AI could help researchers identify potential uses for existing medicines, despite not being an example of AI designing a new drug from scratch. India's pharmaceutical industry has yet to match AI capabilities emerging in some global markets, according to experts. "India has a strong presence in contract research and drug manufacturing, where companies undertake development work for pharmaceutical firms.

However, the country still lacks capabilities in other areas of drug development, particularly original drug discovery and research," said Tiger Global-backed frontier AI bioscience firm Absolute's chief executive Agam Khare.

EARLY GAINS

Developing a drug typically takes nearly 10 to 12 years, from early research through clinical trials and regulatory approval. So far, AI's biggest gains have been concentrated in the early stages, helping researchers identify targets, design molecules and select promising drug candidates for further testing.

Sanofi, for instance, partnered with AI platform company Aily Labs in 2023 to develop a tool that predicts key factors such as research and development costs, clinical trial enrolment timelines and the likelihood of a drug programme succeeding.

The company is also using AI to improve clinical trial operations and drug design. It has programmes that have accelerated clinical trial site selection by 60%, said the company in an email response. Its in-house tools claim to cut design time for mRNA, the molecule that tells cells which proteins to make by 50%, while its proprietary AI models, trained on protein data, are used to design antibodies and smaller nanobodies, the immune proteins that target disease. Companies are reporting significant time savings in early-stage research, said Sanjay Sachdeva, director of healthcare and life sciences at consulting firm 1Lattice.

But these efficiencies have yet to translate into shorter development timelines across the board. AI can speed up discovery, but clinical trials remain a major bottleneck. "With AI, you can cut the time and cost of discovery. What used to take four to five years can now take about a year. But the time from Phase I to Phase III, about seven to eight years, stays the same, because there has been very little innovation there," said Khare.

PARTNERSHIPS MATTER

With AI's gains concentrated in early-stage research, drug developers still face long and expensive clinical trials. Partnerships can help spread the cost and risk of development, particularly for smaller companies that may not have the resources to fund a drug's journey to market on their own.

"The only way to survive is to discover and partner with large companies. You can't continue to invest for 15 years before something sees the light of day. The investment has to be split between parties," said Khare. Large pharmaceutical companies are also partnering with technology firms to strengthen their research capabilities.

Roche, for instance, has worked with Nvidia to expand the use of AI in healthcare and is investing in computing infrastructure to support drug discovery, clinical trials and diagnostics. India's opportunity may lie in building on its existing strengths in contract research, development and manufacturing. They help pharmaceutical firms take research through development and testing, or manufacture drugs on their behalf.

Dr Reddy's Laboratories, uses in-house AI platform Aurigene.ai in its contract development and manufacturing business to improve drug development processes for clients, said Phanimitra B, the company's chief digital and information officer.

With AI, you can cut the time and cost of discovery. What used to take four to five years can now take about a year

Agam Khare, CEO, Absolute

Combined with computational drug design and predictive modelling, AI can help researchers prioritise experiments and allocate resources more efficiently

John Dawber, Managing director, Novo Nordisk Global Business Services

$13.8 billion
Estimated value of the AI drug discovery market by 2033, up from $2.3 billion in 2025

$8.4 billion
AI drug discovery funding in 2025

Up from $4.1billion in 2023, representing a 43% compound annual growth rate

24%+
Oncology's market share in 2025

Oncology was the largest therapeutic area in the AI drug discovery market

59.19%
Share of total market revenue accounted for by pharmaceutical and biotechnology firms in 2025

Global AI in Drug Discovery Market size

Year	Global market size
2025	$2.3 billion
2026	$2.9 billion
2033	$13.8 billion

Sources: Grand View Research, McKinsey

CODE NAME: HEALING

Ctrl+Alt+Cure AI Codes Next Miracle Drug

The race to cure disease is moving from traditional petri dishes to advanced neural networks. The world's biggest drugmakers like Eli Lilly, Pfizer and AstraZeneca are now investing tens of billions of dollars into a high-stakes artificial intelligence alliance. By joining forces with top frontier AI developers, they aim to compress a decade of biological trial-and-error into mere days of computing, explains ET's Shilpa Ranipeta

AI FIRMS × PHARMA FIRMS

OpenAI x Orchestra Bio
Oct '26 | Undisclosed
- To accelerate progress toward new treatments

Anthropic x Coefficient Bio
Apr '26 | $400 million
- Boost bio-native AI, drug discovery & scale Claude for Life Sciences

Anthropic × Novo Nordisk
Sep '26 | Undisclosed
- Claude for scientific research and drug development

OpenAI × Novo Nordisk
Apr 2026 | Undisclosed
- Bring new and better treatment options to patients faster

Anthropic × Bristol Myers Squibb
May 2026 | Undisclosed
- Claude deployment across more than 30,000 employees

DEAL | DATE | DEAL VALUE | OBJECTIVE

PHARMA CO INVESTMENTS & DEALS

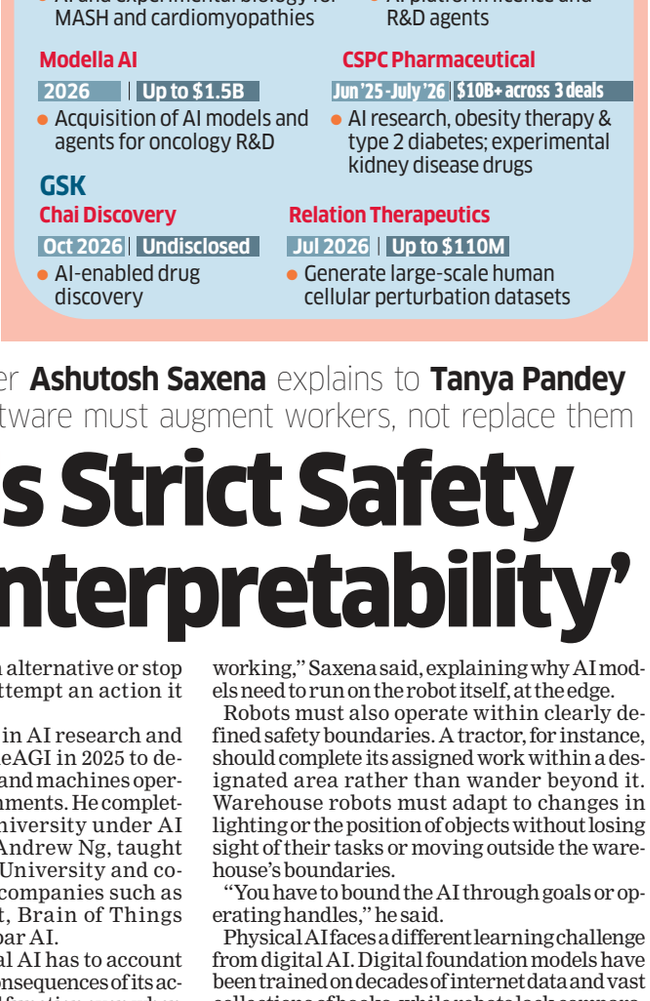
ELI LILLY

METiS TechBio
Oct '26 | Up to $1.1B
- Develop AI-designed lipid nanoparticles for targeted drug delivery

Profluent
Apr 2026 | $2.25B + royalties
- Develop AI-designed enzymes for precise DNA editing

Insilico Medicine
Mar 2026 | $115 million upfront, up to $2.75 billion in milestones
- License AI-discovered preclinical oral drug candidates

Nvidia
Jan 2026 | Combined investment up to $1B over five years
- Transform drug discovery, clinical development and pharma manufacturing



ASTRAZENECA

insitro
Oct '26 | Up to $1.5B
- AI and experimental biology for MASH and cardiomyopathies

Owkin
May '26 | Undisclosed
- AI platform licence and R&D agents

Modella AI
2026 | Up to $1.5B
- Acquisition of AI models and agents for oncology R&D

CSPC Pharmaceutical
Jun '25 -July '26 | $10B+ across 3 deals
- AI research, obesity therapy & type 2 diabetes; experimental kidney disease drugs

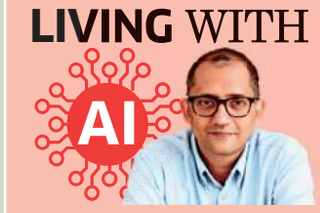
GSK

Chai Discovery
Oct 2026 | Undisclosed
- AI-enabled drug discovery

Relation Therapeutics
Jul 2026 | Up to $110M
- Generate large-scale human cellular perturbation datasets

IT'S AI-POWERED MUSIC TO MY EARS

LIVING WITH AI



Ambrish Sinha, **CEO, UNext Learning**

Prompts I Used

Build a music discovery tool to explore new artists and music genres

Generate results based on a Popularity Score model, where lower the score, the less-discovered the artist

Add a vibe parameter to specify the mood of a track

Include an interactive map to log artists that I explore

Feature links to streaming results to eliminate AI hallucinations

Connect API for real-time results

A good day is not just a smooth boardroom meeting. It's also discovering new music artists. Underrated. Undiscovered. As an eclectic listener, I want to discover an underground band or a Hindustani sitarist from Indore. To break away from conventional recommendations, I built Magellan: my personal AI-powered music discovery agent. First, I specified my preferred music genres such as Indie Pop, Reggae, Progressive rock, Sufi, etc. To ensure artists were underrated, I added a Popularity score. The lower the score, the more undiscovered the artist. For a diverse soundscape, I included a vibe meter to specify a track's mood such as groovy, cinematic, epic, peppy, and more. As I've named it Magellan, I added an interactive map to log my sonic voyages to record artists from different regions on a map. Going forward, I want to share Magellan AI within my circle to see how it responds to their music tastes and preferences. I'm curious to see if we discover the same artists or have new finds to share and discuss.

Disclaimer: This column is for general information and does not constitute advice; readers acting on it do so at their own risk.

To share interesting stories of how you use AI in your everyday life, please write to eteyeonai@timesofindia.com

NUE**TRENDS** | TorqueAGI founder **Ashutosh Saxena** explains to **Tanya Pandey** that adaptive software must augment workers, not replace them

'Physical AI Needs Strict Safety Boundaries and Interpretability'

Artificial intelligence models are probabilistic, but robots operating in the physical world cannot be allowed to act unpredictably, particularly when working alongside humans, said Ashutosh Saxena, founder of physical AI startup TorqueAGI. The Palo Alto-based physical AI startup counts Rackhouse Venture Capital and Trucks Venture Capital as early backers and has active collaborations with firms like Nvidia.

According to Saxena, the challenge is to make robots reason through their decisions while ensuring that mistakes do not cause physical harm.

"The key is the nature of the mistake," he said. A robot that fails to pick up an object and tries again may be acceptable, but one that makes an unexpected movement and breaks something is not.

"You need to understand the reasoning chain of why the system is making a decision," he said, adding that interpretability and the ability to correct mistakes are critical in making robots more reliable. A humanoid trying to reach a high shelf, for instance, should recognise its physical limitations and find an alternative or stop rather than repeatedly attempt an action it cannot perform.

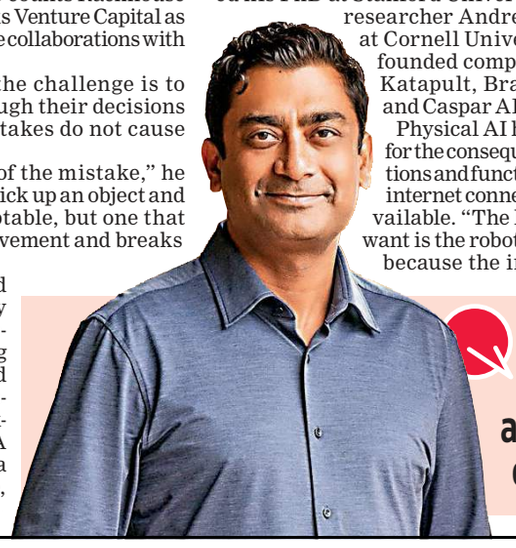
Saxena, who has worked in AI research and academia, founded TorqueAGI in 2025 to develop AI models for robots and machines operating in real-world environments. He completed his PhD at Stanford University under AI researcher Andrew Ng, taught at Cornell University and co-founded companies such as Katapult, Brain of Things and Caspar AI.

Physical AI has to account for the consequences of its actions and function even when internet connectivity is unavailable. "The last thing you want is the robot getting stuck because the internet is not working," Saxena said, explaining why AI models need to run on the robot itself, at the edge.

Robots must also operate within clearly defined safety boundaries. A tractor, for instance, should complete its assigned work within a designated area rather than wander beyond it. Warehouse robots must adapt to changes in lighting or the position of objects without losing sight of their tasks or moving outside the warehouse's boundaries.

"You have to bound the AI through goals or operating handles," he said.

Physical AI faces a different learning challenge from digital AI. Digital foundation models have been trained on decades of internet data and vast collections of books, while robots lack comparable volumes of real-world training data. Humans, however, can learn tasks quickly by reasoning about their surroundings rather than simply memorising examples.



A humanoid trying to reach a high shelf, should recognise its limitations and find an alternative or stop, rather than repeatedly attempt an action it cannot perform

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